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Team RPG Dev

CECS 491A: Computer Science Senior Project I

17 March 2025

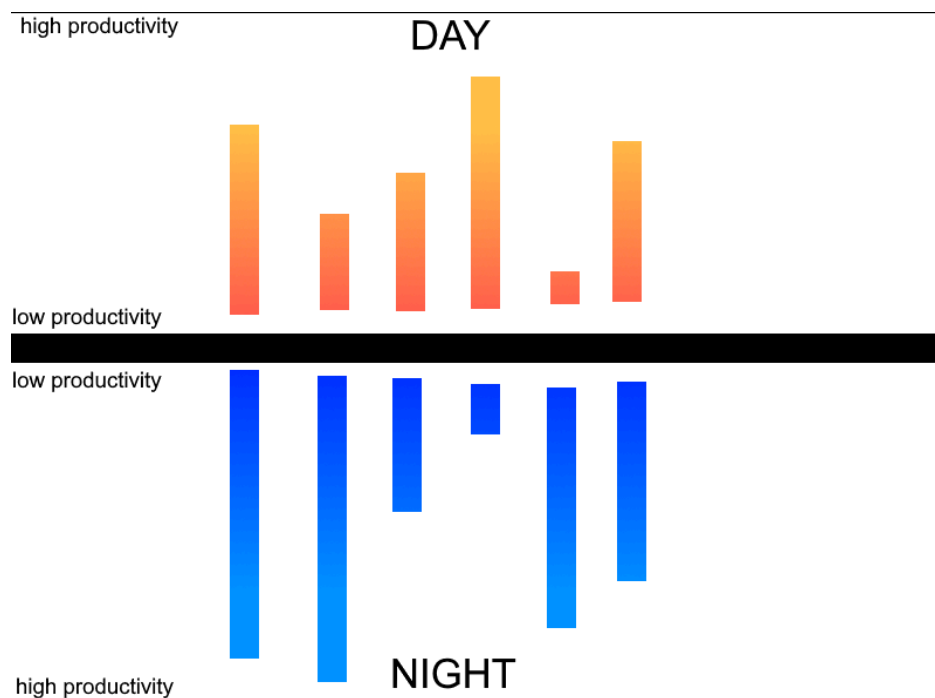
Milestone 2 : Comprehensive Target User Definition & Report

Introduction:

For Milestone 2 of 491A, Team RPG Dev was tasked with conducting user-research interviews from a diverse pool of potential users. Key takeaways that we looked to leave with from each interview involved discovering pain points that the potential user may have encountered with similar products in our targeted market. In addition to discovering potential pain points we are also looking to discover the user's perspective on a range of topics from questions that Team RPG Dev has collectively formed. The questions that the team has formed range from topics such as: Student/Work Status, Engagement with Apps/Games, Pain Points & Challenges, and so forth. Once the user-research interviews were completed, we looked to find any common patterns and themes that we have noticed amongst the 19 interviewees. From this point, we looked to establish defying quality and traits to form different personas; these personas that the team curated are supposed to be a representation of who our potential users can be. The user-research is crucial in our path to developing our application for the reason that we will be able to meet the needs of our intended audience when proceeding and deciding what features suit best for the intended audience. The following report will include the transcripts from the user-research interviews conducted by the team, the user insights that were derived from the interviews, personas of potential users, and some use-case scenarios that could be presented to potential users.

User Insights Discovered From Interviews:

Fig (a).



One point that we noticed from the data gathered from interviews is that the most productive time of the day varied from individual to individual, some responses indicated that they felt mornings were the hardest to feel productive versus other responses pointing towards mornings actually being the best time of day to get things done. Rather than a time of day some even answered with whenever they were doing a certain activity, such as any time between classes. Overall, since this point in particular seems to be up to the individual's personal preference a solid conclusion can't be drawn without a much more extensive data set to draw a conclusive decision on what would be the most typical time any given individual would be most productive. The purpose of this question was to figure out if our team should build an application with reminders based on time of the day. However, with our findings, it is better off to

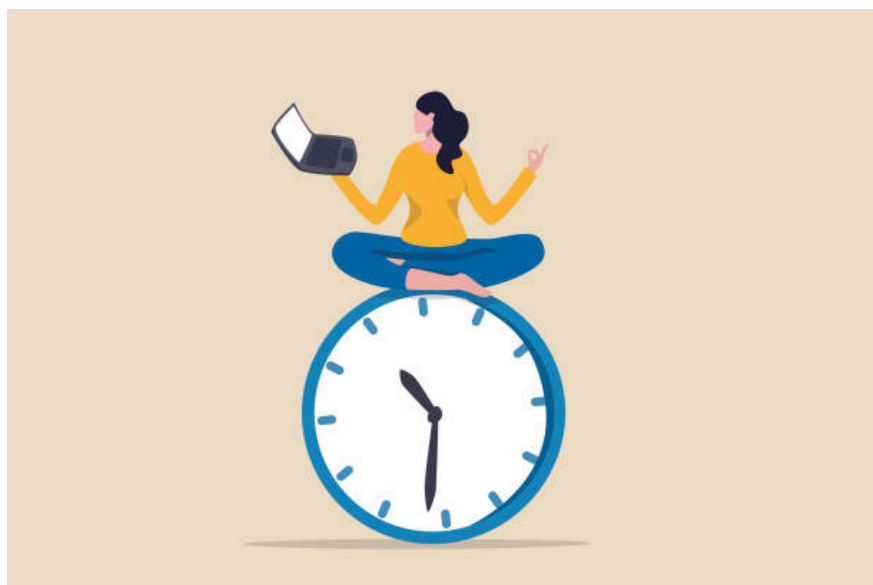
holistically create an application that would work 24/7 whenever needed and the user can set up their own preferences as needed.

Fig (b).



Another point that we came across had to do with whether or not someone would be interested in using an additional tool to help keep track of their daily routine or if they were already using one. From the answers that came back a lot replied that they were not currently using any particular medium to keep track of their routine. Several users reported using basic planner apps such as Dawn, Reminders on iPhone, or other basic task apps. Several participants reported using physical mediums such as a basic list on paper as well as a daily planner. Many participants didn't find any problems with current usage of their applications to keep track of their goals. In this scenario, using a well-known and used application can be a basis of our app implementation. Our team will likely add onto our application gamifying elements that won't interfere with the purpose of the application—to stay productive.

Fig (c).



Some other key takeaways were that users generally prefer two main things about the overall user experience. For a productivity app they value simplicity in an app's design without an overwhelming amount of content on the screen. This means no clunky, intrusive layouts and a clean overall user interface. The other thing is that they prefer customizability when it comes to the way they track or plan tasks. One participant referred to an app called Notion that has a steep learning curve and requires extensive set up to get started. They prefer an app that works “out of the box” having little to no setup. This tells us that gamifying a productivity app has to not interfere with the purpose at the end—staying productive and motivated. Gamifying elements should not be intrusive, but rather add an interesting/engaging spark in the usage of our application. The gamification elements should also not be too time consuming for the user and should reflect immediate and important things that are needed.

Unsurprisingly, many users report feeling overwhelmed by daily tasks or goals. Several participants reported that they had used apps in the past to track daily tasks and productivity in other aspects such as working out. They shared common pain points with these apps stating that they were overwhelming as they required planning time periods longer than day-to-day. Some of them were also lacking in features or had features that clashed with the app's intended purpose. Apple's Reminders app comes to mind due to the fact that it is a little complicated to set reminders. Overall, unnecessary complexity and questionable features are what primarily cause a loss of engagement with a productivity app. Another factor that may cause loss of engagement in an application includes not having enough time or no necessity to engage with it. Our intended audiences, students, typically used these trackers during school times or whenever an amount of assignments or tasks start to overwhelm them, and dealing with an application with hassle would skew them away from using said product.

While many users are overwhelmed by daily tasks and goals, these same individuals also want to seek self-improvement. This concept can be found in individuals looking to do better athletically, mentally, socially, or academically. This includes moving forward in life which could be seeking higher education, career opportunities, tracking workouts, or simply reaching your fullest potential in your current place in life. Many individuals have used apps as a tool in order to achieve self-improvement in a wide variety of topics and fields. In response to this insight, our application should be built to be flexible to support the needs of the users in whatever their current and future endeavors are. Creating a rough pathline for certain user goals should be available in our application as a basis for them to add on. An example template of a pathline in improving in the career field include: getting experiences, creating resumes, finding connections, applying for jobs, practicing for interviews, and more.

In terms of gamification, many participants support the gamification of productivity apps for several reasons. They felt that it could not only contribute to their motivation, but also believe it could retain their engagement with the app. Participants reported that some of the reasons they stopped using certain productivity apps in the past were due to the way they attempted to retain engagement with the app. One example that comes to mind are notifications that remind a user too often that they should return to the app. This could be eliminated by introducing gamified features. Regardless, it is true that a lot of people struggle with productivity whether or not they play video games. However, people like to feel rewarded and accomplished for having completed tasks, especially gamers. The idea of gamification should not overwhelm the purpose of being productive, having a passive way to track your progression throughout completing deadlines, activities, and goals is a visual way for users to know they are being productive, providing, hopefully instilling a sense of a positive feedback loop.

Aside from just gamifying an app, users would like to have a visual of their productivity and progression over time. This could be as simple as statistics of tasks completed throughout a week, month, year, etc. Introducing more stimulating and engaging visuals could help users visually track their progress in a fun, attractive way. A concept that was introduced to the interviewees was providing an avatar and based on completed goals and tasks, the user could receive some form of reward being gear for their avatar, badges, or levels to display their consistency and accomplishments. The interviewees responded positively to the concept with the consensus being that it could be a positive reinforcement if they are able to see their consistency put on display. Having such concepts introduced into our application can help with user engagement and retention if they are able to display their progress of being consistent over a period time.

Another piece of insight that the team was able to take away from the user-research interview was in relation to which device between the choices of mobile device or desktop that the user prefers. We chose to ask users this question to gain insight on whether it would be better to develop the app for mobile or desktop with the hopes of maintaining user engagement. We learned that for activities such as gaming users often preferred desktop; when it came to productivity the majority chose a mobile device with few choosing desktop. From the interviews we are able to conclude that the majority of Interviewees had preferred mobile devices over desktop. It can be summarized that the responses from the interviewees selecting mobile devices was due to the reason that they often have their phone on their person more often than their desktop or laptop.

An area that we gained insight on was whether or not users have struggled with meeting their goals/tasks. Many of our interviewees reported that while they met the majority of their

deadlines, not all of them are proud of it. Many use deadlines as a motivator rather than a way to space things out in a way that reduces stress and provides more free time and productivity on a day-to-day basis. The goal of our application is to also allow users to be able to see immediate rewards or gratification for being productive, otherwise they may lose engagement in being motivated. People don't necessarily struggle, but may feel overwhelmed if they have to juggle a lot on a day-to-day basis. Our application should cater to what the user wants by providing a way to visually guide them into meeting deadlines and goals.

In terms of subscription services, we gained insight that not all software is created and priced the same. Each category of applications has its own applications and may cost more depending on the toolsets it provides. Typically interviewees also appreciated a demonstration or free trial of applications before deciding to purchase an application. More research will need to be done in terms of pricing our application. There are many opportunities to make revenue out of this product, but we want to keep it low cost for users to provide an entry point into using a productivity application to improve their lives towards meeting certain goals.

Persona Development:



Javier Patel

Age : 18-24

High School Education

College Student

Goals and Objectives

- Staying consistent
- Job hunting
- Starting a fulfilling and stable career

PAIN POINTS

- Overly Complicated UI
- Intrusive Notifications
- Having to Setup Up an App

Technologies

- Mobile
- Desktop

MOTIVATION

- Stability
- Progression

SCREENTIME



ACTIVITY (Weekly)



BUDGET (Monthly)



APPS USED

Discord
Youtube
Instagram



Ren Takahashi

Age : 25-35

Bachelor's Degree

Working Full Time

Goals and Objectives

- Become More Productive Outside of Work, Disconnect from Work Mindset
- Begin Working Out
- Maintain a Clean Living Space

PAIN POINTS

- Dislikes Samsung's Health App
- Wants Something Better than Physical List of Tasks
- Paid Apps Currently Not Worth Price

Technologies

- Mostly Mobile

MOTIVATION

- Self Improvement
- Clear Goals
- Tracking Progress

SCREENTIME



ACTIVITY (Weekly)

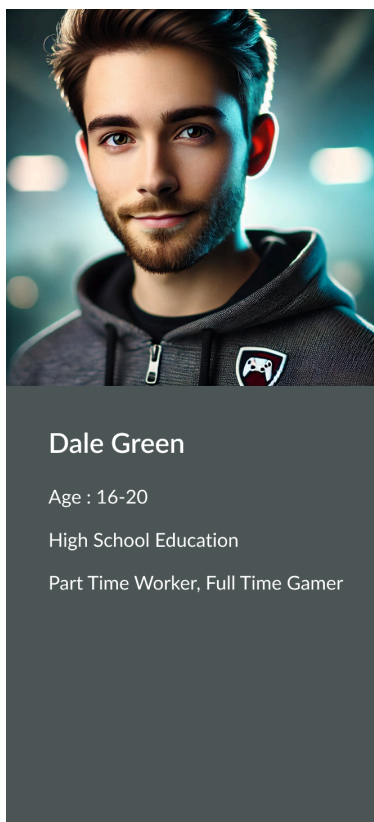


BUDGET (Monthly)



APPS USED

Health
Teams
Finch



Goals and Objectives

- Spend Free Time Playing Video Games
- Balance Gaming with Life's Responsibilities
- Healthy Competition with Peers

PAIN POINTS

- Engaging Apps that aren't Productive
- Productivity Apps Aren't Fun
- No Reward for Completing Tasks

Technologies

- Mobile for Productivity
- Desktop for Gaming

MOTIVATION

- Enjoyable
- Gaming
- Well-Designed Rewards
- FoMO (Fear of Missing Out)

SCREENTIME



ACTIVITY (Weekly)

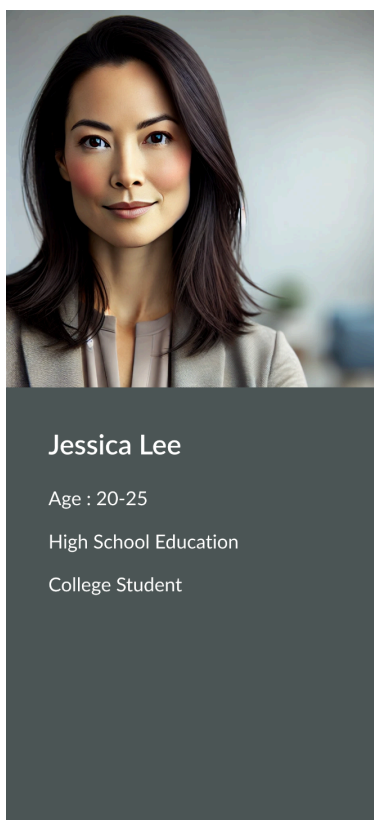


BUDGET (Monthly)



APPS USED

Discord
Steam
Notes



Goals and Objectives

- Become Productive in Everyday Life
- Seek Help in Achieving Goals
- Limit Procrastination

PAIN POINTS

- Spending Too Much Time in an App
- No Way to Track Progress
- No Guidance in Apps

Technologies

- Mobile for Convenience

MOTIVATION

- Rewards for Productivity
- Better Quality of Life
- More Productive Free Time

SCREENTIME



ACTIVITY (Weekly)

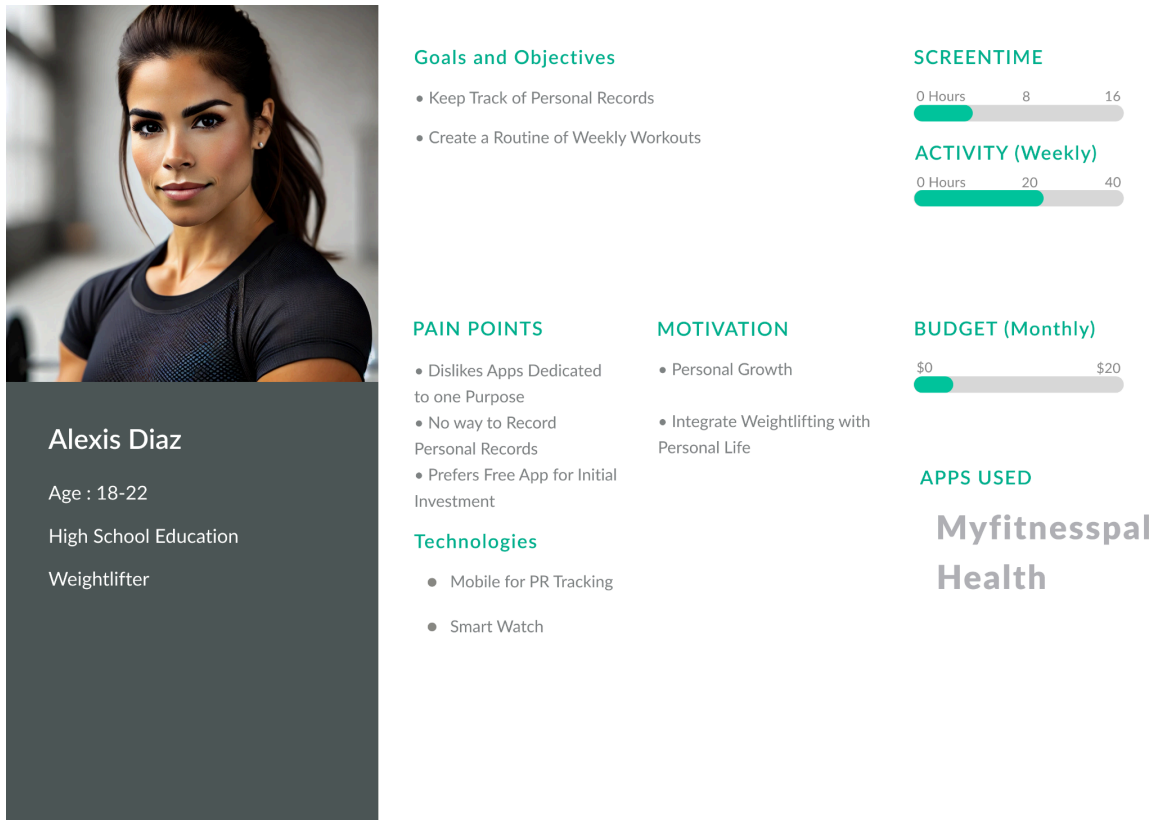


BUDGET (Monthly)



APPS USED

Health
Messages



Use Case Scenarios:

Javier Patel:

Javier is in his final year of college, juggling multiple responsibilities such as coursework, job applications, and his personal life. He often procrastinates and struggles to prioritize assignments, leading to last-minute stress. He needs a tool that helps him stay accountable while making productivity engaging. While browsing online forums about time management for students Javier discovers about a gamified productivity app. He decides to download and create an account on his mobile device. By exploring the app, Javier discovers about the core features such as task tracking and reward-based productivity. Javier inputs his current priorities being: coursework, job applications, and fitness. Javier customizes his “Quest List”, breaking his tasks into actionable steps. Every completed task earns Javier XP (Experience Points), by doing this he is leveling up his in-app avatar. By consistently using the app, Javier is

able to unlock achievement badges. As Javier continues to use the app he is challenged by one of his friends; through the leaderboards, Javier is motivated to complete his tasks to land a higher placement than his friend. With consistency of using the app Javier receives a report displaying his efficiency, identifying the days he was most productive and the days he was least. After months of consistent use, Javier lands his first job interview. Now that he is financially stable he decides to purchase the battle pass the application provides recognizing the success that the app has helped him achieve.

Ren Takahasi:

Ren Takahashi is a work-oriented individual seeking to improve his productivity while maintaining a healthy balance to avoid burnout. To do this, he needs a structured and engaging way to track his progress. He believes a gamified productivity app will help him detach from his work mindset outside of work while also making task management more enjoyable.

At work, Ren is responsible for delegating team tasks and maintaining meeting notes, both of which require organization and accountability. He relies on a physical planner that he cannot afford to lose. He also fears missing deadlines and failing to maintain team cohesion. During his downtime at work he researches if there are any productivity apps that suit his needs. That's when he discovers RPG, a gamified productivity app designed to turn productivity into a rewarding experience. He sees that there is a free version. He dislikes having to pay for apps that don't seem worth the money they charge. He decides if he likes RPG he will pay for the full version. Ren sees that he can form a virtual team for his workgroup, track assigned tasks, and keep track of reminders for meeting notes. The leaderboard system allows him to compete with his team on productivity while also working together on team projects. He earns badges and rewards for meeting deadlines and completing tasks, helping him avoid burnout. Outside of

work, Ren is focused on self-improvement. He wants to start working out and track that progress so he sees that his efforts are paying off. He appreciates how RPG allows him to track workouts, set personal milestones, and level up as he achieves goals. The progress tracking system gives him visual confirmation of his achievements. What starts as a work tool soon becomes an essential part of his daily routine. Ren finds himself using RPG for home tasks, fitness tracking, and personal goal setting. The app not only helps him stay productive but also makes the process enjoyable through gamification. By competing with coworkers, earning achievements, and watching his progress grow, Ren finally feels in control of his workload without falling into burnout. RPG transforms productivity into an engaging, rewarding experience that keeps him motivated in all aspects of his life.

Dale Green

Dale Green is an avid gamer, and is always wanting to play games and have as much fun as possible throughout the day. However, he has a problem that has two main parts. The problem is that he can not stay productive enough and loses out on time he could be using to play games and have fun. However, he also struggles with staying engaged with means of staying productive like through apps. When bringing this up to his online friends, they give him the idea to use a popular productivity app that combines what he loves with what he needs, gaming and productivity. It helps him be productive by rewarding him for finishing goals with game-like leveling systems and customizations. It also helps him prioritize what tasks need to be done first so he can go back to gaming. Through this app, he would be able to stay productive because the app uses familiar tactics such as leveling up, badges, streaks, and FOMO rewards. These tactics his favorite game uses help him stay accountable for his productivity goals by giving him rewards for meeting them. On top of that, Dale also found the battle pass had many rewards he

would love to show off to his other friends, as well as the want to get limited time only cosmetics and customizations.

Jessica Lee:

Jessica often finds herself procrastinating on important tasks whether it's house chores, work-related projects, or personal goals. She often struggles with self-discipline and motivation, often having feelings of being overwhelmed. She needs a structured but engaging system that keeps her accountable while rewarding her efforts. Jessica searches for “best productivity apps for procrastination” and discovers this gamified productivity app with positive ratings. She decides to download the application onto her mobile device. By interacting with the application she learns of the core features: such as: goal-setting and rewards for progress. Jessica sets up small, manageable quests for herself such as: completing one work task before checking social media, partaking in a set amount of time of exercise before noon, and spending 10 minutes decluttering her workspace. The application syncs up with Samsung Health, pulling in her step count. Each task that Jessica completes earns her XP points, assisting with leveling up her in-app character. After a month of usage, Jessica sees real changes in habits: she notices that she spends less time procrastinating and more time on meaningful tasks. In addition, her Samsung Health data is showing improved activity levels, thanks to her commitment of moving daily. She is now able to establish a morning routine that makes her feel energized and ready to tackle the day. After noticing her progression, she decides to make a purchase of the subscription service that the app provides to further gain gratification of completing tasks.

Alexis Diaz

Alexis Diaz is a novice weightlifter who tries to workout whenever they can. This has led him to obtain some growth and personal records when it comes to lifting, but they have hit a

plateau with their growth. Without being able to keep track of just how often they go to the gym, or even how much they lifted in their previous session, their personal records and growth seem to not be obtainable anymore. While looking for help and insight as to how they can improve their lifting experience and reach their goals, Alexis gets notified of a way to help keep track of their goals and personal records through a gamified goal tracking app. Not only would this help keep track of her lifting sessions and her personal records in lifting, but also incentivise him to go more often and regularly through streak rewards and leveling up. After Alexis came across the goal tracking app, it has made him record her progress and go to the gym on a regular basis, increasing their personal growth once again and integrating fitness into their everyday life more seamlessly. After getting used to the app and its benefits, Alexis decides she wants even more rewards for staying on top of their routine to keep them on track even on the worst of days. To do this, Alexis pays into the subscription service to even further reward themselves for keeping up the routine and losing more if not.

Interviews:

Bryan:

1. Jenni Lim

Bryan: Hello!

Jenni: Hello!

Bryan: Okay, so uh just want to make sure, did you complete the consent forms that I sent to you?

Jenni: Yeah.

Bryan: Okay, so uh this is an interview for my 491a class at uh Long Beach and essentially we're building an application that uh involves productivity boosting your productivity and um so right now I guess right now we're just getting some user research or we're doing re user research and one of the things is to interviews and things like that so does that sound good to you?

Jenni: Yeah

Bryan: All right okay so let's start off with you so uh what is your current like status are you a student are you working you're doing both can you tell me a little bit about yourself.

Jenni: Um I graduated this year and I'm just studying for grad school exams so postgraduate I guess

Bryan: Okay, um so how many hours do you think you're doing a day studying or in a week?

Jenni: Probably three to four hours a week and then I take like one day off.

Bryan: Okay uh do you do you feel like this is part of your daily routine is it something that you find fun to do is it productive for you?

Jenni: I don't find it fun, it's just something that I have to do and once I have gotten used to it and adapted to it then it just becomes something like second nature.

Bryan: Okay, do you have any struggles with meeting specific goals that you set for yourself like uh for example you study this today and then you do it again do you ever shift your focus around a lot.

Jenni: Yeah I used to be like that because at in the beginning like for example when you're starting like a new class or like studying for a new test it feels overwhelming but then once I got used to it it took like a few weeks and then it just becomes like kind of manageable I try to break it down into like pieces

Bryan: Okay, that's that's nice um uh so so what about like routines is there do you track your routine or anything do you have any that you use to like keep track of what you were doing like hourly or like daily or in a weekly basis

Jenni: Um, I do it daily just like a rough outline you I used to just use Google Calendar I used to use like Notion as a checklist when I was in school cuz um for assignments but I just found that being more flexible helps not get stressed out as much or put too much pressure

Bryan: That's good uh notion was that the writing tool or I can you please explain to me what notion is I know what Google Calendar is but what is notion?

Jenni: Notion, it's like you can create your own website kind of you um make your own themes and then you can input like lists and different databases and then all these like you can customize uh basically like it's like a giant to-do list and there's different pages and everything so it's kind of like a website.

Bryan: Got it, did you use that on your phone?

Jenni: It's on my phone and laptop both.

Bryan: Okay alright thank you. Okay uh just for now or maybe compare yourself to before and now um is it challenging for you to balance your different goals and tasks?

Jenni: Now it's easier because I'm out of school so I have more time to study and just focus on only a few things whereas when I was a student I'd have more responsibilities like I'd have to time manage better and for example I'd have to wake up earlier go to class and then do whatever after if I had to go to lab then that means that I wouldn't have time to do homework and like etc.

Bryan: Okay, uh do you play any or like during your breaks or whatever like I guess during school or even now did you use did you play any games did you what did you did you do any social media to help you relax or like something like that?

Jenni: Um I just use Instagram for catching up with people but the main one for just relaxing was just Tik Tok just watching videos and that was just like scrolling.

Bryan: Okay uh well okay if you put yourself in your shoes which you obviously are um in those applications do you what keeps you engaged in using them?

Jenni: Just the amount of content and usually the content that you see is catered towards you so if you like certain things like an algorithm then you just get presented with like more things that are similar and it's just easy to get to waste a lot of time and then spend more time on there than uh doing work.

Bryan: Okay um okay so moving on to the next topic uh do you feel like you have a lot of free time?

Jenni: I feel like I do even though it seems like I have a lot to do and it's just a lot of work, I feel like I have more time to balance and more flexibility to plan around things.

Bryan: Okay uh do you seek self-improvement for yourself whether it be through furthering your goals your career even healthwise?

Jenni: Yeah I've always been trying to have a more like growth mindset um I don't really like to be stagnant for too long if I do something for a long time then I feel uncomfortable so I like to have a little bit of variety.

Bryan: Okay would that include things like when you're doing whatever you're doing for your free time

Jenni: yeah I usually try to implement new things such as going to the gym or doing more like recently I started volunteering just to have some sort of change and then um it just feels like I have other things to look forward to than doing like monotonous uh routine.

Bryan: Oh that's nice and regards to volunteering do you feel like it's something that you look forward to? Cause that's kind of like a bit of commitment for you I assume.

Jenni: Yeah I do look forward to it because a lot of my time is spent studying now and that's usually alone and then just like on the computer and just like looking at flash cards and stuff so it's nice to have um a obligation to go outside and have a social environment where I can talk to people on a weekly basis and then also just feel like I'm doing something else.

Bryan: Okay that's that's really nice um so earlier you mentioned uh you use Google Calendar do you I assume you are still using that and you said notion you don't really use that much uh if you go back to school which I assume you are since you're studying uh to go into med school uh are do you plan to go back into using notion?

Jenni: Yeah because I just feel like the interface for Google Calendar since I have less things to do in general I can just be able to more easily put my task on one place but if I were to go back to school obviously you're juggling more things like multiple classes working etc. so then you would need separate pages or different places to store your assignment or other time obligations so a notion is easier for that but I feel like if you don't you have a lot of free time and you don't have much going on then it just seems a little like overwhelming to use.

Bryan: Uh you're talking about Notion right? Is that too excessive if you don't have a lot of things going?

Jenni: Yeah

Bryan: Okay that's that's nice okay um what are some frustrating aspects of staying productive or organized and that could be like just doing it mentally or even using the applications that you use if that makes sense?

Jenni: Uh frustrating it would would be trying to stay consistent I think that would be my biggest struggle because um there's not really like an outline for how to be consistent or productive it's just kind of like um a quality that people say you should have and that's different for everyone so the only way you can be consistent is being self-disciplined and that is hard because obviously you're the only person who can discipline yourself and stay motivated so I feel like there's a balance of giving yourself time to take a break and also being strict about things that you have to do so I think that's a struggle that I still have even after you know being in school for a long time.

Bryan: Okay and then if you feel overwhelmed or struggle by these things like what do you do like to fix that to get through it?

Jenni: I try to write down what I have to do just kind of step back and then see where I'm at in terms of my like tangible uh assignments or goals that I have for myself and I also if I feel overwhelmed I try to step back and talk to my friends or do something that's more fun such as going like to a cafe or like going out getting a drink or whatever and then um once I have a better mind mindset then it's a little easier to break things down and plan.

Bryan: So basically like a disconnect or like disconnect from whatever is bothering you or something.

Jenni: Yeah because I I noticed like when you're overwhelmed and stuff it's easier to step back and come back with a better with a different mindset than just trying to like force yourself to fix a problem that is obviously not going to get you anywhere

Bryan: Okay and then are there any challenges or frustrations that you've had with using the tools or methods that you're currently using like for example you're trying to do something but it's just too complicated for you or like what you want to add to these tools are not going how you want it to visually show you or anything?

Jenni: You mean the technical side of the applications?

Bryan: Yes technical or like even yourself like uh you maybe tried disconnect like you said earlier but it you couldn't disconnect for some X reason.

Jenni: I would say syncing like between your phone or your laptop sometimes with formatting and stuff on Google Calendar the formatting is not really good so you can't really put like any pictures or anything you can only put text so that's a little limiting especially if people like write list down differently or they need to add like attachments and stuff it's not really accessible that way and then Notion is you can put anything like you can embed even like code and like other videos and stuff but it is less accessible if you're on a time crunch or just trying to be more efficient so I haven't really found like a middle ground in terms of that so I just kind of uh divide my like apps for whatever I can do with them.

Bryan: Okay that's nice uh so essentially if there was an application out there that would be more suitable for you what is something that you're looking to or looking in it looking for it to have?

Jenni: Um I think it should have more accessibility for like images and personalization I found that if I personalize things like with colors or images or just like for me I like putting like cute images or like PNGs like if you've seen people do that online and then um uh for example when I do flash cards and stuff I put like a I downloaded a plugin for um like motivation it's like cat images and stuff so those things could serve as like reinforcement that makes me like using the app versus like it looking weird or looking boring and then just kind of like um giving me a reason to not use it and then also be lazy.

Bryan: uh would this app be like from Notion? Or what app are you specifically talking about?

Jenni: My ideal app would combine.

Bryan: Oh your ideal app yeah yeah okay yeah that's correct okay um how do you feel about getting said up but also combining essences of productivity and gamifying it/

Jenni: That would be fun because I feel like I don't really play a lot of games like I want to but I just don't have energy to do it.

Bryan: No energy okay uh why?

Jenni: Um I just feel like after studying and stuff I just want to shut my brain off and then some games require a lot of uh brain power I see so it's just easier to like Doom scroll or watch videos and stuff.

Bryan: Gotcha.

Jenni: More like passive entertainment.

Bryan: Okay well if there was an application out there that could help you do what you need which is to motivate yourself and also boost your productivity do you think gamification of that application would help like for example if notion had Essences of like games or anything do you think it would help you?

Jenni: Yeah I think it would motivate me to be more consistent and productive.

Bryan: Okay uh what do you think like is there like a specific genre that you would prefer that to have like storytelling or or uh things like that?

Jenni: I think I like apps that like promote growth or like story yeah storytelling like if the characters are able to like have an arc or something or like there's certain games that are like um for example have you seen like gardening games where you have to go in consistently like different days and then you have to like keep doing a task in order to level up and stuff.

Bryan: Oh okay um then for example if you were to get like rewards out of that application what kind of rewards would be most motivating for you so example would be like leveling up or receiving um uh online like cosmetics.

Jenni: What do you mean by cosmetics?

Bryan: Like uh for example if that application had like an avatar or something if you do certain tasks or be consistent or whatever you would get rewards like cosmetics.

Jenni: Oh yeah I would feel like yeah getting coins or like being able to further personalize things would motivate me to um level up and in that case then what I would need to level up is to like track my daily routines and like um be consistent.

Bryan: Okay how do you feel about being honest about yourself like for example you put oh I finish this task by this deadline or whatever and you end up not meeting that deadline would you be honest to yourself that you originally did not meet your deadline.

Jenni: Yeah on my calendar I push things off anyway.

Bryan: Push things off okay but do you feel like even if you do do that if it's not something that of an importance would you still manage to do that task in general?

Jenni: It depends, usually I give myself I try to force myself to do things but if I'm just busy then I will push it off a few days.

Bryan: Okay uh what if there were some like I said earlier about the rewards if you did those things before the deadline would you have more motivation to do it as your original deadline?

Jenni: Yeah because when I'm on my calendar and stuff there's not really like an incentive it's

based on my own planning but if it was um and set up like what you described and it would be more fun.

Bryan: Okay well also since you said it's like for yourself or other people do you what do you feel if you had someone else motivating you?

Jenni: I think usually if people motivate me then it makes me more compelled to do things but if it's just by myself and like I'm supposed to be motivating myself and planning it then it's a little a little bit more difficult.

Bryan: More difficult for yourself? Okay.

Jenni: Yeah.

Bryan: Do you for example for example if you were in school and you had deadlines do you ever feel competition amongst you and then all the students around you?

Jenni: Not really I mean everyone. If it's the same deadline then everyone does it the same way and we help each other but in terms of grades and stuff I personally didn't feel competition but some people might.

Bryan: Okay um okay so going through uh people around you what things do you use to socialize uh so it can be like social media or even games that you play or like even going out or whatever.

Jenni: Um I use social media like Instagram and Discord to talk to my friends and then I usually try to hang out with people at least once a week by going out or going to a cafe or like I'm just getting like a Boba or something.

Bryan: Okay uh so let's go on to the next topic uh this is about the devices that you use um for productivity wise do you prefer using those applications that you mentioned earlier on like your mobile devices or your laptop devices or desktop devices?

Jenni: I don't really have a preference but if I'm like outside then I prefer it on mobile just because it's more accessible.

Bryan: Okay and then what about games do you prefer or this also kind of like whatever is there for you?

Jenni: Yeah whatever is there but it would be nice to have a feature where I could sync it. I like when I'm able to close it on my computer and then go back on my phone and it's the same thing that would be more accessible.

Bryan: Got it! Okay um do you have any smart devices or do you plan to incorporate that in your life like in the future or anything.

Jenni: Um not really.

Bryan: Not really okay um now I'm to go back talking about that games uh so for example you're introduce a new game or whatever if you were told there was a subscription based aspect of that game would you consider playing that game like originally the game is free but then there is an option for you to get a subscription like a battle pass that introduces more new things that you could also get but you would have to pay for it yes you would have to pay for it.

Jenni: Oh usually I don't play those games if they cost money.

Bryan: Okay but for example though the game is free in the beginning and then it would you can keep playing it for free for as long as you want but there's also like a battle pass or a subscription on top of that where you can let's say it would boost your experience or you would get more rewards.

Jenni: Depends how much it would be and how often I play it but usually I don't stay too consistent with games for like a long period of time so it wouldn't be worth it to me.

Bryan: Okay do you play any event based games like uh for example during Christmas season your game would have Christmas cosmetics or anything like that.

Jenni: Not really I used to but I don't really anymore you don't really anymore.

Bryan: Okay, well for example let's say you still played those things and there is an event where there's some limited time items and if you don't get those things like would you feel like have a FOMO feeling like would it encourage you to continue working towards getting those cosmetics?

Jenni: Yes I would want to collect them because then I would have to wait until it comes back again and if you're talking about like a season that would be like a year.

Bryan: Got it okay and then how do you feel about spending money in general whether it be on games or even software in general?

Jenni: Um, I try to be frugal. I don't really spend on excessive things but if it's something that I would need and is beneficial to my everyday life then I would spend money.

Bryan: What if it's what if you had that money like and you weren't frugal would you still spend it?

Jenni: Yeah if I use it but if it's something that I don't use then I wouldn't spend on it even if I had money.

Bryan: Okay uh what's for now based on your understanding what is like for games like the minimum you would spend, like the entry.

Jenni: Minimum, maybe a few dollars a month like five Spotify I think it's like five or six too.

Bryan: Okay what about productivity apps?

Jenni: Maybe less.

Bryan: Okay and uh if I told you these applications had a demonstration like a free trial would you still would it help change your decision on purchasing certain aspects.

Jenni: Yeah if there was like an app where a lot of people were using and then it looked interesting and helpful then I would use the free trial.

Bryan: okay thank you so that's all the questions I had uh so like I said earlier you signed the consent form and you read regarding how I may use your voice for that and uh would you like me to tell you if you if I do use it and then show you what things we use this interview for? Or

Jenni: Sure!

Bryan: Okay so thank you very much and your name is again?

Jenni: I'm Jenni

Bryan: Okay and thank you very much, bye!

2. Bronson Hua

Bryan Tran: Is it recording?

Bronson Hua: Yep, I heard it.

Bryan Tran: Okay? So all right, just to start off with. Did you do the consent form?

Bronson Hua: Yes.

Bryan Tran: Okay? So do you have any questions regarding that?

Bronson Hua: Nope. Looks good.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Alright. So the purpose of this interview is for my senior project, for at Long Beach and the software that we're making is basically a gamification of a productivity application. So think of like any I don't know, like basically Google Calendar or something, and basically add gamifying elements into that. Okay? So yeah, that's the basis. Alright. So I'm gonna

start off with, just talk a little bit about yourself. So what is your status? Are you working? Are you a student? Are you doing either?

Bronson Hua: I'm doing both student and work.

Bryan Tran: Okay.

Bronson Hua: Computer Science, Major Senior Level Senior Standing.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then how old are you?

Bronson Hua: 22.

Bryan Tran: Alright. And then how many units are you taking?

Bronson Hua: 15.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Since you said you are working, you don't have to tell me where you work. But what kind of work do you do, and then, like like, are you like office corporate? You know that kind of thing. And what is your typical work? Hours.

Bronson Hua: I'm in sales, and I work 20 h per week.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Okay. Now, I want to know more about your daily routine, your daily routine. So I guess, can you briefly describe what your normal daily routine is?

Bronson Hua: If it's a weekday.

Bronson Hua: So Monday to Thursday, it's just schoolwork.

Bronson Hua: So when we go from morning till night.

Bryan Tran: Yeah, you can do an estimate.

Bronson Hua: Alright.

Bryan Tran: What, what, how many hours I guess you would be at school, and how many hours you'd be doing homework that kind of deal.

Bronson Hua: Okay, so I'd wake up in the morning, have a morning class at 8 o'clock, and then do homework for 2 h, and then my next class would be at 1230, and then do your homework till relax, shower, do homework till dinner, and then play video games till my bedtime.

Bryan Tran: Okay

Bronson Hua: Okay you want to know about my weekends

Bryan Tran: Yeah, sure.

Bronson Hua: Weekends normally work between 4 to 8 h. So I'd squeeze homework either in the morning or at night, depending on my work schedule. That's it.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Is there? A oh, sorry. How much do you feel like you get enough sleep?

Bronson Hua: No.

Bryan Tran: How many hours?

Bronson Hua: Between 4 to 7. It fluctuates.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Okay. Next part is, is there a specific part of the day where you feel most productive? And is there? What? And then, and vice versa, which is part of the day where you find yourself struggling to focus.

Bronson Hua: Most productive would be at school between classes. I do. Homework in the library, or hors or hors horn center. least productive, would be at home when I can game.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Do you have any struggles with meeting your current goals, slash tasks, and these goals could be like what you want to do for yourself. Health, wise even education, wise.

Bronson Hua: Yeah, I feel like I could manage my time better. I feel like there's a lot I feel like that could improve.

Bryan Tran: Okay, is there anything that you use to keep track of things that you need to do? Do you use it like a planner or anything?

Bronson Hua: Yeah, I use the reminders app on my phone. I just list out the things I need to do. So I don't forget important due dates and homeworks and chores.

Bryan Tran: Okay, speaking about the reminder app, is there anything that you don't like about the reminders app that you would dislike? Like any inconveniences that you find, or anything that you think should be on there out of, like the basic necessities. If that makes sense.

Bronson Hua: I don't know.

Bryan Tran: Nothing that inconveniences you.

Bronson Hua: Let me think!

Bryan Tran: Formatting issues, buttons too small, anything like that? Or is it really well made, very intuitive for you.

Bronson Hua: Thinking. No, I think it's fine. It's fine.

Bryan Tran: That's that's that's good. That's fine. Do you think? Do you like those things that you put on the reminder app? Do you ever have things where it's like, you don't meet your goals or you don't meet your deadlines. or do you try to meet it? Basically, whenever you set it like. For example, you say you have an assignment due this Friday. Even though it's due in like 2 weeks or something. Oh, sorry you said that you want to finish the assignment by Friday, even though it's due in 2 weeks. Do you ever like to move that deadline?

Bronson Hua: Oh, yes, yes, all the time.

Bryan Tran: All the time. Okay, do you feel like you pace yourself? Well, in regards to task goals.

Bronson Hua: No, it's feel like always

Bronson Hua: save it till the last minute. Okay, so what things would motivate you or like what things motivate you to like

Bryan Tran: would actually do it? Would it be just deadlines in general?

Bronson Hua: Hmm. yeah, I think just deadlines.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Do you stress a lot about that?

Bronson Hua: Yeah, it. It depends. If it's an important class. I do. If it's a, it's an if it's an easy class stress free.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And how do you prioritize these things like, do you have a ranking of them? Or are you just on the list? And then you randomly be like, oh, I can do this, or something.

Bronson Hua: Yeah, no, no priority. I just list it out and do whatever that I feel like doing.

Bryan Tran: Got it. Okay, okay. So going on to the next set of topics. Do you? You said earlier that you use a reminder app. Is that the one built into the phone into your phone? Or is that like a 3rd party.

Bronson Hua: No, it's built into the iPhone.

Bryan Tran: Iphone. Okay? And then, do you? Or have you used any health or other productivity apps.

Bronson Hua: I use it. I have a Garmin watch.

Bryan Tran: Yeah, yeah. So does Garmin have their own software.

Bronson Hua: Yes. Yeah. Yeah. Okay. Yeah. Garvin, connect.

Bryan Tran: Do you use anything else?

Bronson Hua: Health wise?

Bryan Tran: Yeah, anything else related, if I like. I don't know how to keep track of your walking, or even your weight, or something.

Bronson Hua: No, they're just Garmin.

Bryan Tran: Just Garmin. Okay. And then how often do you use or like? Look at the Garmin application and like, does it? Do you have it just to achieve goals, or just to stay productive or stay healthy.

Bronson Hua: I check it about 3 times a day. I check my steps and the amount of sleep I get, and it tracks my heart rate. I mostly use it for my health.

Bryan Tran: Okay, like, especially if.

Bronson Hua: Sleep, because sleep is important to my health.

Bryan Tran: Okay, is there any preference or what is like your target regarding your steps, or your hiking, or your sleep?

Bronson Hua: For my stuff. I like to keep my average steps over the month. I don't really care about the day to day. I care about the monthly steps. My goal is believe, 6,000 over the month per like 6,000 per day over a month.

Bryan Tran: So that would be around 50,000.

Bronson Hua: 30 times 6.

Bryan Tran: 30,000.

Bronson Hua: 100 and 180,000.

Bryan Tran: I can do math.

Bronson Hua: Okay and asleep. I try to get at least 7 every day.

Bryan Tran: Is 7. What you want, or do you think you need more.

Bronson Hua: I think I want 8 ideally.

Bryan Tran: Yeah, okay, all right. And then, do you seek any self-improvement? And like it can be in any aspect education wise. You want to go for a higher degree? Do you want to look for another job or anything? Even health-wise? Do you want to gain weight, lose weight? Anything like that?

Bronson Hua: Yet I am looking for a new job since I graduate this spring. Fitness wise my Garmin app also keeps track of my fitness level, and that's calculated using my heart rate when I hike the amount of steps that I do daily, and it tells me if I'm training or detraining. So like my productivity levels in terms of fitness. Those are my 2 goals: career and hiking.

Bryan Tran: Hiking. Okay, do you work out outside of hiking or no?

Bronson Hua: Just hiking.

Bryan Tran: Did you used to do it, or would you like to get back into it?

Bronson Hua: Yeah, I did work out a lot back in high school. I stopped doing it because I feel like I don't have enough time. If I had more time I'd get back to working out like in the gym.

Bryan Tran: Got it. Okay? And then, by any chance, do you know your average screen time like it'd be daily or weekly.

Bronson Hua: Am I allowed to check.

Bryan Tran: Yeah, go for it.

Bronson Hua: Okay. I think it's a little inaccurate. This is 12. But it's because I leave my Youtube on like playing while I sleep. I'm going to guess.

Bryan Tran: Okay.

Bronson Hua: I would guess like 7 h.

Bryan Tran: 7 hours a day?

Bronson Hua: Yeah.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then well, I mean, you said it was Youtube. But outside of that, what do you think you spend the most time on?

Bronson Hua: It's literally just Youtube and Instagram.

Bryan Tran: Youtube and Instagram. Okay.

Bronson Hua: But Youtube, it says, 9 h. Instagram is 40 min.

Bryan Tran: The difference in those is crazy. Okay, do you use any other applications that you use or like? Do you have any other applications you use on a daily basis, like, even if it's just for, like a short amount of time, what is like? Do you open anything just to look at things, or whatever.

Bronson Hua: Stocks, email

Bryan Tran: Any other social media apps.

Bronson Hua: Oh, snapshot discord! And that should be my daily apps.

Bryan Tran: Do you play any games, whether it be mobile or on your desktop?

Bronson Hua: No mobile games, but I play on my desktop.

Bryan Tran: Okay, did. You used to play mobile.

Bronson Hua: Yeah. I played brawl stars Clash Royale on mobile. Yeah.

Bryan Tran: If you recall these games on Mobile. What kept you engaged with them? I'm assuming you stopped playing them because you either lost interest, or you had no time.

Bronson Hua: I think a mix of both, and my friends used to also play it which motivated me to play. When they stopped playing I stopped too.

Bryan Tran: Got it. Okay? And then, how much gaming do you do on average, let's say a week.

Bronson Hua: Recently, it's been a lot like 4 h per day.

Bryan Tran: 4 h per day. Okay.

Bronson Hua: Yeah.

Bryan Tran: And then how much free time do you think you have? I guess.

Bronson Hua: Does free time include my gaming time?

Bryan Tran: Whatever you consider free time for yourself.

Bronson Hua: Yeah, I'll consider gaming in my free time. So 5, 4 h.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then those video games that you play, you don't feel non-productive when you're playing it?

Bronson Hua: Oh, yeah, definitely, definitely. Yeah. Cause I feel like I could be doing homework instead of gaming or job searching.

Bryan Tran: Got it. Okay? Alright. Going on to the next topic. Do you have any frustrations regarding staying, motivated, or even organized with the things that you have to do? Do you feel like you plan your goals and your free time, and like the things that you have to do well. Do you balance it? Well.

Bronson Hua: No, I don't. I don't think so. Yeah. The answer is, no.

Bryan Tran: So you feel frustrated.

Bronson Hua: Yeah.

Bryan Tran: So that I'm assuming you also feel overwhelmed by the tasks and goals that you have to do.

Bronson Hua: Yes.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then what are some things that you did to overcome those things.

It could be like just doing it one at a time, even looking at your planner, or just making time on it a day.

Bronson Hua: See, I just try not to game.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Have you ever used any productivity apps before or like aside the ones that you are using now.

Bronson Hua: No, just just the reminders out.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Now, if I were to introduce you to combining the reminders app, and it has some elements of gamification, how would you feel about it?

Bronson Hua: I think I'd like that. It would make it keep me motivated.

Bryan Tran: Okay, do you think I'm sorry? Yeah, continue.

Bronson Hua: Yeah, I feel like it. I'd be. I'd actually achieve my goals and the task that I write.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Do you think like gamification? Well, you just answered, it could help you with motivation and productivity. And I guess my question is, what kind of elements are you looking for or like what kind of things would be in the game to be rewarding for you? And you can use things from current or past games that you've played where it's like, oh, I think if you implemented this or it was implemented in that, it would kind of be cool, or something.

Bronson Hua: I think tanks like you get points for completing a task and the more points you rack up the higher rank you get like bronze, silver, gold.

Bryan Tran: So, and then

Bronson Hua: If you pass your deadline, your rank decreases.

Bryan Tran: Okay, that's that's good.

Bronson Hua: Saying like, and if you can, if I can like, share the ranks with friends, that also we can keep each other accountable.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Do you? Since you were talking about that? Since that's literally one of my next ones. How do you feel about an Rpg type of thing?

Bronson Hua: Like, what does that mean?

Bryan Tran: So. Rp, do you know what Rpg is? Role-playing game kind of deals where you do things or you complete quests, quests would be equivalent to your tasks or goals or your deadlines, and if you complete them you would get experience. You level up.

Bronson Hua: Oh, yeah, that'd be cool.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then what kind of rewards would be motivating for you. And it can be like points, badges leveling up. Or you did say ranks, which is probably equivalent to badges, but like any other things that you can think up of.

Bronson Hua: No, I don't think so.

Bryan Tran: Okay? Then. Okay, we'll go on to the next set of questions. Do you prefer using mobile or desktop devices for gaming and productivity like which one is more convenient.

Bronson Hua: Definitely mobile.

Bryan Tran: Mobile. Okay?

Bronson Hua: Yeah. A lot more convenient.

Bryan Tran: Is that for productivity, or for both productivity and gaming? Or is it just one or the other.

Bronson Hua: Productivity like doing a homework computer.

Bryan Tran: Okay.

Bronson Hua: For gaming phones, because in my pocket.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then well, productivity? Oh, sorry. Let me rephrase that. Productivity does not mean actually doing things productivity, as in like using your productivity apps or your trackers.

Bronson Hua: Oh, phone, phone.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then gaming in general, would you prefer mobile or desktop.

Bronson Hua: Desktop.

Bryan Tran: Desktop. Okay? And then any. You said you had a Garmin watch. I'm assuming that's a smartwatch. Do you have any other ones like smart weight, or smart lights, or something like that.

Bronson Hua: Yeah, I have smart lights. I can turn it on from my phone on and off of my phone and change the colors.

Bryan Tran: Anything else? Or is that it?

Bronson Hua: no, that's it.

Bryan Tran: And you did mention earlier about having friends keeping you accountable. Do you also value competition amongst them? Amongst them.

Bronson Hua: Yeah, competition would be fun. Yeah, that would help.

Bryan Tran: And you already told me about your social media. And then okay, so now, this is gonna be about monetary based things. So how do you feel about any subscriptions, and it can be. It can be like in general, like even music games and using software or anything of that. How do you feel about subscriptions?

Bronson Hua: It'll depend, will depend on the application. If it's music like Spotify. For example, I think a subscription would make sense, because the alternative would be to buy each individual song that you want to hear.

Bronson Hua: So I think a subscription would make more sense. If it's a note taking app like for school. I would like to buy it just once and be done. I wouldn't like a subscription for that.

Bryan Tran: Okay.

Bronson Hua: Yeah.

Bryan Tran: How about for games.

Bronson Hua: Games. I'd like a 1 time payment.

Bryan Tran: One time payment. Okay? So for these. What rough pricing do you have for subscriptions or payments, or one time payments? Or is it depending.

Bronson Hua: Video game.

Bryan Tran: For example, you said you like music. And then there's a note taking app, you mean, and the games like, is it kind of depending.

Bronson Hua: Oh, yeah, like, what like? What's reasonable to me? Is that the question?

Bryan Tran: Yes, yes.

Bronson Hua: Yeah, that'll depend on the application. My note taking app was like \$7. I think that's reasonable. Spotify is like \$10 a month. Think that's reasonable.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then, how about your take on Battle pass. Do you know what a battle pass is?

Bronson Hua: Yeah, yeah, like.

Bryan Tran: A fortnite battle Pass. Okay, I liked it because.

Bronson Hua: How fortnite structured it was. You just had to buy it once and it rewards you with V. Bucks. and you can use this V. Bucks to buy the next battle pass. So it wasn't. It was. It felt like a 1 time payment to me.

Bryan Tran: Got it. And then how do you feel about it? Fomo! And like, for example, there's like a current event going on in a game or something, and then it's like a limited time. cosmetic or something that you could get. Would you feel, Fomo, if you didn't buy that? Would it encourage you, purchasing those things?

Bronson Hua: Oh, yeah, definitely.

Bryan Tran: And this does not mean real life currency. It can also mean in game currency. So you would have Fomo. You would want to do what you can to get those items.

Bronson Hua: Yes, exactly.

Bryan Tran: And then how do you feel about spending money generally on softwares or applications?

Bronson Hua: Like real money.

Bryan Tran: Yes. Real money.

Bronson Hua: I prefer it, if it's free, but if it's high quality, then a purchase would make sense.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then, if there was like a demo or something like a trial. you all where you do not have to put in your credit card information and stuff 1st at the beginning, would you think it would help with your decision on it?

Bronson Hua: Yeah, a free trial would help me, Yeah.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then so now, these are just some random questions that I just thought of. Do you have any or like game elements? What are some game elements that you like like storytelling and things like that? Do you like any of those kinds of things?

Bronson Hua: I like games with the community. okay, guilds, parties. Squads like in fortnite.

Bryan Tran: Squads. Okay?

Bronson Hua: Yeah.

Bryan Tran: Okay? Well, that concludes our interview or my interview with that. So I just want to confirm everything.

Bryan Tran: What is your name? Again?

Bronson Hua: Bronson.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And so you just made sure you did the consent form.

Bronson Hua: Yes.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then you also saw about how I may be using or this whole entire interview, and I will put it through Youtube to transcribe it and stuff you're good with that.

Bronson Hua: Yes, I'm good with it.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then do you want a copy of this interview, or anything.

Bronson Hua: Yeah.

Bryan Tran: Alright, that's it for me. Thank you.

Bronson Hua: Thank you.

3. Brian Pham

Bryan Tran: Okay. Did you hear it? Record?

Brian Pham: Yeah, I heard recordings. I guess.

Bryan Tran: Okay, so hello there. So this is gonna be an interview about my long beach senior project at Long Beach. So the product that my team is planning to create is a productivity app that is gamified. That's just a general idea of what you're getting it to understand.

Brian Pham: Yeah, okay.

Bryan Tran: So 1st off. What's your name?

Brian Pham: My name is Brian.

Bryan Tran: Okay, and then just to confirm again, did you complete the consent form that I gave to you?

Brian Pham: Yes, I filled out the consent form, and I consent to being recorded.

Bryan Tran: Okay? Alright. So let's start off with. Are you currently a student or working?

Brian Pham: I am a student and working.

Bryan Tran: Can you tell me what status you are, or tell me a little bit about what you do? You don't have to get too much detail.

Brian Pham: Oh, I'm a grad student, and I worked as a TA and student researcher.

Bryan Tran: Okay. What? Major?

Brian Pham: Electrical Engineering.

Bryan Tran: Okay and then you said, you're not working correctly.

Brian Pham: I I guess that we're talking about industry. No, and we're talking about academia. And then yes.

Bryan Tran: Okay, got it? Alright, so that's what I needed from that. And then could you briefly describe your daily routine?

Brian Pham: Well, like school day, or just in general.

Bryan Tran: You can do both a school, and then we can.

Brian Pham: Okay, weekend. It's just studying and working on my research. Relaxing not much on the weekends. But for weekdays I did wake up at like 10, go to school at 12, go to class, and work out, come back, go to class again, go home at 9:45. That's 1 day, Wednesday pretty much the same thing, except I'm working from maybe 6 to 8, and then Friday. I'm a TA from like pretty much 8 o'clock to 5 Pm. And I stick around to like 8 to keep working.

Bryan Tran: That's crazy. Okay, is there a specific part of these days where you feel the most productive.

Brian Pham: Honestly, whenever I'm in the lab, just because we have, like some pretty big monitors, maybe like 48 inch monitors, or it's pretty big. So I feel productive when I'm on that.

Bryan Tran: Okay, what part of the day is that hour wise like is it? During the day, like afternoon, evening.

Brian Pham: It could vary, but for the most part it would be late afternoon into the evening.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then, is there a part of the day where you find yourself struggling to be productive?

Brian Pham: Oh. maybe when I get home, but that's just me being tired, or in the morning I would say in the morning before going to school.

Bryan Tran: Okay, do you use anything to track your daily routine, or like daily tasks? You gotta do or like to keep track of your agenda.

Brian Pham: I either use a calendar app like the one on outlook, or I would just use a notepad and just jot down whatever I need to do for the week.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then for now, is it challenging for you to balance your different goals and tasks that you have on a day-to-day basis. And if you do what makes it difficult.

Brian Pham: I would say in general, I don't think it's that hard to balance my task, but as of recently I have a midterm coming up Monday, and then I have to

Brian Pham: showcase some projects, for like a donor. So right now it's stressful. But in general not really. Oh, what was the rest of the question, how do I.

Bryan Tran: And what makes it difficult.

Brian Pham: I guess just the amount of commitments that I have to do like. I have to keep up with my studies. I have to do a lot of gradings. I am behind on grading right now, I guess. Yeah, that's pretty much it. There's others activities I have to do.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then like, these things that you have to do weekly or daily. And how do you prioritize it? Do you create like a mental thing? Or do you do whatever's the deadline that is soonest? Do you wait? What's the hardest, or whatever? Or do you just like to spread it out like, tell me your approach, and how you prioritize your tasks.

Brian Pham: I guess I would prioritize in terms of starters. So if I have to do something like an assignment that's graded. I'm gonna focus on doing that instead of greeting because of the assignments I'm grading. I don't think the students need to get it back that early. They get it back relatively quickly. But it's not that important, in my opinion, with what they're doing and how it reflects their midterms and stuff. So I just go based on priority and I guess, based on the priority of the professors like, if they want something graded sooner, then, of course, I will do that. Or if the students want me to grade something faster, then I'll do that. But for the most part it's 1st anything that relates to grades and then I guess my research next, and then grading after.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then without including your academia things, how about your own personal goals like you said earlier that you went to the gym, or whatever is that just you doing that? So you can move around like, are there any other outside goals that you want to reach.

Brian Pham: Good question. Yeah, I totally forgot about Jim. But definitely. That is one of the things that I like getting in shape is one of my goals. I do that. I try to do that 3 times a week, but it's not really a priority if I'm too focused on other things. But if I have time, which for the most part I do have time, I would do that outside of the gym. I wouldn't say I really have any other priorities. Maybe just studying. I'm not too sure.

Bryan Tran: Okay. So I'm assuming at the moment you're not really looking to get a job or anything like that. You're just focusing on.

Brian Pham: Oh, oh, oh, yeah, I sorry I have an internship lined up for summer. So I'm not. I'm not looking anywhere. Yeah.

Bryan Tran: Got it. Okay, that's good to know. Okay, okay. Now, I'm going to go to the next topic. So speaking of the calendar that you use. You said, that's the one built into outlook.

Correct? Okay. Do you use any other ones?

Brian Pham: Not really. No.

Bryan Tran: Have you ever used any other ones, or have you just used them on outlook?

Brian Pham: I might have used the Google Calendar, but then I just stopped using that one to use the outlook one.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then how about health apps? Do you use any of that? Like to keep track of your health?

Brian Pham: I used to maybe use one to track my calories and want to track my mood, but as of now, I'm not actively using any apps.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Do you mind telling me what those apps were called? If you remember.

Brian Pham: I've no clue. What the calorie tracker one was but the moods. One was called E. Moods.

Bryan Tran: Okay.

Brian Pham: Kind of display. How I'm feeling for that specific date.

Bryan Tran: Okay? Just just a random question, do you? Are you Android or Ios?

Brian Pham: Injured, or what.

Bryan Tran: Ios apple or android.

Brian Pham: Oh, oh, oh! It's iOS or android! I am Ios.

Bryan Tran: You're Ios. Do. Do you ever use the health app on it?

Brian Pham: I use it every now and then, just to look at how many steps I did for the day. But

Bryan Tran: Got it.

Brian Pham: Not that often.

Bryan Tran: Do you have any goals for the amount of steps you want per day?

Brian Pham: Probably not. It's pretty low cause, for the most part I'm not walking that far.

Bryan Tran: Okay, do you mind telling me what's your current average right now?

Brian Pham: Yeah, let me check real quick. Alright! How do I see the average? Oh, the average for the week is 4,000 steps.

Bryan Tran: Okay now that you do know that I mean, I'm not sure if you thought about it. Do you ever think about: Oh, I kind of want to reach these steps. Have you ever done that before in the past?

Brian Pham: I'm not because I felt like when you're doing stem. There's definitely like, health is important. But I think focusing on just your courses and stuff is more important, so I don't really consider it.

Bryan Tran: Okay, that's right. Okay. Now, going back to those apps that you use. How affected do you think they are in helping you achieve your goals or to stay productive.

Brian Pham: So for the calorie tracking one. I thought it was pretty good for achieving the amount of calories that I need, because the problem is, I'm not eating enough, so I need to track how much I eat. So I think doing that helped me gain a decent amount of weight. But I ended up just not using it. And I just didn't count calories anymore. I just ate and ate, I just kept on eating for the mood one, I've rarely used it. I use it to track my mood for like a week. And then I was like. I don't need this. I'm gonna just go with it and hope for the best.

Bryan Tran: Got it. Okay? So in regards to your calorie tracking. Do you have an idea why you stopped using it? Is it because you just felt like you got your goal out of eating enough, or anything like that? Or do you just not have time? Or do you just not have time, or you didn't care about putting in calories anymore.

Brian Pham: I felt like when I was tracking it. It helped because I'm able to count like I'm able to like, estimate how much I had, but then it got to the point where I was doing like every single

food item, I would just track it and then like if I didn't know it. I'd like to look it up. And then I thought it was just kind of getting like a waste of time.

Bryan Tran: Tedious for you.

Brian Pham: Yeah, it's a little tedious, for sure.

Bryan Tran: Okay, and then well, going on with things that are tedious. You said one of the things that you used to keep track of your tasks was the Outlook calendar. Are there any?

Bryan Tran: Is there anything on that app that has? Do you have anything that you don't like about it?

Brian Pham: Honestly, not really cause I just have it there to plan on my schedule, so I'll know what I have to do.

Brian Pham: It's very the way I use it. It's very bare as in. I'm not diving too much into the functions they have, because I just don't. I didn't bother to look.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Now, how do you feel? Well, I think you said earlier that your current productivity is pretty. Okay. It's just your midterms coming up. So I guess you're a little bit stressed about that right.

Brian Pham: Yep. Yep.

Bryan Tran: So how about in general? Do you have any struggles with meeting your goals or tasks?

Brian Pham: I would. I'll meet them in general. I would definitely say I struggle because it's kind of like when I'm hitting academic tasks or physical tasks, it's kind of like a spur in the moment or definitely with academic tests. Cause I'm gonna have a lot of downtime. I'm just not doing anything. And then at some point, I'm just gonna realize that I need to start doing it. So it's not consistent like productivity is more like low energy, random spike of high energy and then back to low, so I definitely think I could be more productive.

Bryan Tran: Got it. Okay? And then, based on your perspective, do you feel like you're self-disciplined in meeting your deadlines or are deadlines your motivator?

Brian Pham: I would say, deadlines are definitely a motivator. I'm kind of self disciplined, but not enough. It's a weird deadline. Yeah. And I'll just say, deadlines are more important.

Bryan Tran: Okay. So you're basically saying, like the closer it is to the deadline, the more productive you would feel.

Brian Pham: Yeah, for sure.

Bryan Tran: Okay, got it alright. And then, based on these like things that you realize yourself, do you? Do you want to improve yourself in any of these aspects like increasing your productivity, making it more consistent, or anything like that?

Brian Pham: Oh, yeah, definitely, I think increasing productivity like having something done like the day, like the day of the deadline, feels pretty bad. I would prefer to have it done, maybe a couple of days before the deadline. But that's usually with, like, I think, on assignments, I'm pretty good, but like other stuff like grading research, whatever. It definitely could be better.

Bryan Tran: Okay, so is time management an issue for you then?

Brian Pham: Honestly, yeah, for sure.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Now, this is also a random question. What is your average screen time?

Brian Pham: On the phone or in general.

Bryan Tran: Let's say on your phone, and then I guess in general.

Brian Pham: Okay. In general, it'd probably be like 14 hours a day, just because I have to keep looking at a monitor and on my phone. Oh, my phone's pretty high, maybe like 6 h, one sec.

Maybe like 7 h, 7, 8 h. But a lot of that is just playing like a game and not looking at the phone.

Bryan Tran: Got it. Okay? Well, while you have your phone now.

Bryan Tran: What app do you spend the most time on?

Brian Pham: Discord, Youtube, yeah. Those are like, top 2, Tiktok.

Bryan Tran: Sure.

Brian Pham: Instagram.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then you also said the game on your phone. What was that?

Brian Pham: That one's at like. There's like 6 of them where I just like afk for like 30 min. Cause I'm trying to go on a Vegas trip. So I just afk these random games to get points for that collectively.

Bryan Tran: Okay, okay, so it's like one of those games where, like, you just do things. And then the longer you play, you get points, and then you change into money, or rewarded, or something.

Brian Pham: Yeah, yeah, exactly. That might add up to 15%.

Bryan Tran: 15% got it. Okay.

Brian Pham: Yeah.

Bryan Tran: Are those games like? Do you? Did you find that from a 3rd party application? Do you mind telling me where you found those games that allow you to do that?

Brian Pham: Yeah. So I was looking into how to make a Vegas trip cheaper. And I just found this guy who said you could get reports or rewards. So I went to Google, downloaded those games. And I just run it in the back room when I'm doing other things.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Do you know what those games are called?

Brian Pham: Yeah, we have Mgm, slots. Live, my Vegas, and pop slots.

Bryan Tran: Got it. Okay, that's good to know. Alright, alright going to the next one. So those applications I use are the ones that are kind of high in the list. What keeps you engaged in using them?

Brian Pham: Honestly, procrastination is putting off doing the work I should be doing.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then how much free time do you think you have in general.

Brian Pham: With or without like, if I just in general, or if I wanted to use those apps.

Bryan Tran: What considers free time to you. So I guess, even if you procrastinate, or whatever. But you consider that still free time, then you can count that as free time.

Brian Pham: Honestly, anytime I'm using these apps is probably considered free time cause if I were to like not use these apps, I'd probably say 4 hours a day that I could do something else with.

Bryan Tran: Okay, so would you? So I guess, using those apps during your quote unquote, free time, I'm assuming you would feel a little bit more negative towards that, because you're kind of procrastinating.

Brian Pham: Yeah, definitely, because I think it's like, I'm losing sleep. Cause it's like, I'm on the phone before I go to bed.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Oh, speaking of sleep, how much average do you get?

Brian Pham: I would say, on average, maybe 7 h, as of last night, maybe like 3.

Bryan Tran: Okay, got it. And do you feel like deadlines approach? You have less sleep.

Brian Pham: Oh, yeah, definitely.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And so in your free time, you said, you go on those apps, which is what you just said. And then what if it's like you, for example, you have no deadlines at all, and then you have a bunch of free time. What's the 1st thing you would do?

Brian Pham: No deadlines, free time. Honestly, if I'm at home, I'll probably be on those apps, or like watching Youtube, or just talking to people. If I'm at school, then I'll just be doing my research. I think the environment plays a pretty big role in my productivity as well.

Bryan Tran: Okay, okay, do you play any video games?

Brian Pham: I stopped playing video games.

Bryan Tran: Oh, okay.

Brian Pham: Maybe like 2, 3 hours a week, but that would all be done in one day.

Bryan Tran: Got it. I'm assuming you didn't feel productive when you were playing those games.

Brian Pham: Yeah, I thought they were too time consuming. And it got to the point where I didn't enjoy playing those games just because I knew I had other things to do.

Bryan Tran: Got it. Okay. Alright, that's good to know. All right. Next topic, almost done halfway. In terms of staying productive or organized, or keeping track of your things. What are the most frustrating things that you have that you notice for yourself?

Brian Pham: Can you repeat that question one more time.

Bryan Tran: So, yeah, let me rephrase that. So what are the frustrating aspects of staying productive or organized to you?

Brian Pham: Oh, okay, I think, since I don't know, I am kind of schedule wise. I kind of go with the flow kind of not really. Oh, I don't know. I don't really know how to answer this question to be honest.

Bryan Tran: Okay, we can skip it if you want.

Brian Pham: Sorry. Can you say it? One more time?

Bryan Tran: Yeah, okay, let me let me rephrase it better. Okay. So in terms of staying productive. what is frustrating to you, if you don't stay productive like. Do you just feel like you're not going to get anything done? Your life is over. You're not going to get anywhere, you know those kinds of things.

Brian Pham: Oh, yeah, if I'm not productive. Then obviously, I feel like I have poor results when I'm not productive. I'm gonna like, beat myself up over that. But then it's like, turn it on me because I'm not being that productive. So it's kinda I guess the negative impacts would be poor results or just bad feeling in general kind of like. I could have done better, but I didn't.

Bryan Tran: Got it. Okay. So do you often in general, do you often feel overwhelmed by the things that you need to do?

Brian Pham: I would say, kinda kinda gnarly.

Bryan Tran: One to 10. How are you?

Brian Pham: Maybe like a 6.

Bryan Tran: Maybe like 6. Okay, I guess right now or before. Are there any methods that you do to keep yourself productive or motivated?

Brian Pham: Best method is to force myself to go to school and just be on campus, because I think that would just help me be more productive.

Bryan Tran: So would you say, like your environment would help.

Brian Pham: But yeah, yeah.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then, so I guess it's kind of going towards more of the fun things that I got that I want you to answer or the fun questions. So what would make, for example, let's say, the Outlook calendar. What would make it more easier or enjoyable for you to use it? Do you have any ideas like: Oh, I kind of wish I had this thing, or be like oh, I wish I can easily change the theme or the colors, or Oh, I wish I can make it appear on my, I don't know watch or computer, or or something.

Brian Pham: Honestly, I don't really think anything would make it better, because I just have it there to remind me if I have to go to a meeting or something. Most of like my remembering, though, would just be on a notepad right just jot down Tuesday meeting Wednesday. Proctored, or something.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Well, is your notepad like a physical notepad? Or is it like what you do on an ipad or something?

Brian Pham: I have it on my laptop.

Bryan Tran: Your laptop.

Bryan Tran: Okay, got it. And do you just use like notepad or something?

Brian Pham: Literally the notepad app, and if I don't use the notepad app, I'll just have it in my mind, and hopefully I don't forget.

Bryan Tran: Alright got it. So, as I said earlier in the beginning, what we're trying to build is combining a productivity app and gamifying it. How do you feel about this idea?

Brian Pham: Honestly as a person that played a lot of games. I think it would be pretty fun to do.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Do you think this could help with motivation and productivity in general?

Brian Pham: I think so. As long as I guess, setting up the productivity goals is pretty straightforward and easy. Like as in I don't have to do a lot of tweaks to you know what I mean. I don't know.

Bryan Tran: Yeah, so kind of like, you don't want to spend too much time into it, in a way, but just make it where it's easy and intuitive for you.

Brian Pham: Yeah, yeah. Like the setup for making my goals on an app.

Bryan Tran: Got it. Okay. And then, this is kind of going towards your gaming side. Since you just said you played a lot, what kind of rewards would be motivating for you. So it doesn't have to be like literal rewards, like loot boxes or anything. But it could be it could also be like leveling up cosmetics badges, rankings, social aspects, etc.

Brian Pham: Yeah, so I, it's really hard to like pinpoint. One exact thing, because I played a bunch and they all had different things like leveling is one. So you play like tft, then ranks are another thing. If you played like an Mmo. Then it's based on improving your own stats honestly. Saying that out loud, I think, improving my own stats like, say, turning my actual real life person into like an in app character or something, and then like, if I study more, I get plus one intelligence or something.

Bryan Tran: Okay.

Brian Pham: Something like that. But I think there's many different things that keep me interested.

Bryan Tran: Okay and then. So now I'm gonna ask you gaming wise. But I do know you said you stopped. But if you were to go back again. Would you prefer gaming on mobile devices or desktop devices?

Brian Pham: I would prefer desktop.

Bryan Tran: Desktop. Okay? And then how about for productivity applications? Would you prefer mobile or desktop?

Brian Pham: I guess it would kind of depend, because I prefer both. If I had some type of productivity where, like Mobile and desktop, were synced up. So if I'm not like looking at my phone, I'm looking at my desktop.

Bryan Tran: Yeah, convenience for you. Okay, so what if these 2 things were combined? Would you feel like you would also prefer having it on both mobile and desktop.

Brian Pham: Yeah, yeah.

Bryan Tran: Alright. So now, this is a random question. Do you have any smart devices? Yeah, like, outside of your smartphone? Obviously.

Brian Pham: I have an ipad.

Bryan Tran: Ipad. Okay, do you have a smartwatch?

Brian Pham: No, I don't.

Bryan Tran: Do you use any is, do you have like you're a smart house, or whatever do you have like lights that you control with your phone? Do you have a weight that connects to your phone with Bluetooth and keeps track of stuff? Anything like that.

Brian Pham: No, I just have a phone, an iPad, earbuds, and a laptop.

Bryan Tran: Got it. Okay so now, this is kind of a little bit related to what we're trying to implement. But do you value competition against your peers or anyone around you?

Brian Pham: Competition.

Bryan Tran: It can be in general. It doesn't. It can be about anything.

Brian Pham: Yeah, I guess I kind of value competition, but not so much of my peers. I mean, I guess some peers were like, if you know, someone's really cracked, you're gonna want to be like, okay, I'm trying to get on that level. But I guess yeah, I would say I do value competition.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then you already told me, or what things you use to socialize. But do you mind telling me that again?

Brian Pham: I'm sorry what things to socialize with.

Bryan Tran: Yeah, what? What applications do you use to socialize?

Brian Pham: Right. Mostly discord?

Bryan Tran: Mostly discord. Okay, yeah, alright.

Bryan Tran: Okay. So in gaming wise or even productivity applications, how do you feel about subscriptions?

Brian Pham: Subscriptions. I am pretty. I guess it kind of depends on the subscription.

Personally, I don't pay for subscriptions, because I think if there's an alternative to doing it, then I'd rather do that.

Bryan Tran: Okay are, do you currently have any subscriptions to anything.

Brian Pham: I do not.

Bryan Tran: You do not. Okay. And then how do you feel about a battle pass?

Brian Pham: I think those I did. I did buy some battle passes. I honestly have like for the most part, positive opinions on it, because generally if you put in the time and effort, you'll get more rewards than what you would actually get if you like. Say you spend \$10 on a battle pass, you'll probably get like, \$30 worth of stuff. So yeah, I think battle passes are cool.

Bryan Tran: Okay. So I guess it's more like it's, it's nice to have. If you're actually going to spend time in whatever it's on.

Brian Pham: If I find it valuable.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then do you have any FOMOs, sorry, does Fomo encourage any purchases? It doesn't have to involve real life money? But it could also be in game, money.

Brian Pham: Oh, I would say yes trying to remember off the top of my head. I obviously, Yeah.

Bryan Tran: Okay. So for example, there's an event or something. They came out with something really cool and like, you really want it to buy that. Would you?.

Brian Pham: In terms of buying, maybe. I don't know how to explain it. But we can just say, yeah.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then, in general, how do you feel about spending money on software?

Brian Pham: On software.

Bryan Tran: To you.

Brian Pham: I don't remember. I did find a \$10 game, so I guess you could count that. But before I don't think I bought any software or anything like that.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Now, if there was a demo, Would it help you with your decision on making that purchase?

Brian Pham: Yeah, like a free trial. I would say, Yeah.

Bryan Tran: Okay, okay, well, that's all I got. So thank you for letting me interview you. So what's your name again?

Brian Pham: My name is Brian.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And my name is also Bryan. Anyways. So once again, I'm probably going to upload this to Youtube to help it transcribe. Would you like me to sign a copy to you?

Brian Pham: Not. Really. I mean, I just prefer the video be unlisted or private. That's it.

Bryan Tran: Yeah, it will be. Yeah, yeah, it will be. Only we won't even use your voice. Maybe we might use your voice, but.

Brian Pham: Okay, okay, honestly, yes. Let me get the link.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Got it? Alright. Thank you. That'll be all.

Brian Pham: Yeah. Take care.

4. Tina Tran

Bryan Tran: Hello! Okay. So just to make sure, did you fill out the consent form that I sent you?

Tina: Yep.

Bryan Tran: You have any questions about it?

Tina: No.

Bryan Tran: Okay? So my project is based on gamifying a productivity app. So if you know any productivity apps, imagine having game-like elements on it. So the purpose of this interview is to get information about what my team wants to implement. So let's just start off with you. Are you currently a student? Are you working? Are you both

Tina: I'm currently a student

Bryan Tran: Okay, what's your status?

Tina: Undergrad

Bryan Tran: Okay. What year are you?

Tina: I'm technically a second year.

Bryan Tran: Okay. How many units are you currently checking

Tina: 12

Bryan Tran: Okay. And what, Major, are you

Tina: Biology.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And what is your typical workload per week?

Tina: Like in terms of hours.

Bryan Tran: Yes.

Tina: Per week, Around 10-15 hours.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then, could you briefly describe your daily routine

Tina: Daily routine like on a school day or weekend

Bryan Tran: Let's do both

Tina: So on a school day I wake up, get ready, go to school and then I come home, eat dinner, do some homework, and then I go to sleep. And then on the weekend, I wake up. I sometimes have plans with friends during the weekends. I wake up, get ready for the plans, and then I come home, and then I study a little bit, and then I'll go to sleep

Bryan Tran: Okay, is there any specific part of the day where you feel that you're the most productive

Tina: Probably at night, like right before going to bed.

Bryan Tran: Okay, is there a part of the day where you don't find yourself productive, and you struggle to focus on whatever things you need to do?

Tina: As soon as I wake up. I like to kind of rot in bed for a little bit.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then do you do anything to track your daily routine

Tina: I do journal like I like write down that my tasks for the day sometimes

Bryan Tran: Okay. And is that on like a notebook or on your phone

Tina: It's not a notebook

Bryan Tran: On a notebook. Okay, have you always done that?

Tina: No.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then, when you're trying to balance different goals and tasks on a day-to-day basis, is it challenging for you

Tina: Not really no.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then how do you prioritize your tasks throughout the week?

Tina: I guess whatever's I prioritize, based on due dates, because most of my workload is kind of like schoolwork. So the tasks I prioritize will be things that are like due sooner or like the bigger projects that are due soon

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then what about like outside of academia. Do you have any responsibilities or self goals?

Tina: Yourself?

Bryan Tran: Like self things you want to do, like health, wise, like socializing.

Tina: Oh.

Tina: I try to do chores every week like every weekend. I like to help around the house, and then I've been trying to go to the gym more like around 3 times a week, sometimes more. Most of my socializing I do at like school, or at like directly after school

Bryan Tran: Okay onto the next set of questions. So do you have or do you currently have any health applications like to keep track of how or anything

Tina: Not really

Bryan Tran: Okay, what about productivity apps?

Tina: Apps. I used Notion in the past. I think I've also used Google Calendar, but they haven't really stuck. That's why I've switched to like notebook journal

Bryan Tran: Okay. Do you ever even look at your steps, or anything, or like the amount of sleep you do, or anything?

Tina: No, I don't really look at those

Bryan Tran: Okay, how effective. So like you said Notion, you said it didn't really stick with you. How effective did it help you in achieving your goals when you did use it?

Tina: I guess not really cause I kinda used it more as like a habit tracker kind of thing

Bryan Tran: What do you mean by a habit tracker?

Tina: Like if I wanted to do something. and then if I did it, I'd like to say, on my notion, you know, like, Hey, I did. This is today

Bryan Tran: I see. Okay. And then, do you have any struggles with meeting goals or tasks?

Tina: Not really

Bryan Tran: Do you stress about them?

Tina: Not really no.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then, as of now, how? How do you feel like your current productivity is

Tina: I think it's okay, since I'm not taking that many classes right now, that's been manageable

Bryan Tran: Okay? How about like, when you were taking a lot of classes? How did you feel about that?

Tina: I felt like I was surviving

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then do you seek self-improvement? And it doesn't necessarily have to be academically wise. It could also be health-wise, career-wise. Anything like that.

Tina: Go to the gym more so I kind of suck at doing that.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Anything else?

Tina: Not really

Bryan Tran: Okay? So you said, you did work out. So what? How do you rate your activity levels?

Tina: What is the rate?

Bryan Tran: Like, what do you think your activity level is like? Do you feel like you're fit? Do you like, If I were to tell you to go on a run right now, would you be able to do it? Do you get out of breath?

Tina: I think so. I think on a scale like on a scale from one to 10. I think I'm like around 7 in terms of activeness

Bryan Tran: Okay, how about your sleep? Do you feel like you get enough sleep

Tina: Most days.

Bryan Tran: Okay, how many hours.

Tina: I try to get at least 6 or 7 h

Bryan Tran: 6 or 7. So is that what you want, or would you prefer to get more?

Tina: I mean, I'm okay with it for right now

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then what is your average screen time? You can check.

Tina: I will check right now around 6 h

Bryan Tran: Okay? And if you did not have your phone, would you feel like you would have more productivity?

Tina: Probably

Bryan Tran: Okay. And since you have your phone. Now, what app do you spend the most time on? Name me like your top 5, and the amount of time

Tina: I have Instagram at 2 h spotify at around 2 h. Hmm on my photos. App for about an hour and then every, and then Webtoon for about an hour and everything else is like around 1 min, 2 min.

Bryan Tran: Got it. Okay. Well, these applications that you use, what keeps you using them? Like, what do they give you that keep you engaged

Tina: Entertainment

Bryan Tran: Okay, which apps provide you those?

Tina: Webtoon, Instagram. That's basically all.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then how much feed time? Do you think you have?

Tina: Like per week

Bryan Tran: Sure.

Tina: I typically keep an entire day free during the weekends. So like, maybe around 30 h

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then what do you usually spend your free time doing

Tina: I play piano. I sometimes do some of my hobbies. Yeah.

Bryan Tran: Okay, and do you play any video games

Tina: Hmm! I've played Stardew Valley for a while.

Bryan Tran: Okay, and any mobile games or anything

Tina: Mobile games. I play a pokemon trading card game.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then when you do play these video games, or if you do, do you feel productive when you're playing those games? Or do you feel non-productive?

Tina: I don't play them as much anymore since I'm in school and everything I have like exams like a lot of exams. So I kind of only play them when I do have free time

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then, do you have any problems staying productive or organized?

Tina: And probably being organized

Bryan Tran: Okay, what is the most frustrating aspect of being organized to you?

Tina: When I'm studying or something. Sometimes my desk is, like, really messy. There's like papers everywhere and there's like a lot going on with like a bunch of different subjects. So it kind of feels a bit cluttered

Bryan Tran: Okay, do you feel overwhelmed by your tasks or goals?

Tina: Not really no.

Bryan Tran: And then what if, like you said, you're having problems with staying organized sometimes. Do you ever feel overwhelmed about that?

Tina: Yes.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then, are there any challenges you had, like trying to self-improve yourself on this aspect?

Tina: I guess. Just trying to keep my desk kind of tidy

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then what are some challenges or frustrations you've experienced with any productivity, tools or methods that you are currently using? Or you have used in the past

Tina: I guess, like most of the time when I was trying to update my journals and stuff like that, I found it. I found that I was too lazy. Just update it so I would go like probably weeks, without even touching it, like touching the apps, or like even my journal

Bryan Tran: Okay. So you feel like sometimes you would get lazy

Tina: Yeah.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Does it feel tedious to you

Tina: Yeah. Sometimes.

Bryan Tran: Okay. If it was like that, I don't know. It had elements that were kind of interesting and made it pop out. Would you consider using those tools more

Tina: Yeah.

Bryan Tran: And what would those things be to make it easier or more enjoyable to use? Give me some ways that you would like to see. It can be as random as you want. Be as creative.

Tina: I guess like, if you incorporate like a little game thingy like some kind of reward system

Bryan Tran: Okay, is there anything else like this? I don't know if pictures randomly popping up or anything like. You can see other people studying things like that.

Tina: I guess seeing other people studying would help like, maybe, like incorporate like a little music section like have like a lot of productivity kind of elements

Bryan Tran: Okay. What do you mean by music?

Tina: Like I'm thinking of, like the Lo-fi kind of music like when I'm studying, I go to Youtube and find, like a little study playlist to listen to. It'd be nice if I had that in the same spot as like my like to do tasks.

Bryan Tran: Got it. And then how do you feel about the idea of combining productivity and gamification

Tina: I think it'd be fun

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then do you think it could help you with motivation and productivity? It doesn't have to be. You specifically

Tina: I guess it would depend on the game type

Bryan Tran: Okay. Could you tell me why?

Tina: I've used some kind of fun product productivity apps in the past, and it was like, complete these tasks and get rewarded with like a little bit of like coins, or whatever to spend on the game aspect of the app and I just I kind of liked it at first, but I kinda got too lazy to continue with it, because it took too much effort.

Bryan Tran: Do you remember what that was called?

Tina: I don't know

Bryan Tran: So was it like a productivity app, or was it just like a whole on game?

Tina: I guess it was catered more towards productivity rather than games. It was just like a little reward system to of being productive

Bryan Tran: Okay so, did you feel like it was tedious or something to the point where you just didn't want to use it anymore?

Tina: I think it's just my attention span is really bad.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then, if there was to be something, what kind of things would be motivating for you? So there could be a point system, reward system, badges, leveling up social aspects. Things like that?

Tina: Maybe the leveling up in social aspects

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then do you prefer using mobile or desktop for gaming

Tina: Hmm. I don't really have a preference, either.

Bryan Tran: Okay, how about for productivity

Tina: Productivity. Hmm, I guess phone, since it's always with me

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then do you own any smart devices

Tina: Yes, I do.

Bryan Tran: What are they?

Tina: I have a phone. I have a laptop and a tablet

Bryan Tran: Okay, do you have any like smart weights, smart lights, smart anything like smart doorbell, smart fan

Tina: Oh. I've kind of automated my entire room. So, like all my lights, I can control them from my phone.

Bryan Tran: Okay? And then well, do these things help contribute to your daily routine or productivity?

Tina: I set timers on them, so they turn on and turn off at specific times.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Do you mind telling me what time you have it set at and like, what's the purpose of those times?

Tina: I don't really turn on my lights during the daytime, because most of the time I'm not really home and I usually use natural lighting if I do want light in my room. So I turn on my lights in the evening, around 6, like around 4 to 6 pm. And then I turned it off around 1:00 AM.

Bryan Tran: Okay, one am. Okay. What time do you usually sleep?

Tina: Around 2 Am.

Bryan Tran: What time do you usually wake up

Tina: I wake up at different times, depending on the day, so like on the weekends, I'll sleep in until maybe 11 but on the weekdays I either wake up around 8 Am. For my morning class, or either or around 11 for my afternoon class.

Bryan Tran: Okay: And then do you value competition against other people?

Tina: Hmm. I'm not a very competitive person, so not really

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then what things do you do to socialize

Tina: I guess I just like hanging out with my friends at maybe the mall sometimes at their house.

Sometimes we'll go eat at restaurants. Kind of thing, little regular hangout spots

Bryan Tran: Okay, do you use social media or games, or anything like that, too?

Tina: I just use social media

Bryan Tran: Okay? And what were, what are the main ones?

Tina: It's kind of just Instagram and I guess discord sometimes. But I'm not as active on discord

Bryan Tran: Okay, and then do you have any subscriptions to anything

Tina: Good notes, It's like a note taking app, and I guess the gym oh, and spotify

Bryan Tran: Okay. How much is how much do you pay for those

Tina: The gym is around 20 to \$30 a month. Spotify I don't really remember how much a month, but I think it's around \$10 a month, and goodnotes I think that was also \$15 a month. Yeah, I can't remember exactly

Bryan Tran: Okay. Do you know what a battle pass is?

Tina: I do not.

Bryan Tran: Okay. So a battle pass is basically a game element where. Like, normally, you level up and then you get rewards right and then a battle pass is basically you can level up faster, but you also get more rewards. But typically you have to buy the battle pass? Does that make sense?

Tina: Yes.

Bryan Tran: Okay, what is your take on that.

Tina: I guess I don't really have too much of an opinion on it.

Bryan Tran: Okay. But if you were to want more rewards, would you buy that battle? Pass

Tina: Probably not. I don't really like spending money on a lot of things

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then, since you said that, does FOMO encourage purchases? It doesn't have to be real life money. It can also be like in game currencies, or anything like that.

Tina: Not really no.

Bryan Tran: So like if there is like a Christmas event or something with limited time items or cosmetics, you wouldn't work towards trying to get those?

Tina: If it was like a subscription, or like a game, or something like that, probably not. But if it was like a tangible item, then maybe

Bryan Tran: Got it. Okay. And then how do you feel about spending money on software or applications in general?

Tina: I don't do it as much.

Tina: I guess I just never really have a reason to spend on softwares and stuff

Bryan Tran: Okay. If you were, though, how much would you spend on average? And there can be different categories of software or applications, too.

Tina: It depends on how much it would do if it was like a simple game. I don't think I'd be willing to spend more than like \$5. But it was like an entire productivity app, like my goodnotes. I'd be willing to spend as much if I needed it.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then, if there are some free trials or demonstrations, would it help you with the decision on it?

Tina: Probably not really.

Bryan Tran: Okay. Would you ever have the idea to even try it if you were introduced? It

Tina: Maybe

Bryan Tran: Okay, well, that was the interview. So I appreciate you for letting me interview you. So I just wanna do this again. You completed the consent form?

Tina: Yeah.

Bryan Tran: Okay. And then your name again is

Tina: I'm Tina

Bryan Tran: Okay? And so I'm just gonna transcribe this right now. Do you want me to send the link to Youtube at the end?

Tina: No, that's okay.

Bryan Tran: Alright. Thank you.

Tina: Bye-bye.

Brady:

1. Marie Wingo

Brady: hello

Marie: hi there

Brady: hi so just uh formality real quick you answered the um poll that we sent to confirm that you're okay with us recording you right

Marie: yeah

Brady: okay good so we'll start off with just some preliminary questions to get to know you better um what's your status for work and are you going to school uh currently

Marie: I am a proctor at an elementary school and um yes I am enrolled

Brady: and what were you going to school for

Marie: uh I'm currently going to school for visual arts and um Child Development

Brady: nice good to know good to know um may I ask uh what your daily routine looks like for you um on your normal work days

Marie: uh well for my work day I basically just wake up get ready for work and then go to work and um the thing about being a proctor is that it's very part-time so I don't have to be there for a whole day unless I'm asked specifically but um I use an app on my phone to clock in and clock out because for some reason it's not like a traditional like normal job for say so I just track my hours like that and then when I'm off I come back home and I just relax for the rest of the day

Brady: okay sounds good sounds good um how would you say how many hours is the typical work day for you

Marie: three and that's three

Brady: and when you're doing school um how many hours do you usually expect to do for school work every single day

Marie: uh for school work uh two and a half hours

Brady: okay uh was there a specific part of the day where you feel most productive or is there a part of the day where you find yourself struggling to focus

Marie: um to be to answer honestly the time of day that I feel most productive is when I'm in the middle of my shift at being a proctor because I have my attention is on the students and uh even though I'm working and like I told you prior I do use an app to clock my hours in while I'm working I have no other use for my phone so I just keep it in my back pocket

Brady: okay that's good um do you track your daily routine

Marie: I will be honest no no I do not

Brady: okay um let's see

Brady: do you think that it can be challenging trying to balance different goals and tasks on the day-to-day basis

Marie: yes yes it can what makes that difficult uh like for example when I get home then I try my best to do my homework but sometimes I just want to take a break for myself and sometimes I lose check of time and even when I use the timer on my phone it does really cut it out for me

Brady: Hm interesting that's good to know how do you prioritize your tasks throughout the day or week

Marie: uh usually I try to give myself a little schedule on the calendar app of my phone where it can actually categorize the time of day and I write for myself like oh hey this is what we do for work and then outside of work this is what I do for school and then for school like the homework Etc

Brady: thank you I try my best to do that that's good sounds good um now we'll be asking about like productivity or app usage so for do you happen to use any health apps

Marie: no no I don't

Brady: okay um what kind of struggles do you have with meeting goals or tasks that you make for yourself

Marie: um usually I don't hold myself to it like if I don't hold myself accountable to a goal that I want to achieve it for somebody that just collapses from me

Brady: okay so in order to meet your goals you have to hold your you have to have yourself or have someone else hold you accountable

Marie: yeah

Brady: interesting um do you seek self-improvement

Marie: yes

Brady: um do you work out or if not would you like to

Marie: I currently do don't work out however while I'm working I do walk around a lot so I quote unquote consider that my workout but other than that no and I would like to start exercising however

Brady: what is your average daily or weekly screen time that you think you have an

Marie: hour and a half

Brady: and what do you spend most of your time on

Marie: social media and sometimes um my school and work apps that they have that they require me to use

Brady: that makes sense that's most people so now we're gonna go to oh sorry go ahead \

Marie: I was just gonna say I try my best to space it out between everything on my

Brady: no that's definitely the goal so now to user engagement what keeps engagement in the applications that you use what helps you keep keep engaged

Marie: um I'll start off with what I use for work um I'm not sure if anyone else has heard of this but it's called ADP it's usually for payroll and for me um with that app I just make sure that um you know actually the app itself is very glitchy me and my co-workers have been having problems with it um when we try to clock in our hours or try to let our supervisor know through the app that there's been issues and she our supervisor doesn't get the message that we're trying to send on from our and to her we we all kind of wish that that would be more um productive I guess like just a better working app for people who rely on it to work

Brady: okay um for the apps that you do use for the most part on your daily or weekly uh screen time what apps do you think keep you most entertained and why

Marie: that I would have to answer with my social media app simply because everyone keeps themselves up to date with what's going on like polit political wise um what's happening in your hometown to um pretty much to be up to date in the present day that's what keeps to be most attracted to uh social media apps

Brady: Hm interesting do you play video games

Marie: I do but not on my phone believe it or not wait no that's a lie I'm sorry I do I do play video games on my phone

Brady: that's okay I mean you know I lie all the time um do you feel non-productive when you're playing sometimes

Marie: sometimes I do

Brady: hm okay okay um what do you think is the most frustrating aspect of staying productive or organized

Marie: that's an interesting question um let me see uh I'm sorry I I apologize that you please can you please repeat the question

Brady: what do you think is the most frustrating aspect of staying productive or Organized

Marie: what do you have the most with whenever I try to be productive in the moment I usually like to keep my item like my items in order like for example for my job I sometimes have to do online courses sometimes I get that juggle with schoolwork like I think I'm actually doing something for school when it turns out I'm doing something for work and then when I get the

two mixed up and I realize have to turn an assignment and then I find out it's late or wasn't even turned in I'm like oh well that's just great that's fantastic I thought i was more productive than that

Brady: okay do you often feel overwhelmed by tasks or goals

Marie: um certain tasks yes especially for the ones that I do for my job since recently I thought I for the way that I go with my work that I got to make sure that I completed all the courses listed on my work website and unfortunately I had the pro recent problem of missing one and my supervisor informed me that I needed to complete the course before I could go back to work again and I was like oh okay let me quickly do that course and thankfully that problem has been resolved but yeah that's me

Brady: yeah you just wish that someone told you beforehand rather than the last moment

Marie: yes

Brady:okay Hm have you ever attempted to use um applications like productivity tools or methods of staying productive

Marie: I have once but that was a while ago

Brady: okay do you remember if you had any challenges when using it

Marie:I know that it didn't really meet my standards as as far as I wanted to be productive and when I tried to use an app to rely on it the app is itself was faulty um I don't remember it necessarily having malware but I just know that it just didn't really work out for me

Brady: so what would made it easier if you if it was just a better user experience

Marie: yeah

Brady: good to know for combining productivity and gamification how would you feel the idea of combining those two would go

Marie: I actually think that would be very very interesting I've never heard of that before

Brady: what kind of aspects of gaming do you think you would like to see uh in productivity apps

Marie: I'm thinking of two different ways of how that would work actually like for could I set an example like with my job and my school work sure I was thinking of productivity and gamification like for my course um with my job they I do take quizzes with those courses and instead of doing it on the computer it would be nice to have an app for it on my phone and the

games the game side of the app would be like the quiz except it just be more fun I think that would be cool

Brady: interesting thank you for sharing that yeah um did you have anything else to say

Marie: no I lost my train thought for the rest of the idea that I had in mind I apologize

Brady: it's okay do you think that gamification could help with motivation and productivity

Marie: yes I do believe that it could how

Brady: so it

Marie: could be exciting for people that are used to having a prod a product a productivity app that could also like use gamification as like a more inclusive and and joyful thing to have on your phone I think get more people interested

Brady: I agree so what kind of rewards would be most motivating for you

Marie: I know that one thing that I've seen a lot recently on other apps that I've seen people fall for is like offering actual money and I feel like that's just a scam waiting for to happen for anybody but um I feel like the reward should be actually accomplishing urgent stuff that people may need to do it in their life sorry that might be useless

Brady: no that's not it's important um how about things like that we can put in our apps such as points badges or leveling do you think those would help

Marie: leveling yes leveling yes leveling important

Brady: okay Hm what kind of devices do you prefer using do you prefer mobile or desktop

Marie: um I can't really say for sure with desktop because I have a old version of a Google Chrome uh my phone is also outdated as well but um to put it bluntly I think a phone app would be nice

Brady: you think a phone is more convenient

Marie: yeah

Brady: how do you feel about smart devices like smart watches or Fitness trackers

Marie: um I've seen a lot of people who I've been working with recently use a Smart smart watches and I actually think that that would be also helpful too like to have maybe that productivity app under SmartWatch 2 that' be cool

Brady: nice thank you um as for social elements of our application do you value competition among your peers

Marie: um I think like there's a lot of pros and cons to that Pro is that you can actually encourage your friends to help each other out the con is there could be some that can achieve their goals and others aren't and it could just creates bitterness in that way

Brady: very true uh what things do you use to socialize whether it's social media or other aspects of mediums such as games

Marie: um I usually go through my contacts when I socialize with people that I know um sometimes I do use social media as well to socialize with my friends um I also do use email too

Brady: so mostly contacts okay so for last bit of questions they're monetary based so any subscriptions like gaming wise or productivity apps um would you be interested in something like like that like a battle pass or reward system but through a subscription based like monetary

Marie: um that does sound interesting it's just that would that be something that would have to pay for in the future

Brady: yeah so with like our subscription service you would pay monthly to have extra benefits and to get extra rewards for things that you would have normally done but not get as many rewards for

Marie: oh okay then that doesn't sound too bad at all not too bad

Brady: okay and do you know what fomo means

Marie: yes fear of missing out

Brady: and do you feel like that encourages purchases um when you miss out on certain things

Marie: yes yes it does yeah kind of hate to say this as an example but like I recently cancel my Netflix I have major fomo now

Brady: okay good to know and how do you feel about spending money on applications or softwares

Marie: um I will do what I have to do to make sure that whatever software that I have doesn't have any form of malware in it even if it includes spending some money okay I'd rather have that like safety protection and mind

Brady: totally and would demos help you with the decision

Marie: um I guess a reliable source that excuse me would uh inform me very well on what the software has and what it includes along with its major features um currently can't think of anything else

Brady: but you think it would help you make your decision

Marie: as long as it had the major features to Showcase and not just like thoughts of what it would be yeah okay sounds good

Brady: so I think that's it um thank you very much for this interview you will be the first in line to test our product if you are interested and your input is will be very useful for us making our product better for the average user

Marie: oh okay great

Brady: and what is your name again

Marie: Marie

Brady: okay thank you Marie

Marie: you're welcome

2. Angeles Aguilar

Brady Askins: Hello!

Angeles Aguilar: Hello!

Brady Askins: So I just wanted to ask some preliminary questions before we get on topic for the interview. What is your name?

Angeles Aguilar: My name is Angeles Aguilar.

Brady Askins: Alright. And what is your current occupation?

Angeles Aguilar: Current occupation is, I work as a custodian, and at fast food.

Brady Askins: Okay.

Brady Askins: So now we'll start off with the student slash work status questions. Are you currently a student.

Angeles Aguilar: Currently I'm not. But I intend to go back.

Brady Askins: Hmm, okay. And what is your age?

Angeles Aguilar: I am 23 years old.

Brady Askins: Hmm, okay.

Brady Askins: And for your work. What type of hours do you typically see per week?

Angeles Aguilar: At the moment I currently see myself doing about less than 20. But I'm currently looking for more.

Brady Askins: Hmm, okay. Can you give me a brief description of your daily routine?

Angeles Aguilar: My daily routine usually includes getting up doing a little bit of exercise. I tend to walk around the block and get up

Angeles Aguilar: tidy around the house if anything needs to be done, and besides working at the moment just with friends, honestly.

Brady Askins: Okay, sounds good. And do you track your daily routine at all with anything.

Angeles Aguilar: I do not track my daily routine. However, I feel like I should, so I can better prioritize my time management.

Brady Askins: Feel like you should. Interesting.

Brady Askins: Alright! Can it be challenging, trying to balance different goals and tasks.

Angeles Aguilar: It is very tough for me, only because personally for me, I have Adhd, so I tend to get easily distracted. But if I had a schedule to follow through with. Then I'm pretty sure it'd be easier.

Angeles Aguilar: Hmm!

Brady Askins: I like the sound of that. Do you prioritize any of your tasks throughout the day.

Angeles Aguilar: The only thing I prioritize is making sure I'm on work on time, and that's usually about it.

Brady Askins: Okay, alright. Now we'll go on to the health and productivity app usage.

Brady Askins: do you use any health or productivity apps? So far right now.

Angeles Aguilar: At the moment. The only thing I do have is something that tracks my steps, but anything else I do not own.

Brady Askins: Hmm, okay.

Brady Askins: and do you think that this app is help is effective in helping you achieve any goals that you're currently having.

Angeles Aguilar: This app does help me in the sense that it keeps the total count of the steps I've taken per day, and it definitely gives me more motivation to keep doing it, as I feel proud of the steps that I have taken.

Brady Askins: Hmm, okay.

Brady Askins: Do you struggle to meet any goals or tasks that you set yourself.

Angeles Aguilar: Besides, a little bit more physical exercise. Yes, I still feel like having a plan schedule, and maybe something physical to look at to see what I haven't done for the day. Like a checklist of per se. I definitely would benefit from that.

Brady Askins: Hmm, okay. And do you, would you seek self-improvement, if possible?

Angeles Aguilar: I definitely would seek self-improvement, not only for my mental state but physical performance.

Brady Askins: Okay. I already asked you, if you work out

Brady Askins: what would you say? Is your average daily or weekly screen time? Whatever is easier to answer.

Angeles Aguilar: More than I probably should have it. But if I were to give a rough guess, maybe still about

Angeles Aguilar: 10 HR week.

Brady Askins: And what app do you spend most of your time on.

Angeles Aguilar: Personally, on my own entertainment purposes. I like to spend my time

Angeles Aguilar: usually just playing games. If I'm not working or not with friends.

Angeles Aguilar: I would say it's team.

Brady Askins: That's good. Okay? So more onto the engagement of apps and games. What do you think helps keep you engaged in those apps that you use a lot.

Angeles Aguilar: The engagement is being able to visually track in a number type of sense of things that I have done. So. When I mentioned the steps I've taken. It literally displays the total amount. It gives me a feeling of satisfaction that I have achieved something rather than just me, either forgetting what I've done, or just not being able to track it.

Brady Askins: Hmm, okay, hmm, and what video games do you play?

Angeles Aguilar: I tend to play some shooter games, but I do like a little bit of challenge. So some puzzle games. I definitely like to have that differentiating type of entertainment.

Brady Askins: And do you feel non-productive when you play any of these games? Both shooters and puzzles.

Angeles Aguilar: Non productive. I mean, knowing that I can best probably be out of work instead. Then this I still feel like it's in a sense worth it for me, since I can be entertained because not everyone wants to be doing the same thing all day, every day.

Brady Askins: It's very true. It's very true.

Brady Askins: Okay, now on to the pain points of our production.

Brady Askins: So what do you think is the most frustrating aspect of staying, productive or organized.

Angeles Aguilar: The most frustrating aspect is still maintaining the motivation or the feeling of just. I feel like, I don't think I have the capacity to maintain this goal that I've set for myself. So it definitely would hinder on onto my mental state, which is why some things

Angeles Aguilar: like, for example, exercising, I do sometimes give up, but it does come around when I gain the motivation to do so.

Brady Askins: Do you have any idea what would possibly help you improve this.

Angeles Aguilar: I definitely still think a physical checklist would definitely help. Since I can see what I need to do. And it's like, okay, I done this already. I can still do that, and it would come down to. I can do it rather than I do. I need to do that. Do I have to do it. It definitely would help.

Brady Askins: Okay. And do you often feel overwhelmed by tasks and goals?

Angeles Aguilar: I definitely do at times feel overwhelmed. Hence, why, it's easier for me to either knock it all out in one, go and then think about it later, or just completely pace it set by set, which would link back to the idea of me having a checklist to definitely pace it out more healthfully.

Brady Askins: Okay, that's good. I know you said the only productivity tool you used was like your step tracker.

Brady Askins: But was there any challenges or frustrations that you've had through this app.

Angeles Aguilar: There wouldn't be any frustrations. I think the only thing I would say is that it wouldn't correctly display the steps like it wouldn't update it instantly.

Angeles Aguilar: though I'm pretty sure that wouldn't be easy to track on a simple application with not much work that was put into it.

Brady Askins: Well, we'll try our best to make sure that it tracks everything properly, since that's what everyone wants.

Brady Askins: Let's see.

Brady Askins: So what would you think would make the app easier to use just having a more precise.

Angeles Aguilar: I definitely think a more precise tracking way would definitely help out a lot.

And I think for me personally, I would like to at least see a little bit more statistics that would be displayed so per se, potentially the distance you've traveled. Oh, and especially if you can change the type of way it's measured. So kilometers, meters, miles, in case you want to know the specifics in different numbers and definitely things such as calories that you've burned.

Angeles Aguilar: and I think that would definitely be more interesting rather than helpful. But I I think that's different with everyone.

Brady Askins: Hmm!

Brady Askins: I think that's both interesting and helpful. That's very nice. Thank you.

Brady Askins: And now we're gonna go on to specific gamification preferences. How do you feel about the idea of gamifying

Brady Askins: productivity like through an app.

Angeles Aguilar: I definitely think it would interest the particular party that you would try to be aiming for. I know for me, if I were to combine productivity and games. It would be interesting, in a sense, since I mentioned, I like puzzles as well. It is challenging for the brain reading definitely can help out with that, it definitely would make it more intriguing to continue productivity.

Brady Askins: And you think it would help with motivation.

Angeles Aguilar: I definitely think, if it provides an immense feeling of satisfaction, the motivation would still be maintained greatly. Oh, absolutely.

Brady Askins: Okay? And what kind of rewards do you think it would help motivation like points, badges, leveling? Do you think those would help.

Angeles Aguilar: That would definitely be specific for independent people, as I think one example is leveling. If you and a partner both are doing at the same time it's like, Oh, look! I'm higher level. Then it would then

Angeles Aguilar: give the sense of Oh, I need to do more to feel motivated, to keep

Angeles Aguilar: at this task that I set myself for. So yes, I definitely think that a type of award system

Angeles Aguilar: that would benefit you

Angeles Aguilar: in the long run definitely would be more for bragging rights. But it would keep with the motivation. Yes.

Brady Askins: Oh, okay, we'll touch on the social aspect in a sec.

Brady Askins: But for device preferences. Do you prefer using mobile or desktop devices for productivity and gaming.

Angeles Aguilar: Of course, if I'm on the go, for when I'm walking I would use my phone. But if there was a way to have it linked to share those statistics onto my computer and then combine it. That definitely would be interesting to see.

Brady Askins: Hmm, okay.

Brady Askins: some more convenient for phone. But, added desktop features would be nice.

What about smart devices? Would you be interested in using like a smartwatch.

Angeles Aguilar: I would say a smart watch would definitely be very handy, since you wouldn't have to worry about the phone and going back to being interlinked with the single application on multiple different devices, like on a cloud data storage. That would very much be more easier to use.

Brady Askins: Hmm, okay. And you said earlier about how there would be like competition with your peers.

Brady Askins: Do you think that that would

Brady Askins: be a great value for this tracking up, being able to have, like a competition with like minded people.

Angeles Aguilar: It would be very nice to see a competition, and it would help, I believe. I know, for example, some

Angeles Aguilar: like in discord. You can make group events. And everyone can attend, I think, having a function to potentially have

Angeles Aguilar: you all create a group. And then we all have like a set goal, and maybe 2 weeks time we'll try to all together have a competition where we can see who can burn this amount of calories, or who can have the most. And then, I think, whoever wins that potential competition would of course, get the most rewards and or bragging rights that'd be definitely interesting to have a friendly competition that way.

Brady Askins: Hmm! That's interesting. You mentioned that because I didn't bring it up. But part of our

Brady Askins: application would have like things like raids where you would have like a a raid team.

Brady Askins: and you would start like a mission, and there would be like a set goal by the end of this time period to get something done, and you all can work towards a goal, but also have your own individual points.

Angeles Aguilar: Yes, so that everyone can work together to either. Complete that entire rage. Set goal, and especially see who has put the most effort in.

Brady Askins: Yeah, I think that's both a good combination of competition and camaraderie. Oh, absolutely.

Brady Askins: And what kind of things do you use to socialize, whether through social media or other mediums, like games.

Angeles Aguilar: I tend to value more in games, since I'm not a big social media fan. So, having abilities that would be either shared or told about in social media. Personally, for me it would not matter too much.

Brady Askins: Okay, that's good.

Brady Askins: And for our last section of questions are about monetary

Brady Askins: values, so how would you feel about any like a type of subscription service. So like a battle pass, or just like a premium membership, they can subscribe to, and you get added benefits and rewards.

Angeles Aguilar: I definitely think it still would be unfortunately, following the most biggest trend. I think most companies tend to just default to which is a way to make money, since it would just cause everyone just to have a subscription and claim all these benefits would be nice, but it really would heavily have to depend on exactly what type of benefits would outweigh the free type of rewards that you already would get without subscription. I think it really would definitely, dramatically depend on the

Angeles Aguilar: value of said subscription and its items.

Brady Askins: So that'd be a big difference between free and the subscription service. Okay?

Brady Askins: And how do you feel about Fomo? Do you know what that means?

Angeles Aguilar: I do not actually.

Brady Askins: Fomo is a tactic used for making money called fear of missing out. So instead of just having like a thing you can buy normally, you can only buy it for a limited amount of time, making people feel like they're going to miss out if they don't buy it right away. How do you feel about that kind of model.

Angeles Aguilar: It is, I think, a slight better way to tackle such type of funding instead of it just being a subscription. But it probably would have to depend on type of item that would be

Angeles Aguilar: one time purchase only because it would either have benefits that way. Others, or if it's just clearly superior in the sense of rewards that you would constantly have the opportunity to have.

Angeles Aguilar: It definitely would cause the fear factor to be playing more into a point of should I purchase this or not?

Brady Askins: That's good, so don't weaponize fear, but it could be useful.

Angeles Aguilar: It could be useful.

Brady Askins: Hmm! And how do you feel about spending money on software.

Angeles Aguilar: It would for me definitely have to

Angeles Aguilar: mean something to me, and have either a long, lasting effect

Angeles Aguilar: of enjoyment or for other purposes. I know for me in games and puzzles it would be different, since in games I'm spending it for memories and sometimes bragging rights. But.

Brady Askins: Hmm! And would Demos help with that decision?

Angeles Aguilar: I think Demos definitely would help. It's like a little bit of a taste. And then

Angeles Aguilar: maybe, like a time trial, you can have this specific item or reward

Angeles Aguilar: for your activity. That definitely would be a little nice tease to then be like, Oh, I did like that. Okay, I want to buy it.

Brady Askins: Hmm, okay.

Brady Askins: Well, that's all the questions that I have for you. Thank you again for your time.

And what is your name? Again?

Angeles Aguilar: My name is Angeles Aguilar.

Brady Askins: Alright and just to clarify you. Did agree to the consent form that was sent to you before this interview? Right.

Angeles Aguilar: I did with full permission, I grant.

Brady Askins: Perfect. Alright. Thank you for your time.

Angeles Aguilar: Thank you as well.

3. Melody Gatan

Melody Gatan: This meeting is being recorded. Okay.

Brady Askins: Hello!

Melody Gatan: Hello!

Brady Askins: I would like to ask just a couple of preliminary questions before the actual interview, so can I get your name and your occupation

Melody Gatan: 1st and last.

Brady Askins: Yeah.

Melody Gatan: I'm Melody Gatan. Is that my, what I'm trying to pursue, or what I currently do right now?

Brady Askins: What you currently do

Melody Gatan: I am. I work at target part time.

Brady Askins: It.

Melody Gatan: A fulfillment expert

Brady Askins: And do you go to school?

Melody Gatan: I do go to school. I go to Cal State, Long Beach

Brady Askins: And how many units are you taking

Melody Gatan: I? From what I recall, I I'm taking 15 units

Brady Askins: Alright! And how old are you?

Melody Gatan: I am 20

Brady Askins: Years old, of course. Yeah. And how many hours do you expect yourself to work each day?

Melody Gatan: Target

Brady Askins: Yes.

Melody Gatan: Well, that depends.

Brady Askins: On average.

Melody Gatan: Like average daily, I am. I mean doing the math because I work average 20 to 25 h per week. So what is that daily

Brady Askins: It's about 3 HA day or 4 HA day.

Melody Gatan: Yeah, about 3 or 4 a day

Brady Askins: Alright. Sounds good. Can you give a brief description of what your daily routine looks like?

Melody Gatan: If I have work I usually wake up because I I'm usually scheduled from 8 to 3, because I can't wake up any time before 8, I have a class on Tuesday, Thursdays, at 3 30, but my

work is in the middle, so it only takes me 15 min to drive. So from 8 to 3, I'm working, cause I wake up. Sorry. This is so out of order. Okay, I wake up. I do the basics, brush teeth, brush hair and get dressed. I drive to work. I work at a Target in Cerritos. I'm basically at work. I just shop for the online orders. People place on our app and then I go to lunch. And then I get off work, I am at 3. I don't speed. I go to school in a timely manner for my 3 30 class, and I go to class and work with my group for my senior project, and then I go home, eat dinner, get some homework done and have leisure time before I go to sleep around 10 to 12 on a good day.

Brady Askins: Yeah. Sounds like a very full day

Melody Gatan: Don't get me started on Mondays and Wednesdays.

Brady Askins: Hey, pat, is there a specific part of the day where you feel most productive

Melody Gatan: I mean at work, like I've mentioned to friends. I am productive in a way where I'm moving my body at target, you're always walking like a lot of us. We say we lose like 5 or 10 pounds when you work for the 1st 3 months on target. It's kind of crazy

Brady Askins: Damn!

Melody Gatan: Yeah, we did well, especially for order pickups. We walk around the store like 6 to 8 miles a day like, that's like over 10 k steps. I mean, I'm productive in that manner where I'm both moving my body, and I'm doing good for the world in a way where I'm placing. I'm doing your orders for guests online. But at school I feel most productive when I'm coding for sure, when I'm working on a project that I don't hate. Yeah.

Brady Askins: Okay, and is there any time of day where you find yourself struggling to focus?

Melody Gatan: I would say at home. It is a bit rough doing homework or trying to code when this is my comfortable spot in which I like gaming issue. But sometimes even at school, when I'm with friends our talking sessions last a bit too long.

Brady Askins: Hmm, okay.

Melody Gatan: I would say yapping, but I don't know if that's a really good transcription word

Brady Askins: No, that's very, very useful. Hard for you to stop yapping and get to work, and that's understandable.

Melody Gatan: Yeah.

Brady Askins: And do you track your daily routine at all?

Melody Gatan: I do. I actually love Google Calendar, even for events that have passed like eating dinner with friends. I put that on my calendar even after, you know, as a reminder

Brady Askins: That's good to know

Melody Gatan: Yeah, I always have, like my classes outlined in my Google Calendar. I have my work. I have days where I need to get stuff done when I get home. I have chores, a slot for an hour shower, you know, a slot for like 30 min to an hour, and homework planned out for different classes, depending on how productive I need to be for that day. Google Calendar is my Savior

Brady Askins: I see. So you do value a way to track your stuff you've done throughout the day and week. Do you find it challenging to balance different goals and tasks on a day-to-day basis?

Melody Gatan: Sometimes, especially when I don't know how long something's gonna take, or the difficulty of that task such as different classes sometimes all have, like underestimated the amount of work that was needed to be put in for a certain assignment or task

Brady Askins: Okay, so you struggle to fit your time into a cohesive schedule good to know onto like usage of health apps. Do you happen to use any health apps or productivity apps. That's not Google Calendar.

Melody Gatan: I use it well for working out. I like using an app called heavy. It's where I feel accomplished whenever I hit a personal record and wait, or amount of reps or volume in that way. It's nice keeping track of for progressive overload, I would say, using a fitness app like heavy as well as I used to use another app called, lose it whenever I want to restart on a diet, counting calories as well as heavy, and lose. It goes into the fitness app by apple and the fitness app is not very accurate, but is for iphones. It sometimes tracks how much you walk, and it applies that into the fitness app as well for apple ios.

Brady Askins: Okay, very interesting. And how effective do you feel these apps are with helping you achieve your goals or stay productive

Melody Gatan: I would say the heavy, workout app heavy helped me a lot with my goals. When it comes to working out, I would say, lose it, though it's very on and off I'll go weeks without using it and kind of forgetting it in a way. But when I'm unhappy with stepping on that scale. I'll come back to it for only like 2 to 3 weeks, and then I'll just forget about it.

Brady Askins: No, it's very useful. Okay. And do you seek self-improvement

Melody Gatan: Yes, I always try to find a way to make better choices. Oh, especially when I well, when I'm eating productive, wise though I've been struggling with that like trying to be more focused on my career

Brady Askins: Okay. And how often do you work out

Melody Gatan: I work out at least twice a week. I try to work out any day that I don't have work, though, for my 3rd day, but sometimes it's hard, or I already have plans for the day. I don't go to work

Brady Askins: Oh, okay, now, we're gonna go on to the user engagement with apps. Section. What would you say? Your daily or weekly screen time? Looks like

Melody Gatan: Oh, my, what is my average? I can I actually go check this real quick

Brady Askins: Sure.

Melody Gatan: Let's see. Screen time, I would say 8 last, I would say, hmm, maybe. Well, according to my app, it says 7 h within the past 24 h.

Brady Askins: Is that true

Melody Gatan: Says for screen, on, which is kind of accurate, but

Brady Askins: And I would say, it's not because I leave my phone running well on.

Melody Gatan: Oh, I would say, 7 h, yeah, 5 h, maybe

Brady Askins: Okay, 5 h. And what do you spend most of the time on your screen when using

Melody Gatan: I would say, discord or facetime, as of these past few weeks.

Brady Askins: Okay? So like social media type apps. Okay? And what keeps you in? What do you feel like keeps you engaged in these apps

Melody Gatan: Well, connectivity with friends, I would say, for sure.

Brady Askins: Okay.

Melody Gatan: Yes.

Brady Askins: And how much free time do you usually have throughout the day

Melody Gatan: Is free time considered going to the gym, or is that like a commitment responsibility

Brady Askins: Free time is time that isn't spent. The doing commitments like working out or working

Melody Gatan: Daily, I would say. I would say, about 5 h. Yeah.

Brady Askins: Okay, and you spend most of your free time, usually on your phone or playing games

Melody Gatan: Yes.

Brady Askins: Okay, good to know. And what games do you play

Melody Gatan: I play a lot of games, I mean, as of recently I've been playing repo I recently got back into Valorant, though, which

Brady Askins: Sorry to hear that.

Melody Gatan: But it was only it was my 1st month back in like a month and a half.

Brady Askins: Okay.

Melody Gatan: But it was for a friend. I didn't play it for me.

Brady Askins: And do you feel non-productive when playing games

Melody Gatan: Yes, but I feel like it's desert after everything I've done that day

Brady Askins: It's not in the bad way. Okay.

Melody Gatan: Like. Of course, you feel unproductive, but it's kind of like my reward or my downtime, you know, from either work or from school.

Brady Askins: Okay, now we're gonna go on to the pain points and challenges of the interviewer.

What do you think is the most frustrating aspect of staying, productive and organized

Melody Gatan: And I would say for me, it's actually being overwhelmed by so many tasks and not knowing where to start. Wait! What was the question? That was the question. Right? Like

Brady Askins: Yeah.

Melody Gatan: But okay, yeah, I feel like as personally for me, I get really overwhelmed with if I have so much due. But that's also because of procrastination, and I suck at splitting these tasks up.

Melody Gatan: and don't see the urgency till something is due. Within the next day or 2.

Brady Askins: So it's more on a macro scale. Okay, and do you often feel overwhelmed by tasks and goals?

Melody Gatan: Yes, a lot

Brady Askins: That's understandable. Okay, so what are some challenges? Have you experienced challenges or frustrations with productivity, tools or methods used to become more productive

Melody Gatan: I would say there was a time where I tried using a pomodoro timer and I felt like that gave me too many breaks, or I just wasn't consistent as well as it would be hard to turn it off and on, especially when I have notifications on from discord because I have strong cases of Fomo, also known as fear missing out in like friends, group chats or servers, or what's happening. So, it was strong to adhere to it when I'm constantly checking my phone or tabbing out back to discord.

Brady Askins: Okay. So it's Fomo when it comes to social interactions.

Melody Gatan: Yes.

Brady Askins: Interesting. That's very useful. So do you feel like what would make productivity apps user? Or what would make productivity apps easier is if they had a social aspect that we didn't have to leave??

Melody Gatan: There's a social aspect

Brady Askins: Interesting, very useful, very useful. Okay, so next subject is about preferences for gamification. So I'm sure you know our product is about gamifying productivity apps. How do you feel about the idea of combining those 2 mediums?

Melody Gatan: I think it's a very interesting aspect. I feel like having incentive or awards, or something to showcase that you did a good job is very gratifying, such as like. I mentioned earlier how the heavy app, whenever I hit a personal record, it shows me like this little medallion, and it makes like a little ring, and it feels very fulfilling in a way

Brady Askins: Okay, so you do like rewards for beating personal records. Good to know. So what other kinds of rewards do you think would help you? Do you think having an in-game, leveling system, or points or badges would be more enticing?

Melody Gatan: Badges are enticing. I kind of, I see appeal whenever you like, it's like a streak kind of or not streak, but, like Github, commits those green stuff or leak code streaks like the you know that that is, it looks so satisfying to me like I don't know, displaying that you're keeping consistent with something. I don't know if that's if that's just me

Brady Askins: No, that's very useful. And how do you feel about social aspects that would keep people engaged to like competition among peers? How do you feel about that?

Melody Gatan: I actually have seen an app about that before. It was

Brady Askins: Impossible! Never done!

Melody Gatan: You're so right, are you sure it's not your guys? But it was like these people compete to do elite code a day, and if you don't, you ruin the streak for the whole entire group and

Brady Askins: Very interesting.

Melody Gatan: Right. I forgot where I saw it. It was like weeks ago, but that part where it's the social aspect of you're all supporting each other, and you're all working collectively towards the goal. I think that's pretty cool. Okay. And that's very useful. Thank you for that. And when it

comes to like a preferred device. What kind of device do you prefer using? Do you prefer using like a mobile device or a desktop?

Melody Gatan: I would say, either, or but personally for me, I would prefer desktop, because I don't use Instagram on my computer, but I do sometimes on my phone.

Melody Gatan: so that could be like distracting

Brady Askins: Hmm, okay.

Melody Gatan: Cause personally for me on discord I am on, do not disturb, so I don't see the notifications. But if I'm on my phone, the notifications still appear sometimes. And now I feel like I shouldn't be on. Do not disturb anymore because of the fomo I don't know. I feel like it's more productive on computer

Brady Askins: Okay. So now for the last section of questions. How do you feel about monetary values when it comes to apps like subscription services or battle passes.

Melody Gatan: Like us paying for stuff like that. I would say, what do I have a subscription for? I have a subscription. Oh, you know what I do pay for discord, nitro to flex my banner and my profile picture

Brady Askins: That's very useful. So you would pay for a subscription service just for added benefits of themes or

Melody Gatan: Yeah.

Brady Askins: I just show off to other people

Melody Gatan: Yeah and customization customization

Brady Askins: Okay, that's very good to know. And how do you feel about Fomo when it comes to like purchases like only being able to purchase something for limited time before it's gone forever.

Melody Gatan: I do that for pokemon. I do that where, if I see something I like, I'll buy it for a month and then I'll unsubscribe till I see something else I like. Alright

Brady Askins: So it is very effective.

Melody Gatan: Yes.

Brady Askins: Okay. And how do you feel?

Melody Gatan: Or like that deal where it's on heavy, where it was saying like for limited time, you could buy a whole year of like heavy plus or whatever like, for like a cheaper cost like, if something's on sale for a year like a considerably like lower percent, like percentage, or whatever

like if something was usually 29.99 per year. But like, oh, they're like limited time, like, Oh, this is only gonna be like 11.99 for the whole

Brady Askins: Oh, okay.

Melody Gatan: Like those. Get me? Those actually do get me

Brady Askins: And how would you feel about spending money for software or applications?

Melody Gatan: Like an example? Could you provide

Brady Askins: Like. Say the heavy app, for example, if you had to pay for it 1st before you started using it.

Melody Gatan: I think I would have been deterred away from it like I like the aspect of how it was free. And it was actually I actually did my research about them, because I wanted to apply to actually work for them. But they're based in Canada. And they're looking for experienced react native developers, but they just released their Api any who's

Melody Gatan: I liked how it was free, and that it was like created by a small group of people at the beginning

Brady Askins: Okay. What if the app they had to pay for had a demo at first? st Do you think that would help with your decision?

Melody Gatan: I I don't think so.I only get

Brady Askins: Upfront costs, outweighs.

Melody Gatan: Yeah, if anything. Cause I I've been the type of person to never buy any apps or games that had like an upfront cost

Melody Gatan: on my phone

Brady Askins: Me, too. That's why I didn't want to download Blue and start offense 5 for a long time

Melody Gatan: Yeah, my parents got that for free, and they were like stuck on it.

Brady Askins: Okay, that's very, very helpful. Thank you. So

Melody Gatan: That's why I never played Minecraft, not gonna lie as a kid. I didn't play any games that cost money. I would like to include that

Brady Askins: It is \$30, so it's a bit steep

Melody Gatan: It's how much

Brady Askins: 30,

Melody Gatan: The heck; Yeah. But now that I have a job, some games are worth buying.

Brady Askins: Very true, yeah, especially now that you make your own money. That makes sense

Melody Gatan: Exactly.

Brady Askins: Okay. Alright. It's all the questions that I have listed here. Thank you again for your time. And can you please

Melody Gatan: Yes.

Brady Askins: Reiterate who you are.

Melody Gatan: I am Melody Gatan

Brady Askins: Alright. Thank you, Melody Gatan, for your time.

Melody Gatan: Thank you.

Michael:

1. Greg Terada

Michael: Can you tell us your name?

Greg: Yeah my name is Greg Terrada. Nice to meet you.

Michael: And are you currently a student, working, or anything like that?

Greg: Uh no I graduated from CSULB in 2022 and just currently job hunting now.

Michael: nice nice wish you luck with that, uh can you tell me how old you are?

Greg: Uh 26.

Michael: okay and let's start with like, can you describe your daily routine, what you really like, what you do throughout the day?

Greg: Daily routine. At this point I'm kind of just job searching and trying to take it easy before I really start getting uh into my career um it's really just uh applying to jobs and then uh just being at home most of the time now

Michael: Okay and is it like a specific part of the day where you feel like you're most productive? Maybe you're a morning person or you're an afternoon person?

Greg: Definitely morning I'd say I'm more of a morning person and it's like morning or like late at night I guess

Michael: Right, right. Do you uh track your daily routine at all? Like what you do throughout the day or...

Greg: not at all I I wouldn't say I do

Michael: Okay that's fine, uh when you did have, like if you're ever working on goals or tasks do you find it challenging to balance them at all?

Greg: um I I do I find it hard sometimes it's hard to get motivated I'd say sometimes but um you know you just kind of got to push through and keep on going at it especially with applying for jobs and you know if I get rejected it's uh it's hard but you just keep on pushing through and applying right always moving forward.

Michael: yeah uh so let's see here have you ever used any health or productivity apps maybe like a gym tracker or like calorie tracker?

Greg: yeah um I use like the iOS like Health app I use Fitbit and then uh I used to use an app called Finch um

Michael: Finch oh I've heard of that one

Greg: It's kind of like a yeah, yeah, it was like a how do I say it was like a daily like tracker I guess for doing you know daily tasks and whatnot and whenever you would complete a task you would like check off something in the game and it would like reward you with like a little present or something right

Michael: Right, uh did you feel it was like effective with helping you achieve those goals or like keeping you on track?

Greg: Finch I think it it was good but I just stopped using it um but more recently I've been getting outside a lot more um and I think Fitbit helps with that um like having a Fitbit is just kind of like a reminder to be like oh maybe you should be active

Michael: right like get you motivated a bit.

Greg: Yeah, yeah Like to get out of the house more.

Michael: So what would you say keeps you most engaged when you use those kind of applications

Greg: um so most engaged... I'd say so with Fitbit for example I'd say the most engaging thing about it is seeing your own stats I guess how many steps you take um maybe how long you're in like a high heart rate zone like a actual working out Zone um seeing how far you've walked uh your heart rate and stuff like that

Michael: right just getting a measure of where you started and where you're ending up at like those gradual inclines

Greg: Yeah, definitely, yeah

Michael: Do you play video games? And like how often yeah

Greg: I play video games uh pretty often every day for sure um yeah.

Michael: Do you ever feel overwhelmed by tasks or goals at all?

Greg: um yeah I definitely feel overwhelmed if I have a lot of them or it's like a big task um I'll definitely start to feel overwhelmed um and I guess like my way of sorting through is just tackling like one at a time

Michael: Right, right and when you use, like productivity tools for that do you have any specific challenges you've run into or like anything that holds you back from doing that?

Greg: uh honestly no um productivity apps are usually pretty helpful I think I just don't use it consistently enough to be useful to me which you know that may just be a me thing not the apps fault itself.

Michael: Right so would you say that's like your main point on why you stopped using these type of apps it's just like a motivation thing? Or like just putting it down and then not picking it back up Greg: yeah yeah that's kind of what it seems like. Like with Fitbit it's a very passive thing you get to see stats so that's the reason why I use that one um but with some of the other ones like yeah I kind of just fall off and I stop using it.

Michael: Okay so how do you feel about like... I know you mentioned Finch where it gives you rewards. That type of like gamification of productivity apps do you think that's like helpful or not helpful?

Greg: I think it's helpful it keeps me engaged at least so it's something to work towards and so you're kind of like mixing in your own like goals along with um getting these like in-game rewards Michael: and what kind of rewards do you think would be most motivating? like levels badges or like something, like cosmetic wise you know?

Greg: For me Cosmetics. I know like a lot of people like Cosmetics so I think adding that in is probably going to draw on a lot of people or that's what most people would look for.

Michael: And do you think like for you personally, does fomo... like fomo purchases or fomo events rewards anything like that, does that encourage you to participate or like discourage you?

Greg: uh I'd say yeah fomo does. I'd say it encourages me if it's like a limited time thing it's like oh you know I'll only have one chance to get it um if I'm like really into the app then yeah I'll care and I'll be like you know what yeah let's do it like I'm never going to get it again might as

well try right?

Michael: right, and do you value competition specifically amongst your peers like a leaderboard anything like that?

Greg: I wouldn't say value it um it's like neat to see just see where you rank amongst with like other people and friends but I wouldn't put it high up on a list of like what I would want to see in a game

Michael: okay and uh regarding games specifically what do you use to socialize like what kind of apps or games or Medias do you usually hop on to?

Greg: um I'll use Discord that's the main one um I guess like just texting um but I think Discord is the main one

2. Mark Trung

Michael: Alright are you ready to start?

Mark: Yup.

Michael: Can you tell us your name and how old you are?

Mark: Hi, my name is Mark Truong. I am 26.

Michael: And are you a student or working?

Mark: I am working.

Michael: What would you say are your typical work hours?

Mark: Uh, I do military supplies and relations, and my work hours are from 6 a.m. to 3 p.m.

Michael: Can you briefly describe your daily routine?

Mark: Uh, yeah. On the weekdays where I do work, I wake up, um, around five in the morning. I get ready and leave the house around 5:40. And then I get to work and I start the day. And basically, I just work until lunch, which is roughly around noon. And then after lunch, I go back to work for the next couple of hours, and then I go home and I rinse and repeat for a normal workweek.

Michael: Is there a specific part of the day where you feel most productive? Is there a part of the day where you find yourself struggling to focus?

Mark: Uh, I would say I feel the most productive towards the morning because it's just starting out, but then I feel less productive maybe after lunch because, you know, you're tired from eating and you're waiting for the day to be over.

Michael: How do you track your daily routine? Like an app or just something mental?

Mark: Um, most of it's mental. I do have, like, a calendar system to keep track of what days I do have work or don't, or if I have any special events, but other than that, it's mostly a mental thing.

Michael: Can it be challenging trying to balance different goals and tasks on a day-to-day basis?

Mark: Uh, sometimes if it's like a really busy day or a busy week, I kind of have to make sure to mentally check myself and make sure that I'm doing everything I need to be doing. Um, but, you know, that's where I use calendars and stuff like that to check.

Michael: So what's your system on how you choose to prioritize tasks?

Mark: Uh, like, how's my system? Uh, I usually prioritize things that are sooner and then things that are later I'll work on when the start time starts coming closer.

Michael: Do you or have you used any health or productivity apps? If so, which ones?

Mark: Uh, the closest thing I have probably would be from my Samsung phone. I have, like—not my phone, but the watch. Um, it does have a Samsung Health app. And that would be the closest thing I use. Even though it's not something I use daily, I just check it here and there.

Michael: Right, to check your stats from time to time.

Mark: Correct. Yeah.

Michael: And when you do use it, how effective do you feel they are?

Mark: Uh, it's more or less just there as a nice thing. I mean, for me, I don't really feel as if it does too much because I'm not really dependent on it. It's just there—like, it's nice to have to check sometimes. Like, oh, I have it, I can use it. And if I don't, it's not the end of the world.

Michael: Right, whenever it's convenient.

Mark: Yeah.

Michael: And would you say you're the type of person who's always seeking self-improvement?

Mark: Oh, yeah. For sure. Definitely. Um, always seeking self-improvement. I feel like that's the normal mentality—wanting to do better and to do more, you know?

Michael: And how often do you work out? Or any type of physical activity?

Mark: Uh, I do walking. I don't really work out necessarily. That's not something I do. Uh, I like to go on hikes here and there when the time comes up. I'm not opposed to doing physical activity or anything. It's just a matter of when I get the chance to do it.

Michael: Of course, like whenever it fits into your schedule.

Mark: Right.

Michael: What is your average screen time?

Mark: I want to say, like, if not 80% of my day.

Michael: What app do you spend the most time on?

Mark: Uh, I would say—maybe TikTok goes into play. I use that a lot during my downtime. And then, maybe more would be just YouTube in general—just watching things if I'm eating or at home or anything like that.

Michael: And what keeps you engaged when it comes to apps like that?

Mark: Uh, it definitely comes with the instant gratification of content and all that stuff. It's just really easy to use them. The usability—and, you know, I mean, these are all free apps too. So there's no need to pay for anything or anything like that.

Michael: Of course, like the accessibility of just instantly using an app.

Mark: Right.

Michael: Do you play video games and how often?

Mark: Uh, I would say I do play video games. I play relatively often. Maybe every time after work, I play for a couple of hours to wind down.

Michael: And other than video games, what other hobbies are you into?

Mark: Um, I would say my other hobbies would be spending time with friends and family. I like going out and doing things. I like to—I'm a big person who likes to eat a lot and try new things. So I'm always looking for new restaurants and stuff to try.

Michael: Most frustrating aspects of staying productive or organized?

Mark: The most frustrating aspect? I would say probably just the mental effort—trying to keep going. Sometimes you just don't want to do things and get lazy. Yeah, definitely hard to do that or keeping up with timelines. It's really hard.

Michael: And do you ever feel overwhelmed by tasks or goals?

Mark: Uh, sometimes, depending on if there's a lot of them at once and they're all thrown at me, I can definitely feel overwhelmed.

Michael: So with the apps, what are some challenges you've run into when using them before?

Mark: Uh, some challenges? I mean, they're not always 100% accurate. So, you know, we run into problems like that where they work, but sometimes they're a little off or I don't completely trust them.

Michael: Right, like a security issue with not knowing how much data it's collecting and what they're doing with it.

Mark: Yeah.

Michael: So do you have a particular reason why you've stopped using these kinds of apps?

Mark: Um, no particular reason. I just tend to forget to use them.

Michael: Okay, makes sense. What would you say makes an app accessible? Like, what would entice you to use them?

Mark: Um, I would definitely say usability. If it's really easy to just open and use, and there aren't a bunch of walls or hurdles to jump through—like creating an account or answering a bunch of things.

Michael: How do you feel about the idea of combining productivity and gamification?

Mark: Um, I think it's a good thing. You definitely need both. Like, if you get a reward for doing something, you'll just want to keep doing it.

Michael: And what kind of rewards would be most motivating for you?

Mark: Uh, maybe points or a rank system—like a status thing. Knowing that, hey, I did this, and I can show people.

Michael: Something that would set you apart from others.

Mark: Yeah.

Michael: And for an app like this, what would be more convenient—desktop or mobile?

Mark: I definitely think desktop would be the way to go.

Michael: Do you value competition specifically among your peers?

Mark: Yeah, to a degree. I'm competitive in that I always want to strive to do better, but I'm not hyper-competitive.

Michael: Okay, we've had a great interview. Thank you so much for your time, and we'll call it here.

Mark: All right. Thank you so much.

3. Calvin Dao

Michael: Hello, thank you for taking the time to do this interview. Can you start off by telling us about yourself?

Calvin: Okay yeah sure uh my name is Calvin Dao and I'll be doing an interview for [with] you today

Michael: And are you a student or working?

Calvin: uh recently graduated a couple months ago

Michael: and how old are you?

Calvin: I am 25.

Michael: Can you tell us what your normal daily routine is like?

Calvin: yeah sure uh wake up you know normal morning routine brush hair brush teeth uh shower all that uh usually get on the computer look to apply to jobs for indeed for like an hour or so or work on soft skills like uh for me would be cadding because uh my speciality is engineering uh from there eat lunch and then mess around on the computer and then go to bed. Repeat.

Michael: And when would you say you feel most productive during your daily routine? Morning, Afternoon, Night?

Calvin: probably around noon is where I feel the most productive.

Michael: And do you use any apps to keep track of your routine?

Calvin: I do not, no.

Michael: And have you ever found it challenging to keep track of everything or balance goals?

Calvin: I would say yes depending on the I guess like the the difficulty of what the goals are uh I guess it for example be during school where I had kind of to balance you know multiple classes I feel like that was the hardest where certain classes took more time and energy so I had to play like a juggling game of prioritizing which one do I want to invest more time in two versus the other.

Michael: Right like which one was worth more effort

Calvin: exactly yes

Michael: Okay moving on, have you used any health or productivity apps to keep track of stats?

Calvin: yes I use the uh the Samsung Health one all the time just to see you know daily steps and they have a sleep schedule one which occasionally works

Michael: And do you find these effective in helping you maintain your routine?

Calvin: uh I'd say it's I say it's nice to have I think the steps one is pretty nice just to gauge how much I'm walking

Michael: Are you the type to seek self-improvement?

Calvin: I would say yeah I seek self-improvement I guess in terms of like at least like in this case I the example of a be uh athletic Improvement you know seeing the step counter go up or seeing consistency run routine for the daily exercise

Michael: And how often do you use these types of fitness tracker apps?

Calvin: I'd say for the running one or the steps one I use it probably daily anytime I would you know walk a significant amount I'm just curious oh you know I should check how many steps I got in.

Michael: And what would you say is like, the most important thing to you regarding these fitness apps?

Calvin: I would say a good UI as like you know like your basic user is a is a big thing for me I feel like if an app doesn't really have anything that you know runs well or like has like nice visuals it's kind of hard for me to maintain, of course you know the actual application matters as well but at least from like the get-go like what gets me to download or what gets me to like occasionally look at it is like the the the initial things I see I suppose

Michael: Right like, how well the app gives a first impression based on how easy to use it is.

Calvin: exactly

Michael: Do you play videogames and how often?

Calvin: yeah I play, I play quite often

Michael: And what types of videogames would you say you enjoy the most?

Calvin: I would say I enjoy um Team based multiplayer games things like csgo League of Legends stuff like that

Michael: Breaking from that thought, what do you think is the most difficult thing for you when it comes to maintaining focus on tasks?

Calvin: I think the the most difficult I guess the things that I find the most difficult would be making sure I have, a let me think... I guess it depends on the the workplace for me is a big one if I'm in an environment where I can you know kind of shut off everything and just focus on my stuff I can usually pump out work but say I'm-

Michael: Right like outside factors can be distracting.

Calvin: yeah outside factors will definitely, exactly yes

Michael: And other than that reason, do you sometimes feel overwhelmed by tasks or goals you've set for yourself?

Calvin: other than that I would say maybe for me personally sometimes it can get a bit overwhelming again like depending on what I'm juggling so sometimes it's hard to um prioritize what I should do first so I end up going into like a freeze uh like to explain like say I have like three projects do and I have no idea which to weigh one above the other so instead of me actually doing the work I'm now like in a constant state of frenzy of oh like should I do project A or project C first I don't know I end up spending like an hour which could have gone to actually working on a project

Michael: Definitely, like we said before it's hard to judge which one to prioritize for sure.

Calvin: exactly

Michael: Have you ever had experience in using like planner apps or anything?

Calvin: uh I guess I've used like online planners I guess before but I kind of stopped just because... I'm trying to think why did I stop? maybe just because it didn't feel like interactive enough I felt like why why use an online at least for that app in particular why use that online app versus just like keeping like a notepad like or a physical planner because to me the the function didn't feel too significantly different.

Michael: And how would you feel if an app were to say use gamification to improve task scheduling?

Calvin: I be I'd say that'd be pretty interesting I've seen um I've seen apps like that for like running where they'll get you to do uh like run a mile in this direction and you'll get you know like a cross reward you know like in-game items or whatever or I've seen in gyms where they'll have uh games for your cardio where you have to run like a track so to speak just to compete to get you like get get your competitive spirit going

Michael: Like to develop a new reason to get goals down

Calvin: exactly

Michael: And what do you think would keep you engaged with an app like that?

Calvin: I think cosmetics would be pretty fun like if you I know like for example a lot of online video games will reward players for you know the games like Overwatch or League where they'll offer free skins if you play uh a decent amount of time if you're if the app runs well people like it I think people would enjoy just being able to have different types of uh ways to like you

know Flex their Flex their characters or Flex their stats or something like that and get rewards from it

Michael: And how much time investment would you think would be appropriate before turning you away?

Calvin: I think there's the balance for sure I think people like investing time into things you can see that with other games like MMOs people love investing times but for the Casual audience for like you know the the majority of people I think there's there's a fine line you want to put some time in but don't feel like you're tied down to it like a job

Michael: And would you prefer this app to be on mobile or desktop, what do you think would be more convenient?

Calvin: I think it depends of the application um again going back to the running app I was talking about for that I'd you know definitely be mobile just because it makes sense.

Michael: Right, portability.

Calvin: um exactly for desktop I think you have if anything I definitely prefer if it had like a like a dual use system where you could have it on your desktop and on your mobile just depending on what you do obviously depends on what your app's focusing on as well but like say like a planner app it'd be kind of weird if I couldn't use it on the desktop as well you know

Michael: The most convenient option at the time.

Calvin: exactly

Michael: And do you use any kind of smart devices?

Calvin: Currently no.

Michael: What do you think about the app being competitive in nature? Like a leaderboard to see where you rank with your peers.

Calvin: I think friendly competition is good I think having a level of competition pushes individuals to strive for greater things you see that with I mean you see that with all these other like competitive Sports and competitive even um compare like math competitions as well where they you know you're because you're have a goal and because you know the other side is also trying the hardest you're going to push yourself to being better I feel like it's a little difficult sometimes to self motivate you know because you'll you don't have a standard to put yourself against

Michael: Right to see how well you're doing based on others.

Calvin: exactly

Michael: Well we'll end it here, thank you again for the interview.

Calvin: yeah for sure

Mitchell:

1. Brittany Lopez

[Brittany Lopez] 19:53:15

Okay, I'm ready.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:53:23

Here we go. The consent form, right?

[Brittany Lopez] 19:53:25

Mm-hmm. Yeah, I sent a consent form.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:53:36

What is your student and work status? Are you a student are you working

[Brittany Lopez] 19:53:41

I'm a student.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:53:44

Okay. And which college did you go to?

[Brittany Lopez] 19:53:50

California State, Long Beach.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:53:54

And what do you study.

[Brittany Lopez] 19:53:57

I do the, I'm in the animation pre-production program

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:54:04

How many units do you take?

[Brittany Lopez] 19:54:08

I think currently... 12 or 14.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:54:14

Would you say that's

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:54:19

How much units you usually take each semester.

[Brittany Lopez] 19:54:23

Yes.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:54:26

Would you say that's a... healthy amount of units as far as workload for you?

[Brittany Lopez] 19:54:36

Yeah. I would say so but it gets harder i think the more units you have and if you're working, it's a lot harder to balance both of those.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:54:48

Yeah. Sometimes the classes don't.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:54:52

Really represent how many units there really are.

[Brittany Lopez] 19:54:55

Yeah, and there's just a... The workload can differ from each class, like some classes i'll have maybe like four hour assignments to like a whole day of workload so it just depends

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:55:14

Okay, do you have a daily routine that you do?

[Brittany Lopez] 19:55:20

At the moment, uh. I kind of the only thing that's like really daily is making my My drinks, my morning drinks And... Which is like matcha latte It's kind of like... like a meditation in making it, but that's about it.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:55:40

Okay. Yep. Yeah, like a reason to get upset.

[Brittany Lopez] 19:55:46

Yeah.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:55:46

Would you say that like you wish you had... a more scheduled routine in the morning?

[Brittany Lopez] 19:55:55

Yes, I definitely... my like ideal routine is like waking up really early so I have time to like stretch at least 15 minutes

[Brittany Lopez] 19:56:09

And then... Probably getting ready, making breakfast, and then like making my drink But yeah, that all takes like maybe like an hour or two or more depending But I want to do all of that.

[Brittany Lopez] 19:56:23

Like ahead of time before I have any responsibilities to do So, and even ideally, I'd like to journal like first thing in the morning to wake up and like write down my thoughts Yeah.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:56:40

Okay. What else is there? Is there a specific part of the day where you feel most productive?

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:56:51

Whether that's the night or morning.

[Brittany Lopez] 19:56:55

I feel a lot more productive at night. I don't know why but I tend to have like a burst of like productivity around like 10 p.m. Sometimes or like even later Yeah.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:57:15

Okay. One second here.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:57:26

Do you use a planner? Regularly okay And do you depend on that to like prioritize how you're doing your chores and tasks throughout the week.

[Brittany Lopez] 19:57:29

Yes, I do.

[Brittany Lopez] 19:57:40

Yes. It has really helped time managing what chores what homework assignments I have to do.

[Brittany Lopez] 19:57:50

And like, just, you know, keeping track of life Because I used to do it a lot in my head and it was very like chaotic trying to remember everything that I had to do for the day or for the week.

[Brittany Lopez] 19:58:03

So being able to have that planner physically and see what I have to focus on helps.

[Brittany Lopez] 19:58:10

With the management.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:58:12

And when do you like to use the planner? Like, when do you write in it? When do you plan your day out?

[Brittany Lopez] 19:58:15

Like when?

[Brittany Lopez] 19:58:21

I usually do it... Like Sunday nights, I like to plan for the week.

[Brittany Lopez] 19:58:28

And write out like what classes i have what homework i'm probably going to be working on.

And then if I have like big assignments or big events come up, then I'll obviously write it down throughout the week.

[Brittany Lopez] 19:58:40

But usually I just sit down and plan ahead. One day out of the week.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:58:45

So it's not a day-by-day thing you You put in the whole week out.

And would you say your week pans out out the way you have it in your planner or do you end up postponing things.

[Brittany Lopez] 19:59:07

Oh, sometimes postpone things. Like if I have a hangout with friends or I have like an event, sometimes it doesn't work out and I have to like scratch that off or like when I write down when I want to clean or when I want to do chores sometimes I get backed up with homework, so I have to like rearrange it so I always have to just like readjust the planner throughout the week which is perfectly fine because nothing is set in stone. So... Yeah, I'm pretty like flexible with my planner and scheduling.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:59:48

These questions are going to be like really random. I'll explain near the end.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 19:59:54

What I'm trying to get at later. Do you use any health apps or productivity apps?

[Brittany Lopez] 19:59:54

Okay. Um... I might, like... I've seen some apps that like doing chores like a video game and that's kind of like cool for me It gives you some sort of... goal or like points if you complete your your desired task for the day or for the week so

[Brittany Lopez] 20:00:25

I might use some of those apps in the future to like really help completing the tests.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:00:32

I feel like that's what I'm struggling with is like actually effectively like executing the task that I want to do or Things like that that I write down in my planner.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:00:44

For health apps. I... I don't use any at the moment. I guess only for like... Because I'm a girl. I track, you know, the cycle kind of thing but That's the only app that I really use. I used to use like a calorie tracking app.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:01:01

Not anymore.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:01:05

Like apple or you use an iPhone Do you ever look at the... like how many steps you've taken throughout the day or anything like that.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:01:09

Yes.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:01:16

No, I don't.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:01:18

Okay. And you were saying... You struggled to... complete tasks. Would you say you struggle to start a task more or Do you struggle to finish one?

[Brittany Lopez] 20:01:35

I struggle finishing a task. I always start like a bunch of new stuff or new projects and I never am able to finish it depending on like other factors.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:01:50

I think it's because sometimes I overwhelm myself with so many new projects. Maybe that's why I'm unable to finish one So... Yeah, that's how I go about it.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:02:18

Awesome movement is a pretty popular word lately, especially with a lot of social media taking people's time would you So you're into that kind of thing.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:02:30

Where do you associate with that like self-improvement culture

[Brittany Lopez] 20:02:36

So are you saying like if I associate with the self-improvement culture on social media?

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:02:42

Yeah.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:02:43

Yeah. I actually really like that kind of content because I really want to like... you know, reach my... my potential and my potential Even if I never reach it, that's fine i just like I like to always improve.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:03:02

Myself, whether it be like spiritually, physically mentally And like with relationships Any factor that I can like improve on my life i want to improve it um so when I get feeds to like improve my diet, improve my lifestyle

[Brittany Lopez] 20:03:22

My spirituality which is like meditation or like meditation or like finding something that works with you.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:03:31

I engage with that a lot. Sometimes it could be taken 2.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:03:38

I get overwhelmed sometimes with self-improvement that I'm like. I stunned myself in shock with my... Like, I kind of... kind of get overwhelmed with so much self-improvement like videos and feed That I... I kind of just don't do anything.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:03:58

But i think i think engaging and like consuming some of that Like... Media is good, but...

Obviously, with everything in life, you have to have a balance of it So I think maybe... balance with Yeah, it's good.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:04:18

Yeah, it's hard to. It's hard to... No.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:04:26

Like all the way in, like, I feel like when people try to improve. They just try to do everything at the same time rather than take it a step at a time.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:04:33

Yeah. For sure.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:04:37

That's something I... Need to work on too, to be honest.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:04:41

Mm-hmm.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:04:45

Do you... Do you work out at all?

[Brittany Lopez] 20:04:50

At the moment, no. I can only really do walking.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:04:57

Right now, because I have a condition that i have a condition Basically, I can't really like sweat too much.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:05:05

Because my skin will be... reactive and not have a good time.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:05:11

But... Before I had this, I wanted to do like Pilates which is like It can be like high intensity, but it's more of like strength training with your own body and like it's also meditative because it's really about the mind and just you and your body and

[Brittany Lopez] 20:05:30

You could have some tools here and there but The Pilates that I like is just you And like your mind. So... Yeah.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:05:44

Okay, so it's more of like a fiscal limitation right now, at least right now at least Keeps you from working out. Okay.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:05:50

Yes. Yep.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:05:52

Now I'm going to talk about some... the apps that you use on your phone.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:05:59

What would you say like you use the most

[Brittany Lopez] 20:06:03

I use TikTok the most right now.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:06:06

And is that really the only social media that you use?

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:06:11

Regularly.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:06:12

Um... There's the occasional like instagram And let me see.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:06:20

Um... Twitch, I guess, and like youtube But I'd say TikTok takes up Like, I guess social media the most.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:06:32

Yeah. Okay. And...

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:06:40

What do you think? Regarding like TikTok, what do you think keeps you engaged.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:06:50

Like with that often.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:06:53

So definitely like the algorithm Because it's catered.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:06:57

To like you specifically and what you like. And I don't know how it is, but it does it well where... It gives you like content that I don't know caters like to your specific hobbies or goals and stuff like that

[Brittany Lopez] 20:07:12

But it's also like... you have to also make it catered towards you could by liking or sharing that kind of stuff And... Every time I see like video that's just like, I don't like it or... I don't resonate with it. I always like

[Brittany Lopez] 20:07:34

I purposely put not interested Especially with like weirder, weird videos that are like, what the heck So I think that's Like, really cringe or like... brain rot.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:07:43

What do you mean? What kind of weird videos?

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:07:52

Okay.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:07:52

I guess, you know, just like really like not useful content. I'm like, okay, this is a waste of time kind of thing. I won't I won't engage with it, but I tend to like engage more with like self-improvement or diet videos or like meal recipes or

[Brittany Lopez] 20:08:11

Small exercises or even drawing because like I love drawing and I love seeing people create stuff on there i I think that's like the most engaging thing because I also like to see people's stories and their perspective on things so I also like to see like

[Brittany Lopez] 20:08:30

A lot of people do creative projects on there. So I also really like that. So that's what keeps me engaged with the app the most.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:08:37

And I think the reason why I like TikTok the most because it's so like personal Compared to other social media apps Like you can see like people's authentic selves and like their journey and their story on there because there isn't there isn't

[Brittany Lopez] 20:08:55

Such a censorship, I guess, compared to other apps so apps Yeah, I think it's a No, I'll just stop there.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:09:04

Okay. That was good.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:09:13

If there weren't any... I read this.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:09:20

For example, you can send your friends TikToks and that kind of thing. If that wasn't even a feature and You had TikTok.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:09:34

Despite... Not any of your close friends having it, I guess you could say. Would you say you would still use it or do you think even play a factor in like your usage of tick tock or Do you think not really?

[Brittany Lopez] 20:09:49

I think not really. That's just like a bonus feature being able to like send relatable content that you and your friends would have.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:09:57

Okay.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:09:59

But because like you could still share that video outside of the app to your friends if you really wanted that.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:10:05

But I kind of use it more for like me. And like what I want.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:10:11

To see, I guess.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:10:13

Okay. And when you're not when you're not doing homework and You've finished all your schoolwork.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:10:27

Is there any other ways you like to spend your time, your free time?

[Brittany Lopez] 20:10:32

Playing video games. Is a big one.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:10:37

I like to go out with my partner. Whatever we can.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:10:43

And if my friends are available, I'd like to have like a small like get together with them to But...
My other free time would probably... be doing personal projects of mine.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:10:58

With art because I'm getting to that point in my education where I need to start.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:11:05

Thinking of a project to work on. So I'd like to start exploring concepts and stuff that I have to do.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:11:16

With art, basically. So I'd probably be working more. I'd like to spend more time like creating paintings and stuff for me And not for school or work.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:11:31

Jeff Industry.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:11:39

Is there anything else? Yeah. Actually, there is.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:11:51

Wait one second.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:12:02

Let me go back to your planner or any like productivity tools that you may use um Do you ever struggle to consistently write in your planner or would you say you're... On top of that.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:12:20

Right now. I think I'm not using it.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:12:24

Consistently and I have struggled in the past to use it consistently Like, I feel like I'm doing, I was doing better using it like every week now And it's really hard.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:12:38

To explain that mindset and like discipline and using it Every week.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:12:48

Because in the past, I used to like just write in it and then forget about it for like months and even a year.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:12:55

But I think what helps me and what really got me to stick with the planner is picking a planner that I really like aesthetically and the format that it came out with And I have like stickers, which makes it like easier to like plan out things when I don't feel like writing in it.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:13:14

So... I think having that like personalization with the planner has really made me stick with it and make it and made made me use it more So I don't know. It might be different for other people, but... for me at least for me at least

[Brittany Lopez] 20:13:31

It was the personalization and also like customizing it and customizing it buying a cool pen.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:13:41

To write in. So yeah.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:13:46

Sure.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:13:53

Anything else?

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:13:56

Yeah, there's a few more things. I'm kind of scrolling through because you have answered some questions.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:13:59

Okay.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:14:04

That I was going to ask. I don't really need to.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:14:09

Okay.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:14:15

Oh, video games. There we go. What? What kind of video games do you like to play like genre-wise?

[Brittany Lopez] 20:14:22

I like open world ones. Uh... I don't know what category it is, but, like... farming videos or not videos games where you can like farm. More chill games.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:14:34

Okay, more chill.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:14:37

Not shooter games. I think I definitely like those more like calm slice of life games.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:14:44

But I do like to do like or play uh like multiplayer games that for example you're like for example you're like in a different avatar you know It's kind of like an escapism kind of thing obviously but I like multiplayer like

[Brittany Lopez] 20:15:04

Is it like RPG? Influence there.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:15:10

Yeah.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:15:11

Games in particular.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:15:14

Um...

[Brittany Lopez] 20:15:20

Well, I like... I like this dinosaur multiplayer game.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:15:26

You know, you're a dinosaur and like other players are dinosaurs so and it's not really like violent or like there's no like any motive to it. It's mainly just like survival or like meeting people So I like that because it's kind of chill.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:15:42

That's a multiplayer game.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:15:42

But yeah. Yeah. The other games like I like indie games.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:15:49

I guess, is that a genre of indie games? In the single player games.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:15:54

Or two-player games.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:15:54

Yeah, yeah. So I would say that's mostly, would you say like you lean towards single player games or multiplayer?

[Brittany Lopez] 20:16:05

Oof.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:16:07

Or I can also say... competitive multiplay cooperative multiplayer or single player.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:16:16

I think I would do more single player. Yeah.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:16:20

Okay. Do you ever find yourself Not.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:16:28

Do you ever find yourself playing multiplayer games alone.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:16:34

Randoms, I guess, for like a better words or Do you prefer playing them with people that you do know

[Brittany Lopez] 20:16:41

I prefer playing with people I do know when it comes to multiplayer games, especially competitive.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:16:47

Like first-person shooter games When games are like competitive, I get really like scared and I guess anxiety from like anxiety not playing good enough.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:17:03

For other people. So I like to play with friends because it kind of like shields me And it gives me a little bit more confidence, even if I'm bad at playing the game to just like have fun because if I play alone in a multiplayer game, I get really...

[Brittany Lopez] 20:17:21

Like doubtful of myself and overthink scared of enjoying the game.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:17:26

And how I'm performing more than You know, having fun.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:17:32

So that defeats the purpose of playing a game to relax You know, like, you know decompress after a day of work or something.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:17:44

Do you think of yourself as competitive? No. So when you're playing with friends you would prefer to play with them versus against them.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:17:48

No, no, no.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:17:57

Or does it matter?

[Brittany Lopez] 20:17:57

Yeah, yeah. It doesn't matter, but... I guess I'll lean towards more like I want to play with my friends rather than against.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:18:08

Okay.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:18:13

Zoom's being stupid. No, I'm good.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:18:16

No. Okay.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:18:35

Find yourself I've been buying cosmetics and video games.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:18:41

Oh, yeah. That's like my biggest... selling point, I think.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:18:47

If I can customize my character or like even my house or like Things that I can like control I guess. Or like... that you need in the game, I would always love to customize it.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:18:48

Okay.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:19:03

Especially since I'm like, I guess an artist or a creative i like to like make things cute or just make things nice So I will definitely like buy a cosmetic and a game to buy a game be more cute or aesthetic.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:19:22

And cater to my tastes and interests. Because I also feel like it also tells people's personality.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:19:30

I think, yeah, I think that's why I like cosmetics Yeah, yeah.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:19:31

Yeah. Like a form of expression in a way.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:19:38

Okay. And just... cosmetics, does that include like Battle passes and that kind of thing.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:19:48

Okay.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:19:49

Yeah.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:19:59

You'll say like the fear of missing out. Does that ever, do you think that affects you at all like getting a skin before... That's not available anymore or that kind of thing.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:20:15

Yeah, I used to be like that. Like, oh, the skin, especially if like... the skin or like the cosmetic is really cool and like i like actually like i like it and not You know, from like, oh, it's a rare skin or a rare thing you should get it

[Brittany Lopez] 20:20:32

I always consider like, do I actually like it and would i actually use it In the game or whatever.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:20:33

Yeah.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:20:39

Before I ever, ever, like, consider, like, oh. Okay, I'll just get it.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:20:46

So I don't really factor like fear of missing out on cosmetics.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:20:52

When it comes to like games I only get it if I really want it.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:21:02

Spending money on

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:21:08

Game or software Versus getting whatever software game for free and then spending a premium.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:21:21

Which one would you say you... for early towards.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:21:26

Sorry, you cut out a little bit. So I'm just going to repeat You said if I prefer... buying like a console

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:21:29

Okay. I'm done.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:21:37

No, I mean... Pretty simple like buying a video game or any software with a flat out price.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:21:42

Mm-hmm.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:21:45

Versus you know the more modern standard of getting a game or software for free and then buying a premium Or... Which one would you say that you... lean towards or do you have any opinions on one or the other?

[Brittany Lopez] 20:21:48

Oh. A game.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:21:54

Oh, I see.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:22:06

Um... I prefer at least buying the game at a set price if it's completed.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:22:15

Fully and like fully If future updates are like given That'd be cool. I love that.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:22:24

I don't like when games are like... you buy the game and then on top of that.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:22:32

Like a DLC comes out, you have to pay for it again.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:22:34

But I also understand like you have to pay the artist that worked on that and blah, blah, blah.

So... And the team that made it.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:22:43

So but when it comes to like free games and then you have to pay for content, I hate that.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:22:49

I don't know. It's just like... you advertise it.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:22:53

Does that include cosmetics too like So yeah, you have a negative view towards I can't really think it became that.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:22:56

Yeah.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:23:04

Off the pipeline. Okay.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:23:04

I do. I have one like Wizard 101. It's like, it like advertises oh it's free From the start, but you have to pay like for anything else, including cosmetics and stuff like that. You're limited to like a certain area in the game and you can't really like finish it or, you know, expand unless you pay

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:23:08

Okay.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:23:28

So that's like a negative like a negative That's what I don't like.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:23:33

Because you can't even enjoy the full extent of the game.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:23:36

Without paying. So that's why I don't like that. But if it's a game where like... You pay for it and then you have like a lot of, you can basically enjoy the game then I'm okay towards.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:23:51

And if they, for example, still offer like expansions or like other stuff outside of it then that's like it gives you a choice when you have a choice to do like... Other.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:24:06

Expansions or cosmetics. That's cool.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:24:10

Okay, let me wear this right. I just realized I can wear this right. I like... Win games.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:24:17

Let you enjoy the game without paying. If that makes sense.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:24:22

When they make it clear okay You can pay for it and enjoy the whole game.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:24:27

Or... You can play for free but you have you're only paying for like cosmetics, not like actual like world or story

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:24:37

What did 101 lying to you and saying that it's all free okay

[Brittany Lopez] 20:24:40

Yeah, yeah. I hate that, basically. Just Wizard 101, the way they did that. No, that's not good.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:24:46

Okay, what about like Overwatch 1.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:24:55

You paid for that game. But then I also had the loot boxes or You know, whatever they have.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:24:57

Mm-hmm.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:25:03

Mm-hmm.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:25:03

I'm also asking that question, like if you've already paid for the base game you don't want, do you prefer they don't have?

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:25:11

Cosmetics like that you would have to pay for on top of that

[Brittany Lopez] 20:25:14

Yeah, I don't. But I know a lot of people like it because it's like, ooh, you more stuff to customize or show off your you know your interests through the game.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:25:26

But I would do not prefer because I'm kind of like... I guess, you know, like... Money... Anxiety, blah.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:25:36

There's like exclusivity, I guess, yeah.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:25:37

Yeah, I'm like, I... I don't want to spend money on stuff that I won't actually use or need. And if like The game is pushing out like, oh, you should get loot boxes and blah, blah, blah, or whatever It feels stingy from the game to like

[Brittany Lopez] 20:25:55

Greedy and it comes off as like they're money hungry and they want money from players rather than like you know there's just like a tone And it comes, especially how they advertise like these expansions or cosmetics it can either be good or bad.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:26:18

Yeah.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:26:19

Okay. This question basically, do you have any smart devices besides your iPhone?

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:26:29

For example, like a smartwatch Or anything like that.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:26:33

I don't have a watch. I have, I guess, an iPad.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:26:37

Um, but... I'm trying to think.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:26:42

No, I don't think I do.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:26:45

And do you have a laptop or a desktop?

[Brittany Lopez] 20:26:50

I have a computer desktop. But that's it.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:26:55

That was all. Thank you, Brittany for taking the time it was like half an hour of questions I appreciate it.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:26:57

Cool.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:27:03

That's okay. You're welcome.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:27:08

Thank you. Bye.

[Mitchell Flanagan] 20:27:09

Thank you. Okay.

[Brittany Lopez] 20:27:15

Okay, I'm going to leave now.

2. Sara Barth-Yi

17:33:25 Okay. Okay, are you currently a student?

[Sara] 17:33:29 I am. I go to UC Davis.

17:33:30 And what college did you go to? Okay. And how many units are you taking right now?

[Sara] 17:33:37 I'm taking 16.

17:33:39 Would you say that's... the amount of units you usually take in a semester.

[Sara] 17:33:45 And a quarter, yeah. Quarters. Yep.

17:33:46 And a quarter. And are you working? Okay.

[Sara] 17:33:50 No.

17:33:58 Do you have a daily routine that you do every morning?

17:34:02 And what does that look like?

[Sara] 17:34:02 Yes. Um... I usually... make my bed when I get up.

[Sara] 17:34:12 And... try and get something to eat. Usually I like stored like stuff in my room so I don't have to go upstairs to the kitchen to get stuff Like protein bars and stuff.

17:34:20 Okay.

[Sara] 17:34:23 I'll eat quickly. And then do like my like hygiene stuff Catch the bus.

[Sara] 17:34:30 Go to class, etc.

17:34:35 All the necessities. Would you say you follow that routine Consistently.

[Sara] 17:34:43 Yeah, unless I skip class, then I don't but Yes.

17:34:47 Okay. Okay, good.

[Sara] 17:34:54 And how do you track your daily routine? Do you use a planner at all?

[Sara] 17:34:59 Not for daily things, but for weekly things I do.

17:35:04 Okay, so what would your planner look like? Do you... Do you write stuff in the beginning of the week and you just kind of follow through with it or how often do you use it?

[Sara] 17:35:15 I use the Notion software. So I'll usually outline the things I need to get done for school in a week.

17:35:19 Okay.

[Sara] 17:35:24 And yeah.

17:35:27 And why do you choose Notion over like a physical fiscal planner.

[Sara] 17:35:32 Um because I'm kind of a perfectionist when it comes to like writing things like physically I'm really bad at journaling because I would never like how my handwriting turned out. So I think just like using a software first of all

[Sara] 17:35:46 It's just easier. It's quicker. I'm not worried about how my handwriting looks.

[Sara] 17:35:51 And I can just have it on my laptop or my phone so I don't have to bring like an extra notebook or anything.

17:35:52 Yeah.

17:35:58 Okay. That makes sense. And do you change Do you update your planner often like something you have on a particular day you ended up like changing it Is that? Okay.

17:36:10 Yeah. Yep.

17:36:13 Good, good. Do you find it hard to follow through with the stuff that you put on notion

[Sara] 17:36:23 Yes, but I eventually will get it done. Like I'll, I'll push it back.

[Sara] 17:36:28 I'll like move I'll move it to a different day. I'll be like, oh, I could just do this on this day instead.

[Sara] 17:36:35 Which is just procrastination, but I do get it done.

17:36:38 Okay. You'd say it's more procrastination, but do you think you like bite off more than you can chew?

[Sara] 17:36:44 No.

17:36:48 Okay. And... And what about working out? Do you work out at all or have any form of physical activity.

[Sara] 17:37:03 I do go to the barn every couple days a week.

[Sara] 17:37:06 There's that. But otherwise, not really. Mostly just walking, but that's it.

17:37:11 Wait, you go to the barn? What does that even mean?

[Sara] 17:37:13 Yeah, I mean, I go ride horses. A couple days a week.

17:37:16 Oh, sorry. Okay.

17:37:23 And have you been to a gym before?

[Sara] 17:37:26 Briefly, a couple of years ago.

17:37:32 And... And what makes you... Was there something unappealing about working out that didn't make you come back to it or going to the gym in particular?

[Sara] 17:37:48 Yeah, I just got busy but also Like, I have always like gym anxiety so it's not always like the most It's a very daunting thing to do.

17:38:00 Yeah.

[Sara] 17:38:00 So I end up just either doing stuff at home or going outside. I don't really go to the gym.

17:38:07 Okay, that makes sense. Sorry, these questions are going to be all over the place. Sometimes I might go back to something.

[Sara] 17:38:14 Okay. Okay.

17:38:17 Do you know your screen time on your phone? Do you check it?

[Sara] 17:38:20 Yeah. Um... not as often as I used to. I used to try and be like really good about it, but Not so much anymore.

17:38:32 Okay. Is that because you're you're... pretty good about it and you don't worry about it as much.

[Sara] 17:38:37 No I've given up trying to be good at it.

17:38:41 Okay. I mean... I don't know what you call being good at it because it's good.

[Sara] 17:38:50 Oh. Yeah, I think I'm a lot better Yeah, I don't like, I don't really play video games anymore so I guess my screen time is better than that.

17:39:02 Okay. And when you have free time, we'll What do you like to do?

[Sara] 17:39:10 Um... scroll on my phone. I like to watch YouTube and stuff, TV shows.

[Sara] 17:39:20 Yeah, read. Do homework. That's not really on free time though.

17:39:19 Okay.

17:39:26 Then you say go to the bind that you call that free time too. Okay.

[Sara] 17:39:28 Yeah, I go to the barn too. Yeah.

17:39:31 Um... Okay, so video games you said you used to do, you don't really do anymore.
That's purely just a time thing.

17:39:41 And when you were playing video games, what kind of games did you like to play?

[Sara] 17:39:40 Yeah.

[Sara] 17:39:46 Well, there was Overwatch. And there's some like MMOs that i've played, like Black Desert and like Lost Ark.

[Sara] 17:39:56 Yeah, I like playing The Sims sometimes like minecraft etc.

17:40:02 Would you say you gravitate towards multiplayer games more or single player?

[Sara] 17:40:06 I gravitate towards single player but like not like like Elden Ring or anything like that like super casual single player games yeah So you're like, relax.

17:40:13 More chill. Yeah.

17:40:19 And the multiplayer games that you do play with Overwatch Do you usually solo queue or do you play Do you prefer to play with friends?

[Sara] 17:40:28 I prefer playing with friends.

17:40:29 Okay. When you play video games, do you feel non-productive when you're playing them?

[Sara] 17:40:37 Yeah.

17:40:38 Okay. Okay, good, good, good.

17:40:48 Do you ever feel overwhelmed by the goals that you set on yourself?

[Sara] 17:40:56 Wow. Sometimes... I think most of the time not. I think it depends.

[Sara] 17:41:06 I was like, oh, shit.

17:41:03 Sorry, I guess that's a lot deeper of a question than I... When I said it, it doesn't have to be that

[Sara] 17:41:11 Are you my therapist? Like, what? I mean, like school wise No.

[Sara] 17:41:21 Yeah, I don't know. I'm like at a place where like, I don't really have a lot of like... goals in mind just because I just don't know what I want to do after it graduates. It's a little bit like foggy right now.

17:41:36 Hmm.

[Sara] 17:41:37 No, I don't usually set like crazy goals for myself.

17:41:42 Okay. Um... What else?

17:41:53 Um...

17:42:00 Sorry, I got a few which questions I don't feel like asking.

17:42:16 And as far as gaming, you prefer using your desktop over like mobile games.

[Sara] 17:42:22 Oh, yeah.

17:42:23 You don't play any mobile games, do you?

[Sara] 17:42:27 No. Sometimes I'll play like Balatro on my phone, but that's also on the desktop. So it's like.

[Sara] 17:42:31 Does it really?

17:42:34 And for Notion, but you use... your phone for Notion. You don't ever go on your computer and use it.

[Sara] 17:42:39 No, I use it on my computer. I only use it on my phone if like... I'm on the bus or something and I want to review something.

[Sara] 17:42:46 But that's it.

17:42:48 And do you have any... Smart devices besides your phone, like a smartwatch or anything like that?

[Sara] 17:42:55 I do. I have an Apple Watch.

17:42:59 Okay. What kind of things do you like to track on your smartwatch?

[Sara] 17:43:07 Recently, I haven't been good about wearing it, but usually I'll track things like my steps and like calories burned and things like that.

17:43:16 And do you think they really help with your daily routine or your daily routine productivity or is it just kind of indifferent.

[Sara] 17:43:27 I think it is a bit indifferent for me, at least.

[Sara] 17:43:30 Just because, I don't know. It doesn't it doesn't change how I like behave.

17:43:36 Okay.

[Sara] 17:43:35 It's just something to see, like something to track but it doesn't change like i won't like walk more if I see that my steps are down or whatever.

17:43:42 Hmm. Yeah, that's... Okay, I'll get into that later.

17:43:52 And how do you like to socialize? Do you use social media apps at all?

[Sara] 17:43:58 Um not to like chat with people.

[Sara] 17:44:02 Usually. Just to scroll.

17:44:05 Okay. And do you use any subscriptions specifically with With games at all?

[Sara] 17:44:14 No.

17:44:16 Yep. And with like Overwatch... arc survival or any of those games have you paid for any cosmetics ever?

17:44:29 Okay. And what about... I don't know if she's listening.

[Sara] 17:44:35 Okay, well... Ask her if I've ever bought cosmetics or anything in like in a game.

17:44:37 Are you listening right now? A little bit.

17:44:43 I asked her if she's ever bought cosmetics and anything. She said, girl, Genshin.

[Sara] 17:44:51 Yeah.

17:44:52 And what about Battle Passes? Ever buy them?

[Sara] 17:44:55 Um... Maybe I have like for Overwatch, maybe once or twice, but usually I don't finish them so There's no point.

17:45:05 Um... Okay. And what about... cosmetics.

17:45:13 What do you think attracts you to buying cosmetics? Is it a fear of missing out kind of thing? Do you like the form of expression?

[Sara] 17:45:27 Yeah.

[Sara] 17:45:22 Wow, this is like this is like... I don't like dig into like old me because I wouldn't do that now I don't think I would ever buy like a cosmetic Like right now, but definitely like a year ago, I totally would have been like

[Sara] 17:45:34 Absolutely. I definitely... One, if it's on a timed like event, I would be like, I have to get it before If the time runs out or like everybody else has it And then expression, definitely. I remember like if it like

[Sara] 17:45:51 I just like the visuals of it. I was like I really wanted it.

[Sara] 17:45:57 I got this oh god i have this, that one stupid like Reese's skin. I don't even like play Aretha.

17:46:08 Do you regret... most of the cosmetics that you've bought?

[Sara] 17:46:13 Yes.

17:46:14 Okay. And...

17:46:20 And like nowadays. Now that you wouldn't really buy any of those type of things, do you have a sentiment towards spending money on games at all?

[Sara] 17:46:33 Definitely. I think I'm like more aware of it now. And so I like to wait for a sale. I'm not so impulsive on my purchases anymore.

17:46:46 Gotcha. That's good. I don't have too many more questions.

17:46:52 Let me see.

17:46:58 Most helpful decision. Okay, there's this Google Doc and there's some questions that my teammates wrote on here that I have no idea what they're talking about.

[Sara] 17:47:09 When is this due? Question mark It's your senior project, right?

17:47:15 It's due on Tuesday, but it's like a two semester class.

[Sara] 17:47:18 What do you mean Stu on Tuesday? Just the interview stuff?

17:47:23 Okay.

[Sara] 17:47:22 Just the interview stuff, yeah. No. So this semester is just planning everything and figuring out what we want to do basically and then the next semester is the next semester coding it.

17:47:40 Yeah. So we would, yeah, we would finish it in the fall.

[Sara] 17:47:36 Wait, you're in spring semester question right now? Okay, so it would be... fall for Oh. Plus, you have another year. Okay.

17:47:51 Yeah. Um...

17:48:07 Oh, are there subscriptions that you use besides gaming like a Netflix account or anything like that?

[Sara] 17:48:12 I'm on my family's accounts. So I don't pay for it.

17:48:16 Okay. And what about music? Do you use Spotify or anything like that?

[Sara] 17:48:17 But yes, we have a lot. Yeah, again, we're a shared family account, so that's also Yeah, I don't pay for it.

17:48:27 Okay.

17:48:31 Okay, that's pretty much it.

17:48:36 Yeah, we have this project but The problem is, is like, how do we I'm kind of iffy on it because... how do you make sure people are like doing their chores.

[Sara] 17:48:53 Well, you got to reward them, right?

17:48:55 Yeah, you reward them, but they could just lie about their chores.

[Sara] 17:49:00 And say that they did it when they really didn't. And they're just doing it for the sake of

[Sara] 17:49:02 But like if if they're like on their own, I feel like Who just lies just to get like a little Lord. I mean... Yeah, I don't know. It was just me.

17:49:13 We want to add the... I mean, one thing I was thinking or brittany kind of said this idea too is this idea too if it kind of functioned like be real.

17:49:24 Oh. Oh.

17:49:23 Or not be real uh locket. So you would send the things that you do to other people.

[Sara] 17:49:31 I see. Maybe like, oh, I don't know.

17:49:38 So if you said like you folded your laundry, but you just have a picture of like your ceiling it's like bruh.

[Sara] 17:49:44 Well, then you get like you get like the little achievement designs They're cute.

17:49:50 And then the other thing was making a character based off of like getting data from the Apple Watch, whether that's like burning calories or steps or anything like that.

[Sara] 17:50:05 Oh, like that, like, like the we fit used to do?

17:50:06 But... Yeah.

[Sara] 17:50:14 Okay, cool.

17:50:12 Okay. That was it. Okay, thank you. It's kind of hard to get people, but I appreciate that you We're here.

[Sara] 17:50:20 Of course. I want to see the final product. I'm curious.

17:50:24 Yeah. Now, yeah.

3. Michael Christiansen

23:49:25 Perfect. Right. And did you do the consent form?

23:49:31 By the way. Okay, forward. Okay, I'll begin.

[Michael] 23:49:31 I did do the consent form, yes.

23:49:36 Are you a student? Currently.

[Michael] 23:49:39 Currently, yes. Currently, yes.

23:49:42 Okay. And are you working? How many units are you taking?

23:49:49 For school.

[Michael] 23:49:49 Uh... Right now... off the top of my head.

[Michael] 23:49:56 I couldn't tell you. I'd have to pull it up.

23:49:58 Or like how many units do you usually take? In a semester.

[Michael] 23:50:03 Usually 8-10.

23:50:05 Okay. And how often do you work?

[Michael] 23:50:12 Pretty much every day. Almost every day, almost every day.

23:50:15 Really? Do you work morning shifts?

[Michael] 23:50:20 No.

23:50:21 Okay. How often do you get scheduled? Do you have one job or two?

[Michael] 23:50:28 One job.

23:50:29 Okay. Do you have a... daily routine or do you just kind of play it by ear.

[Michael] 23:50:37 Yeah, yeah. Daily routine would most likely be getting up getting ready for the day. And then if I do work I would have my stuff in place set for a certain time. I set myself a time where I would have myself starting getting ready. Like, for example, if I was to work at 12 o'clock

[Michael] 23:50:58 I'd take 11 o'clock throughout to figure everything out, what I need for work, what I need to eat, do anything like that.

[Michael] 23:51:06 To get myself ready.

23:51:08 So your daily routine just depends on like When you work, yeah. Okay.

[Michael] 23:51:11 What's going on that day. Yeah, or school in general, of course, I'll get up and Get ready for school or anything like that.

[Michael] 23:51:18 Same thing.

23:51:18 Gotcha. Would you say you you keep... track with your daily routine pretty well.

23:51:27 Keep track as like physically no but I usually try and keep the same type of momentum and rhythm throughout the week.

23:51:36 If it's the same kind of... process.

23:51:40 Okay. What part of the day do you feel most productive? Is that the morning or night?

[Michael] 23:51:47 Night. Night, 100%.

23:51:48 Okay.

23:51:53 Everything. I'm going to skip that question.

23:52:03 Do you use any... Actually, I'll wait for later on that.

23:52:10 Do you use a planner?

[Michael] 23:52:13 Not a physical one, no.

[Michael] 23:52:19 No.

23:52:16 Okay. Do you use an app for a planar ever? Okay. Do you have any like health or productivity apps that you ever use?

[Michael] 23:52:28 Not apps that i use but i use Do you keep physical?

23:52:33 Okay. And what's that look like?

[Michael] 23:52:36 Treadmill.

23:52:38 There you go.

23:52:50 And how often do you use the treadmill.

[Michael] 23:52:58 Like twice a week, daily, or how often would you say?

[Michael] 23:53:02 Depends on what depends on the day, of course, but And depends on the work and school schedule but usually Depends on how it works because I would do it more at night.

[Michael] 23:53:16 So not daily, but not like every other day.

23:53:20 Okay. Um... And I'm going to go back to that health and productivity apps. Why would you say you don't use it?

23:53:29 Do you think they don't really work well or you just don't care?

[Michael] 23:53:35 I... Honestly, probably just haven't thought about trying and using one.

[Michael] 23:53:42 Haven't found one that maybe I could actually use for myself.

[Michael] 23:53:47 Yeah, and also, I guess... There's like Apple watches and stuff so If you don't have it, then it's like there's no big deal.

23:53:54 Yeah.

23:53:58 Um...

23:54:06 What do you like to do in your free time?

[Michael] 23:54:10 Video games. We'll go with just normal answer.

23:54:16 And what kind of video games do you like to play?

[Michael] 23:54:14 Play the day games?

[Michael] 23:54:20 Big variety. Shooters, strategy.

[Michael] 23:54:28 And just indie games in general. Wide variety.

23:54:34 Okay. Would you say when you play video games, do you ever... feel non-productive when you're playing them or Do you feel more indifferent?

[Michael] 23:54:44 Yes and no. Depending on what type of game I'm playing, I could feel that I'm just kind of wasting away, but then other times I feel like I accomplished something.

23:54:57 Okay. And would you say you... You prefer... Single player games or multiplayer more?

[Michael] 23:55:07 Depending on what the type of genre is, I can go either way, but most of the time multiplayer.

23:55:14 Okay. And when you're doing multiplayer, do you Do you prefer playing them um like solo queue or... Do you prefer to play with friends?

[Michael] 23:55:26 Preferably with friends.

23:55:29 Okay.

23:55:38 Let me shoot.

23:55:49 Sorry, some of these questions that some of these questions My teammates are kind of stupid.

23:55:55 But...

[Michael] 23:55:55 You can ask them if you want. I can try to. I'll pass if it's... too complicated or not worth answering.

23:56:03 Unless you want me to answer.

23:56:04 Um... No, it's fine. I'll like give some context to why I'm answering or asking you.

[Michael] 23:56:11 Okay.

23:56:11 Later. Do you... Do you use any subscription services for games or productivity?

[Michael] 23:56:21 Absolutely. You said you don't use them, but games, I guess.

23:56:25 Um...

23:56:28 That could be Battle Pass. As well. Okay.

[Michael] 23:56:31 Yes. Yes.

23:56:38 Gotcha. And... What would you say about Battle Passes that or any subscriptions that gravitates you towards buying them.

[Michael] 23:56:52 If... If I can... Like, for example, one of the main ones I have is from Destiny.

[Michael] 23:57:04 And it feel it kind of in a way makes a goal for me that i can Like I have a time frame to complete this and it makes me want to complete it.

[Michael] 23:57:14 Because I know that I've already put in the time and effort and money into that game.

23:57:21 Okay, so you would say like the fear of missing out?

23:57:24 Could play a factor. Okay.

[Michael] 23:57:26 That could be a factor, yeah.

23:57:31 And I've interviewed some other people that when they ask answer this question, it's

23:57:39 They say they that they like cosmetics because... In some ways, it's like a form of expression.

23:57:47 Where you have something that other people don't have. Yeah.

[Michael] 23:57:50 100%. That's also that could be that is also another reason why I do it.

23:57:57 Okay. Do you have any subscriptions outside of gaming?

[Michael] 23:58:06 Like, for example?

23:58:08 It could be anything, anything software related, whether that's like Netflix

[Michael] 23:58:13 Yes. Okay. Yeah, I have Netflix.

[Michael] 23:58:18 I don't own... it, but my family has my family has A couple other descriptions like Prime Video.

[Michael] 23:58:31 And some of the other ones that are like in the same realm of that.

[Michael] 23:58:35 I have a Crunchyroll subscription. But that's partnered.

[Michael] 23:58:42 And then like other things like that, then, yeah.

23:58:47 And what about mobile apps? Do you play games on mobile at all?

23:58:54 And do you get subscriptions off of any mobile games.

[Michael] 23:58:53 Yes.

[Michael] 23:58:58 Not as much as I would say the other two, but yes there is a couple that I do.

23:59:04 Okay. So if there was For example, a game that had... You buy it flat out.

[Michael] 23:59:13 Mm-hmm.

23:59:14 Versus... Versus a free game, but it has a battle pass or it has some subscription service which do you think you would... you would more likely buy.

[Michael] 23:59:29 Personally, I don't think... To me, it matters whether the game is free or paid.

[Michael] 23:59:36 For example overwatch, that game was originally a paid game And that is now a free game. And I would have paid for a battle pass on both But I would primarily say that it's more... I would more lean onto free games

[Michael] 23:59:56 Because since they're classified as free, I didn't pay for the game so it's some type of way of support for that game.

00:00:05 Okay. In Overwatch 1, what got you to buy that game in the first place?

[Michael] 00:00:12 Just the originality of it. And it stemmed from the game from Team Fortress 2.

[Michael] 00:00:18 That I previously played constantly and everything like that. And it was the same kind of genre And I was interested in it and my friends were interested and so we all Got that.

[Michael] 00:00:30 The game's still running till today. Unfortunately.

00:00:34 Okay. Okay, I'm going to shift my focus to Productivity a little more. Would you say you ever feel overwhelmed um maybe the goals you have on yourself Yes. Would you say that's pretty often?

[Michael] 00:00:55 Yes.

[Michael] 00:00:59 I wouldn't per se it pretty often, but it's potentially sometimes i don't want to say always a thought in the back of my mind But sometimes if, depending on the situation I'm currently in.

[Michael] 00:01:09 Could stem it out or not. But it is just something I thought about.

00:01:14 And is it more like self-inflicted or is it more what people put onto you?

00:01:14 And struggled with.

[Michael] 00:01:22 Both, I would say. I don't know about equally both, but I couldn't say one or the other.

[Michael] 00:01:29 If I had to pick one, probably self-inflicted.

00:01:35 Or like societal standards, I guess, that can fall into other people's

[Michael] 00:01:38 That too. That too, but that doesn't... I don't think that one bothers me as much.

00:01:46 Okay.

00:01:56 One second, I'm going to look at something here.

00:02:22 I mean, that's pretty much it. Do you use... Do you use any smart devices besides your iPhone, like a smartwatch or iPad or anything like that?

[Michael] 00:02:34 I have a smartwatch and I does AirPods count Or... Yeah, I would, yeah. Bluetooth headphones.

00:02:38 Sure, yeah.

[Michael] 00:02:44 And an Apple Watch. I believe would be the main thing. I own a lot of consoles. I wouldn't know if that would count.

00:02:50 But I do own quite a few consoles.

00:02:56 Okay. And... Have you been to the gym before?

[Michael] 00:03:02 Yes. Not anytime soon, no.

00:03:04 Do you still currently go to the gym?

00:03:09 Okay. And what stopped you from going to the gym anymore.

[Michael] 00:03:14 Um... I was going with... a group of people and friends.

[Michael] 00:03:21 That kind of spurt out a little bit. But now I currently am just have my home stuff that I do.

00:03:28 Okay. And you would say you're you're... your, I guess, positively influenced by your friends.

00:03:41 Yeah, yeah.

00:03:46 Okay, yeah, that's pretty much it. So me and my group are... making app for a senior project.

[Michael] 00:03:59 Mm-hmm.

00:03:59 I'm not like... that on board about it, but everyone else wants to make a like a gamifying productivity app.

[Michael] 00:04:11 A gamifying productivity app. Interesting.

00:04:15 So... I mean, I would be cool with it if it was like If we used the data from like an apple watch

00:04:25 Mm-hmm.

00:04:27 If we use data from Apple Watch, like the steps or the calories you burned, and then it would be kind of like an RPG where you have your own character And you get things based off of You know... Yeah.

[Michael] 00:04:39 It could be like stats. The amount of different things you do, you get like put into different stats for like a RPG character

00:04:51 Okay.

00:04:50 Yeah. Yeah, yeah. So yeah, that's what I want to do. I would kind of want to lean towards the fitness thing of it, but they want to do more, uh.

[Michael] 00:04:59 The gaming aspect?

00:05:02 Um... I mean, I guess that too, but more about like doing chores or like stuff besides fitness.

[Michael] 00:05:14 I see.

00:05:15 Like like a planner, but... I don't know, you got customization and ****.

[Michael] 00:05:23 I think there's definitely more of a... lesser market for the fitness one?

00:05:35 Yeah.

[Michael] 00:05:32 Compared to the chore one. Because I've seen like ads of like applications where Oh, you do this small little thing and you get points for it or whatever.

00:05:49 No, I haven't used one, so I don't know how they work, but I was just thinking like how How do you check?

[Michael] 00:05:59 Legit, legit.

00:05:56 When people are actually doing like, I don't know, holding laundry or Or they could just say they're doing it and then just min-max.

[Michael] 00:06:05 I mean, you could you could do like a way that when you're doing the activity or whatever that you have to record yourself and then you can like make a program to where it tracks you doing the certain type of activity. Like for example.

[Michael] 00:06:22 Like folding laundry like you could try to work and you're attracting you to like how you fold the laundry like how you fold a shirt. If it tracks you doing that in that right position, then it'll say, okay, that's completed.

[Michael] 00:06:34 She can't like fake it.

00:06:35 Right. Okay. So you're like implementing ai into

[Michael] 00:06:40 I don't know about AI, more like I guess, but I don't know. I don't know. I don't know specifically if that would be ai that's more like coding where it's like tracking your movements into a certain rotation, I guess.

[Michael] 00:06:57 Or a certain motion into doing i don't know if that's ai though I wouldn't really call that AI, I don't think.

00:06:56 Yeah, yeah, I know what you're saying. Yeah, it's kind of like... I forget what the word is. It's like facial recognition, but... Okay.

[Michael] 00:07:06 Yeah, it's like that.

00:07:09 Yeah, that's kind of what I was thinking. You could also like there could be a social aspect out of it too. Like if you do something, then you take a photo and then You... You post it, basically.

[Michael] 00:07:27 I would think, honestly, I feel like your ***, your side is a lot of more easier and better because like, for example, like you could have it where you video yourself like say you have to do 10 sit-ups, 10 pushups and like 10 crunches. And like you put videos of you're doing this and you get

[Michael] 00:07:48 Like performance on based on like say for example like say you're not good at push-ups, but you're good at sit-ups And like it tracks like how perfect a sit up or push-up you can do And then it like say like

[Michael] 00:08:03 Your your form is... is 90% on a crunch, your form is... 70% on a push-up, here's how you can elevate it and And then it sends you like a video of like how to do a proper pushup or something like that

00:08:20 Hmm. Okay.

[Michael] 00:08:21 Because that can motivate you like and then so they you can like that could be like a game where like, okay, like, for example, like karaoke or like a dance like a dance game like Beat Saber, like how many

[Michael] 00:08:33 Hits you get like perfect hit or like beat karaoke, how perfect you are in singing that song like how perfect was your push-up And you'd get like a rating like a 70%, 60%.

[Michael] 00:08:44 And then by tracking you, you doing it yourself and then helping you fix it.

[Michael] 00:08:48 With like proper form and stuff with like videos or like techniques and stuff like that.

00:08:53 Yeah, that's interesting. That would work really well with if you're working out at home.

[Michael] 00:09:01 Yeah, it would be it would be...

00:09:01 Or I guess if you're comfortable enough to have a camera out or in a gym but

[Michael] 00:09:07 Yeah, I mean, it would be good. It would be good either way because one, it could help you in the gym if you want to be in your corner and like, but still be at the gym.

[Michael] 00:09:17 And then potentially someone else could help you if that or at your home gym or home where you can do it in the confines of your home and Where you can just get like one-on-one with practically yourself

00:09:30 Yeah. It's basically a coach in itself. Okay.

[Michael] 00:09:33 Yeah, you can make an you can make it pretty much an app that becomes your personal coach.

00:09:41 I like that. I'm gonna have to... I'm going to have to write that down and See what they think about it.

00:09:57 Okay, so that is it. Thank you!

Erick:

1. Marwin Gonzales

Erick Mao-Espionza: Okay, it's recording all right. Hello my name is Erick Mao and we're conducting user research for my 491 senior project so I just wanted to brief you on what we are planning on doing as we've just develop that idea and just some core functionalities so what we plan on making is a productivity game so It'll have some game-like features implemented onto like productivity like having like an avatar or having some RPG elements to give it like help with those mundane tasks. So I just want to start off by asking you your name and your age and if you're currently a student or if you're working or both.

Marwin G. : Okay, so my name is Marin Gonzalez; my age is 22 and currently graduated but unemployed.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay so you're in the transitioning point so congrats on graduating. Let's see, can you just briefly describe how you would go about your daily routine? Are there any specific parts of the day where you feel the most productive or are there any parts where you find yourself struggling to focus?

Marwin G. : Yeah so I usually wake up around 8-9 and then during that time like the first like three hours or so I'm pretty productive and I feel like the most motivated to do stuff but towards like the afternoon beginning after lunch maybe I start to get pretty lazy and not so productive and I just kind of sit down maybe like watch a bunch of YouTube or play a game and stuff but definitely not like going outside and stuff and then towards the night time I'm also a little more productive but not so much as the first few hours when I wake up.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: I feel it, like it comes and goes yeah on how the day goes. Um on like on a daily basis it can be challenging to balance different goals and tasks that you have and like. What can make it difficult?

Marwin G. : Yeah for sure, so yeah I could see it because so far i've just been staying home so it's kind of hard to motivate myself to just get out there yeah and start I guess like yeah just going outside trying to move more yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: So when it comes to prioritizing tasks is there a specific way you have going about it on a daily basis or like just throughout the week?

Marwin G. : Um yeah probably, for certain tasks I do like to have them for certain days so like Sunday I do try to go out to play basketball with some friends and for Wednesdays I try to do grocery shopping for my family stuff like I have like certain days where I try I set a goal.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: like for that is like is it like do you use a product like some form of productivity app or like a calendar?

Marwin G. : Yeah no not at all.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: So, it's just like a mental like you make mental notes. Okay um it's kind of similar to what we're trying to do like some elements of health and the productivity space is like are there any health apps that you used currently or used in the past?

Marwin G. : I have used um this app it's called I don't know if you've heard of Finch it's like a small little bird companion app and you basically like when you do a certain task like brush your teeth wash your face you get like you can say you've done it and it rewards some stuff for your little bird and then if you do throughout a few days in the week then your bird like grows up with you.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay that's interesting, I'd have to look into that um is that like a mobile app or is it on desktop?

Marwin G. : Yes, it's a mobile app. I'm not too sure if it's on the desktop but the mobile seems like it's the easiest.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: okay and just is there anything about that gravitated to use it like what makes it easy for you to use?

Marwin G. : The UI is pretty simple and it is eye appealing because it's like a cutesy little bird character and yeah it's just simple to use like the buttons are very intuitive like you just press a button and he and the bird just like you know goes and stuff like that it's like fairly simple to use.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay and do you feel like that app helps you feel productive or achieve your goals that you have set?

Marwin G. : Yeah because like um when I did use the app and I claimed any kind of like goal I did the bird would be all happy and stuff and I felt like I was taking care of that bird so yeah it did like help me through that play yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: okay that's good to know um when it comes to like your engagement with those type of apps and just apps in general in general what keeps like what do you what keeps you engaged with with like just applications that you use on a daily basis?

Marwin G. : Uh for application on a daily basis I'd say like growth like if I can see something developing throughout the time slow it could be slowly and surely but yeah if I do see like a certain amount of growth then I feel like I've Accomplished something in the app throughout that time

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And so a core part of what we're trying to do with our productivity app is have like game-like elements and we're just going to I just want to ask you about like just games in general; so um what games do you play? And then at times if you do, do you feel non-productive when you play them at times?

Marwin G. : Okay, so for now I am playing genin impact and also Call of Duty so they're two very different games yeah but I do play genshin daily and sometimes I do feel a bit unproductive if it's just like a weekday thing because it's kind of rinse and repeat it's a grindy game yeah but on the weekends or like once a week it feels a bit more productive because you get to like build your character a bit more than just the daily thing but on a game like Call of Duty for sure I'm not feeling productive at all it's just kind of it's kind of a thing to play with friends.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: No worries, so um when we're looking for a pain points to address when like coming up with the ideas for what we want to do for our project um one of the pain points we kind of went over is kind of with productivity um is there any frustrating aspects of staying productive or organized?

Marwin G. : Yeah I would say consistency. Like if I find myself not being consistent at something I tend to just drop it and it is a bit frustrating that I can't keep it up like at that point.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: That's understand why everybody can go through those phases, um and relating to that, is it do you feel often overwhelmed by any tasks or goals you have when you're trying to be productive or organized?

Marwin G. : Yeah for sure it's I would say more like the amount of tasks that I try to put on myself for one day because I do tend to try to get everything done at one point so and I have a hard time like spreading it out and it could cause or it could lead to procrastination especially.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, um so you mentioned that the app you used with the growing of the bird. Are you currently using it or have you just stopped using it?

Marwin G. : Yeah, recently I've stopped using it.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, um is there any way when it comes to like productivity apps that would make it easier for you to continue being engaged with or more enjoyable to use?

Marwin G. : I'm not too sure it's a bit far-fetched but maybe like a reward outside of just the app but that is a bit hard to do I can see.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Because one of like the early concepts that we've came up with during this phase of our project when it comes to like functionalities or how we can keep users engaged was potentially having like an avatar and then based on your productivity you be able to earn rewards that you can use to customize that or potentially even badges so I just want to get your thoughts on if that would help make it product like easier you can have like your avatar just show how consistent you have been by e just like the gear you get.

Marwin G. : Yeah for sure that sounds like a really good idea because the finch app that I talked about did have customizability with your bird. You would like to buy stuff with the gems you get every day but it just didn't fit with my kind of style.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay so would you say like having an avatar would be a bit more towards your style?

Marwin G. : Yeah I can see that.

Erick Mao-Epsinoza: Okay um now I just ask you about gamification just adding the game elements on top of the thing like your preferences so we kind of delve into it already but what do you feel about the idea of trying to combine both predictivity and gamification?

Marwin G. : I think it's a very good idea because well video games especially been on like a rise as of late since I don't know it's just a very fun thing to do and I could see like it's hard to be productive while playing a game but if you can Market yourself as a game to be productive I could see that selling pretty well.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, so you're leaning towards it being like being able to help more than harm you with when it comes to motivation and productivity?

Marwin G. : yeah for sure I think if you just don't like focus more on the productivity elements than the game elements in itself if I don't know if you get me.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: yeah, and like when it comes to rewards you said you'd have to pay for rewards on the finch app with the or not pay but you'd have to use gems from you.

Marwin G. : Yeah you can also pay for like a higher amount of them which I found was a bit I guess to support them but yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: yeah so is there like for you would there be any kind of rewards that you'd like to see in that type of app that would motivate you like points badges leveling or Etc.

Marwin G. : I think the level upgrades if you could like yeah that would definitely be a cool thing to see for progression to unlock skills or something for your avatar.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Just to show how consistent you've been kind of okay. Um I'm just going to ask you about like because we're just trying to see what app or like what system or platform we'd like to develop the app on so when it comes to gaming or productivity is there a preference you have for each one whether it be mobile or desktop devices?

Marwin G. : Yeah for productivity I would say I think mobile is a bit easier to do since it's like on the go you can you can like check if you're outside or something okay so yeah I have a I have an iPhone so iOS.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay that's perfect because we've been debating whether we'd want to develop it using like using Android based or between iOS so being able to figure out which um device that we interview uses helps us in that case so we can make sure that we make sure we reach as many people as possible um another thing we've been looking to we ike um thrown out there as an idea is um being able to connect a smart device for like your health to like to check your steps whatever I just want to ask if you have any smart devices like a smartwatch or a fitness tracker?

Marwin G. : Personally I do not.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: okay no always um another thing we've been looking to add is like social aspect elements to our thing or application so I just want to ask do you value competition amongst your peers when it comes like just gaming or in general?

Marwin G. : Yeah I would say I do value competition.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And do you think being able to have a competition such as leaderboards would help in like a productivity app if you were able to see your friends how they're doing with their productivity?

Marwin G. : yeah so I would think it's it's from person to person because I would see it as like yeah if he can do that then or if they could do that I would try to do better but some people I

I could see like some people it would be um a bit disheartening to see yep so but personally yes for me I think if I see the leaderboard with my friends to do just my friends then yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: If you can see just friends it works but just like a I guess Global leaderboard yeah would be a bit disheartening just seeing how others okay yeah.

Marwin G. : I think you have the option if you know certain people.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay um and when it comes to socializing, social elements, whether it be through social media or um gaming, are there any apps that you gravitate towards?

Marwin G. : oh for sure Discord

Erick Mao-Espinoza: okay and is there anything about that that makes you make it an enjoyment like just use like easy to use or just an enjoyable enjoyable use?

Marwin G. : Yeah so for Discord it's both on mobile and desktop and they do allow like screen sharing and stuff and they have just the availability of both voice Channel and text Channel makes it very easy and simple to use conveniently.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And uh the last kind of set of questions I have to ask is it's kind of monetary based so we for our um project we'd have to we for task we looking at entrepreneurial aspects of our um path of developing apps so when it comes to like subscriptions whether it be gaming wise or productivity um why is there like do you have a take on like a battle pass or reward system?

Marwin G. : yeah um, so personally I don't uh buy into the battle pass on many of the games I play or any of the games I play in general but I do see like a value in it because like it's like it's an optional thing so you could get like cosmetics and stuff and if you do see cosmetics in there that you like then you might think about purchasing it.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And is there does like um the fear of missing out encourage you making purchases on certain things like that just knowing that it might not be able to ever return to like a store or a shop more in like the gaming sense like just promotion of oh this is the only time you'd be able to purchase X item.

Marwin G. : yeah I think that would. If I really like the game that had a battle pass yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Just in general with demoing, like just demoing the application and then how certain aspects like the battle like our monetary system if we were to pursue the battle pass would that help with your decision on that on how it could like just have like if we were to introduce like a battle pass system into our predictivity app and it just it had like badges or um

Avatar customization if we were to demo that towards the user would that help like your decision on making such purchases?

Marwin G. : Yeah I think having like an example of how features work yeah I think that would definitely help.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay and then that's it for the interview. I just want to thank you again for taking your time out today.

2. Triet Nguyen

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, Hello. My name is Erick Mao. And I'll be performing a user research interview and just want to give you some briefing. What my group is planning to do is, we're planning to make a productivity app that has game-like elements. So you put it in a task that you like to do, and then it would have some game related elements like leaderboards, rewards, badges and so forth. So, the 1st question I'd like to ask you is just your name and age.

Triet N. : Okay. So my name is Triet Nguyen and I'm 24 years old.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, and when it comes to your status, are you currently a student working, or both?

Triet N. : I'm currently a student.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, and so when it comes to your daily routine, can you briefly describe your routine like on a daily basis?

Triet N. : I guess. Do we need to talk about the time specifically?

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Not a time. Just like briefly.

Triet N. : Okay so I guess I wake up then brush my teeth, and then wash, wash my face and stuff, and then I get dressed, and someday I will go to work, and then others I will just, I don't know. Just sit around till noon to go to school. Yeah. And then, once I'm done with work or school, I come home. Then I'll change out my clothes, and then I'll take a shower. Oh, yeah, I forgot. I forgot about lunch, though.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Yeah. No worries.

Triet N. : But yeah, okay. So I had lunch, and then I came home. Change my clothes and take a shower and then I'll have dinner. Then, after that I work on homework and stuff, you know.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay.

Triet N. : Yeah. So, oh, yeah, yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: No! Go on! Go on!

Triet N. : Because after homework, just the play, some stuff on my computer.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, so is there like any specific part of the day where you feel like, there, you're like the most productive. Or is there a time where you feel like you're struggling to focus.

Triet N. : Yeah, I'll feel like I get to be most productive around at night, like I eat and take a shower. Yeah, and the least productive is in the morning, like before.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Yeah.

Triet N. : Go to school. I just don't want to do anything.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And when it comes to your routine, is there any way you used to track it like a calendar, or any other app.

Triet N. : No, I don't use any tracking app. Yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Hmm, okay, when it comes to having, like having different goals or tasks that you need to do or want to do? Can it be challenging? And if so, like, what about it? Makes it difficult when it comes to balancing your goals and tasks that you have to do.

Triet N. : Yeah, some. Sometimes, I guess it's challenging, because, like I don't know, maybe it's just me. But when I have an appointment like in the afternoon and then I would spend the whole morning doing nothing, because I feel like I am prepared for the afternoon. Yeah. So I guess.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: I guess just like the build up, I guess, because I can understand where you're coming from, whether it be a test or having something to do is like building up, making sure that I'm prepared for that moment. So it makes it difficult doing other tasks.

Triet N. : Yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, so another portion that my, the question that we came up with is, kind of with is health and productivity app usage. And when it comes to health apps, do you have any health or productivity apps that you use?

Triet N. : Like fitness and stuff.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Yeah, like, just anything like whether it's health related or productivity related.

Triet N. : I guess. The health, the fitness app on iphone. Yeah, I use those to track, like, how many steps I take throughout the day and stuff.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, and do you feel like It's effective when...do you feel effective with helping you achieve or like, stay productive.

Triet N. : I wouldn't say that it helps me stay productive. First, like on the days that I do feel like working out and stuff. It kinda helped me know that, like, how much did I work and stuff, how long did I work?

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, and just in general, when it comes to trying to meet your goals and tasks is, do you have any struggles with it?

Triet N. : I would say like, Oh, is it about the app, or just me?

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Just you in general, like, if you do you not? Yeah, just you in general. Do you have any struggles trying to meet any goals or tasks that you have set for yourself?

Triet N. : Yes, sometimes I do, because, like but I would say, I wanna like to workout that day right? And then when I get out of work or get out of school then it rains or bad weather. And so I just like actually decided to come home instead.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And some other. Oh, I can pivot off of this. You said you work out is like, do you know just about how long you do work out for.

Triet N. : Oh, oh, I don't work here anymore. But like.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Oh, okay.

Triet N. : When I still do, I usually go for around an hour of just working in the gym.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay. No worries.

Triet N. : Yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: So some of the stuff I have to ask is just relating it to around user engagement. Like just on apps in general, like applications, or whatever that keeps you engaged, like what applications or what things keep you engaged like, what applications that you use, that keeps you engaged.

Triet N. : I'll say, like something with a video especially audio, like music and stuff. Yeah. And yeah, I think that it would feel like you know, it's easier to use or more like, it's more interesting to use the app.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: and you'd say, like just a video format. And just that just helps you keep engaged with whatever you're doing.

Triet N. : Yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, so another thing is just asking about free time like, do you have free time? And how much of it do you have?

Triet N. : I think on my school days I would say, I have a lot of free time. Yeah, cause I like the whole morning, the whole evening after school.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay.

Triet N. : Yeah, yeah, I would say, I have like a decent amount of free time.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, and is there anything in particular that you do in your free time, whether it be gaming or just studying.

Triet N. : Mostly just gaming.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, that's good cause. Then I can now pivot into our next section. So when it comes to playing video games. Are there times when you're playing video games? If you feel like you're not being as productive when you're playing.

Triet N. : Yeah, yeah, a lot of time. Yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And just in general, do you have? What games do you like to play in your free time?

Triet N. : I don't know like I switch between you knowosu? It's like a rhythm game.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Yeah.

Triet N. : Random, game. Sometimes I just playosu. And other times I just like, I don't know. Just go around and play different games. But not competitive games.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: I mean, is there like when you mentionedosu, is there anything about it in particular that makes you like playing the game or keeps you wanting to play the game.

Triet N. : Yeah, it's like, because the games you play at your own pace. Yes, and sometimes I can see, like my own improvement, you know, and it gives me one to play more.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, it's good. So some things we're looking to do or find with this user research are looking for pain points and challenges. Like that application we're trying to build in that area. So when it comes to pain points with productivity, Is there any like any frustrating aspects that you have frustrating aspects that you have when trying to stay productive or organized.

Triet N. : Oh, can you repeat the question.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Is there anything that gets frustrating when it comes to trying to stay productive or organized, like, yeah.

Triet N. : I guess when my friends text me and stuff.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay.

Triet N. : Like when I'm doing my homework and stuff; because I don't. You know, I don't have a lot of friends, but like when they send me messages I have to check it, you know. Yeah, yeah. Yeah, so like. And they keep sending like they don't like send all the Texts right away, you know. So they send it. And then they do something else, and then I have to check it. And then when they send another message, I have to check it again. It's gonna break my focus.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And when you have, like any tasks or goals that you set for yourself, do you often feel overwhelmed by them?

Triet N. : Yeah, I guess. Yeah. Sometimes I do get overwhelmed by it.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And is it like cause? You have too much that you have set for yourself? Or is it just like when you have, like how can I explain this.

Triet N. : I think it's because, like procrastinating and stuff. And then when I actually work on it, there's just like too many things to get it done within that time frame.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, it's good to know. So you said you have. You haven't used a productivity app or tool correct?

Triet N. : Yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, if you were to use one, is there anything that would help you get into it or make you want to use it?

Triet N. : Yeah, I think maybe the 1st thing would be like setting your own goals. Yeah, like setting your own goals in the app. So you can like work at your own pace.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay.

Triet N. : And another thing is to keep track of the data, so you can like, look back and see how much you improve.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: I haven't run into that one. That's good. Okay, so what we're trying to do I've mentioned at the beginning is we're trying to combine like game, like game elements into productivity. Well, how do you feel about hearing that of trying to combine the idea of productivity with gamification?

Triet N. : I think, yeah, I think it's a good idea, because I have thought about it like a similar idea like, you know, like, when you play games like get like, really exciting.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Yeah.

Triet N. : Like so like, why don't we just think about like, for example, like working out right? You just think about it like you're training your character and stuff. And it gets you like, focus more on stuff you're doing.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, that's good. Do you think gamification could help with motivation and productivity?

Triet N. : I think I think it would work. Yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, when it comes to just like rewards in general, like, we're trying to think of, like how we could motivate the user with rewards like badges, points, leaderboards, leveling and etc. is, would those like concepts be motivating to you if you were to hop on a like the app, and know that you can earn like badges or points.

Triet N. : Yeah, I think I think it would help like the user if they are if they have a leaderboard, or maybe like achievements. Yeah, they would feel like it's more special, you know.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Yep, because I'm asking as, oh, or just until like, we're, we're thinking about implementing like an avatar that a user can have and based off of that like. If you, if there's like certain tasks you meet, you would earn specific gear towards that.

Triet N. : Oh, yeah, yeah, that's a good idea.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, perfect. So when we're trying to come up with something like what we should make our app on when it comes to do you prefer mobile or desktop desktop? Devices for, like gaming or productivity.

Triet N. : For productivity. I think I would prefer a mobile, mobile app.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And is it? Is it just because it's more convenient just because it's like it's handheld and you are. You always have your phone on you?

Triet N. : Yeah, mostly because of that. But also like, so like, when you let's say you, you're working on a laptop, right? Maybe you don't want to switch to another tab, but you just want to quickly check your progress. Like, pull out your phone and open the app, you know.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, cool and like, when it comes to mobile devices, do you have an apple device, or like an android device.

Triet N. : Oh, I have an apple device.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, perfect. Oh, also, do you have any smart devices that use a smartwatch to keep track of anything?

Triet N. : No.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, very good. So I mentioned earlier about leaderboards. We're thinking about the idea of having social elements to that application. Do you value competition amongst your peers or friends?

Triet N. : I think it can be a good thing to have a kind of push, you try to be better than yourself, and maybe better than your friends. But personally, I don't really care about it.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay.

Triet N. : Maybe it won't help me, but it might help other people.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, that's fine. And when it comes to just socializing, is there any social media, or like gaming apps that you use to socialize?

Triet N. : Oh, a gaming app?

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Someone mentioned, maybe, like discord, or like Instagram, or every. Is there anything like that you use to socialize?

Triet N. : I guess. Mostly discord, yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, just the last set of questions is like a monetary base, because we have to consider that if we were to plan moving forward with our idea of the gamified productivity app. When it comes to like subscriptions, whether it be like a battle pass or reward system, what are your thoughts on that.

Triet N. : My thoughts on like a battle pass?

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Or like a subscription? Yeah.

Triet N. : Okay, I think it shouldn't be too expensive, you know, because it is like a long term kind of stuff.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Yeah.

Triet N. : Yeah, and I feel like the rewards on the; let's say, a battle pass. It should be a little bit more special.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Yep.

Triet N. : Because, like, it takes a lot of effort to finish the whole thing.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Does feel like fear missing out. Encourage purchases for you like missing out on certain things because it's like, Oh, you have X amount of time before it's gone forever.

Triet N. : Oh, what about it?

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Like do you have, like the does, like the fear of missing out, encourage you to make certain purchases.

Triet N. : Yeah, yeah, I sometimes do, yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay/ And I just want to ask you thoughts about spending money on software and applications like, how do you feel about that?

Triet N. : I guess I usually would check by that was some information about, like the Creator.

And if they seem to be like they actually care about stuff, you know, like they are listening to the user and fixing stuff. Yeah. Then maybe I would support them. I wouldn't mind paying for them.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, I think that's about it on my question list. So if you have anything to ask me, or that's it. That's that's all. And thank you for helping me out with this.

Triet N. : Alright. Yeah, I think that's all. Yeah. I don't have any questions.

3. Aileen Mao

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay. Hello. My name is Erick Mao. And I'm performing a user research interview for my 491 computer Science Senior project. So I just want to give you a brief overview of what my group is planning to do this semester into the next, and we are planning on making a gamified productivity app, where you input any goals or tasks that you have, and then it would have like game like features into it, whether it be leaderboards or avatars, or just earning badges or leveling in general. So the 1st set of questions, I'd like to ask you your name and your age.

Aileen M. : My name is Aileen, and I am 22 years old.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And when it comes to your status, are you currently a student working, or both?

Aileen M. : No, I'm currently just a student. But I used to work

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And just for this semester. How many units are you taking?

Aileen M. : Right now I'm taking about 15 units, so I'm full time

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay. And would you say that you have to put plenty of time into that? or is it kind of an easy schedule, because I know just the units aren't very indicative of your workload, just because some classes may be a bit easier than others are.

Aileen M. : I think it's just 50 50. Some of my classes fluctuate where some of the classes aren't as workload, whereas my other classes are a little bit more intensive. And then this for this past semester. I'm also taking on a research project with my professor. So that's another thing that's added on top of my school scheduling, that I also have to consider.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: So just some things I want to get into is just, can you briefly just describe your daily routine

Aileen M. : I choose to have morning classes, so I'm pretty much out of the house pretty early in the morning around 8 I have class from early morning to about afternoon, and then once I'm done with class for the day, I go home, and I try to get started with all my assignments that I have due for the week, or even get a head start on some that aren't due to a little bit later

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, so during your day, is there any specific part of the day where you can feel most productive? Or is there any part of the day where you find yourself struggling to focus?

Aileen M. : I'm usually pretty productive if I have a gap in between like before my next class. because I'm on campus. But sometimes when I'm at home sometimes it can be hard to do work or just have motivation to do it, just because it's I'm just tired

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And when you say that when it comes to feeling like you mentioned being productive towards gaps, would that be towards the morning?

Aileen M. : Yes.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And then the evening towards where you lose focus.

Aileen M. : Yeah, pretty much.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, and how is there anything that you used or like? How do you track your daily routine?

Aileen M. : I use a physical planner, but I also use notion to help organize my workload

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Notions?

Aileen M. : Notion.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Is that a like a planning app

Aileen M. : Yeah, you could pretty much catalog and plan your own calendar to your own liking.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay. So when it comes to balancing different goals and tasks that you have on a daily basis, can it be challenging for you?

Aileen M. : It can.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And is there anything like what makes it difficult for you

Aileen M. : Oh, the question is, can you repeat again? Sorry?

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Is there anything that can make it difficult, when trying to balance any different goals and tasks that you have set up for yourself?

Aileen M. : Yeah, I just think sometimes other stuff happens that I sometimes might have to prioritize over my task for the day. So sometimes it gets pushed. Not that I don't want it to happen, but sometimes some things just have to get moved over. I kind of have to prioritize

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Oh, yeah. So we came up with various different questions when we came to get prepared for user research. And we have a section regarding health and productivity app usage you mentioned. You use notion, and this is towards health apps. Do you use any health, apps or productivity apps outside of notion and a physical planner?

Aileen M. : I just use the help app that's integrated into iphone

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, and do you feel what the methods you named; does it feel that they are effective when you help achieve the goals, or stay productive in general?

Aileen M. : I feel like, yeah, it does, cause I have an apple watch, too, and sometimes, when you set goals you could check it off. So I kind of feel that's like a motivator, too.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, so that's something you like about having the integration with the watches, it being able to be a motivator being able to check off your task

Aileen M. : Yeah, cause you could pretty much set it to your preference, and I feel like it helps a lot.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Oh, yeah. Do you have any struggles with trying to meet any goals or tasks? When you try to perform them?

Aileen M. : For the most part, I feel like I don't necessarily unless it is the only case, if I have a busy week, and I have assignments that fall within the same day that I have that need to be done. I feel that's probably the only thing that I struggle with is like probably tackling like 2 assignments that are due the same day

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Yeah, so it can. It can just be a bit overwhelming

Aileen M. : Yeah.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, we're also looking for user engagement with different applications. What when you use just apps in general, whether it be on your mobile device or on a laptop. Is there anything about whatever applications or games that you're using that keeps you engaged with that?

Aileen M. : I feel like planning apps. I just like to see what I have to do. I like the structure of it.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Also, when it comes to free time, do you have much free time?

Aileen M. : I think it depends on what my schedule looks like. I feel like I can't really like, I can't really say, just because I feel like every day looks different for me, and sometimes things pop up, and I just have to do it then and there.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And also a key part of what we're trying to build is the gaming aspect. So just in general, do you play any video games? If any

Aileen M. : I used to, but I don't, really, because I'm busy with school

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, so one of the key things about our user research is looking for any pain points or challenges that you or the potential user may have encountered with using products similar to what we're trying to develop. So is there anything frustrating with the apps that you have used that are productivity related or just trying to stay organized in general?

Aileen M. : Sometimes I kind of wish it was a little easier to plan out because I feel like for notion It's kind of like they give you like the outlines and like templates and stuff, but for the most part, like, if you want to customize it to your own personal preference. It's a little bit more tedious. I wish it was a little bit more easier and accessible

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, And we kind of went over it briefly earlier. Do you feel that you can be overwhelmed by tasking goals?

Aileen M. : Yes, for sure.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, you mentioned that. So just the challenges and frustrations you experienced with productivity, productivity, tools, and methods, or just that it can be tedious on a just a customizable front. Okay, how are you currently using any productivity apps or tools? Or have you stopped?

Aileen M. : I feel like for notion. I haven't updated as frequently as I like just because I feel like it does get a little bit too tedious for me. So I feel like right now I'm more on to just physically writing it into my planner.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And what about having it as a physical object to track your productivity and motivation? What about it? Makes it more enjoyable to use compared to a non-physical copy or application?

Aileen M. : I think for me. I like the fact that it's like right in front of me, and like I could physically check it off with my pen because I feel like for me. I could see my whole overview and what I set for the day. I feel like it's just easier for me, because it's condensed into one thing that's like in my hand.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay. So when it comes to, if you were to make, have a productivity app. What are some features or things that you would like to see? That would make it easier or more enjoyable for you to use?

Aileen M. : I think, just to not over complicate it. I just like apps that are easy for me to access, and not to put too much thought into it, but also make the functions easy to use, because I feel like for some productivity apps. It's kind of confusing to figure out how to work it with, like some companies, intentions to like, make it easy when it's not in reality

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay. So we touched on it. I touched on the gamification aspect of the app, which is just a term for adding game- like elements. How do you feel about combining productivity with the idea of gamification

Aileen M. : I feel like that'd be interesting and enjoyable.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Do you think having those elements could be helpful with motivation and productivity?

Aileen M. : I feel like it can cause just cause that's like one thing that I haven't tried yet, and I feel like that might work for me, and it could work for other people, too, who have, like struggles, just sticking to like one thing.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: We're looking to you to mention the experience of not having that before productivity apps, we're looking to implement some kind of rewards like points, badges, and just leveling. Do you feel like those rewards would help motivate you, knowing that by the goals and tasks that you complete you could earn points, badges, and even we touched on it briefly. You have. You would have an avatar. You could earn potential gear to like display, showing how consistent that you've been with the app

Aileen M. : I feel like that'd be nice because I feel like for me. That's just a form of like my progress into a character. So seeing the more I add on, will probably make me more more motivated to continue to tackle my goals and tasks for the day.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: So just briefly, we're like, do you prefer mobile or desktop devices for gaming or and just productivity in general?

Aileen M. : I feel like I enjoy mobile a little bit more right now.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Is there anything about it? Just the convenience of it? Is it just because it's just a smaller device that you can just always have on you?

Aileen M. : Yes, I feel like that's the reason why. Just because I don't have my laptop on me.
24/7.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Oh, yeah, and you mentioned that you had an apple watch earlier in the interview. Do you feel like it helps contribute to your daily routine and productivity?

Aileen M. : I feel like it does like even for like, it's like physical aspects. And like your health. I really like to use that feature, and I feel like it helps cause. I set it to my preferences.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Right. So some things were we've come up with in the like idea process of what we want. Our app is just having social elements in the application. Do you value competition amongst your peers or just friends in general?

Aileen M. : For me. Personally, I don't

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay, no worries. And just just socialization in general. What things do you use? Socialize, whether it be through social media or games

Aileen M. : Like? Do I?

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Like, what applications do you use to socialize

Aileen M. : I socialize through Instagram, mainly

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And is there anything about that app that gravitates you to to use that app more like, is there anything that you like about it, or just in general, that you feel like helps you stay engaged with it

Aileen M. : I just think it's easy, because with the whole messaging like, it's I just message like everyone through there. And so just like leaving the app. Go in like my messenger, like my imessage. I feel like it's all on Instagram, so it's it's easy for me to access then and there

Erick Mao-Espinoza: So the last set of questions that we have is we have to look beyond the scope of just developing the app and looking at a monetary based system. And we're looking towards subscriptions like a battle pass or just a monthly subscription. Is there any take that you have on that, whether it'd sometimes be too expensive or not enough value.

Aileen M. : I would probably worry about it being too expensive and maybe not having, like a good value. I feel like there has to be pretty good benefits for me to want to like you know. consider doing something like a subscription, or something.

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay. So when it comes to making purchases, does having, like the fear of missing out, encourage you with making purchases just because of the fact that you may be missing out on certain things

Aileen M. : I feel like it depends

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Okay so do you have any particular feelings about spending money on software and applications in general?

Aileen M. : Not any negative feelings. I feel like, if you have to. You have to

Erick Mao-Espinoza: And when it comes to making those decisions, do you feel like having a demo of the application would help you make decisions on whether or not you would like to make a purchase?

Aileen M. : I feel like for sure that would, because sometimes especially when it comes to software, obviously, you commit to buying, and then when you try it out. It's not good. It's kind of like a waste of your money. So having a demo would actually be pretty helpful

Erick Mao-Espinoza: Right, and I believe those are all the questions that I have for you. If there's anything you have for me you can ask me now, but if not, that's it for the interview, and thank you

Aileen M. : Thank you.

Jordan:

1. Shayne Lopez

Jordan: We are now recording. Okay, so I'm just going to jump right into the questions. Some of these first questions I'm going to ask you about your student and work status. So, are you currently a student, working, or both?

Shayne: Just student.

Jordan: Student. How old are you?

Shayne: 24.

Jordan: How many units are you taking?

Shayne: 12.

Jordan: Okay. How would you describe your daily routine briefly?

Shayne: Wake up early, get ready for school, go to school from 1:00 p.m. to 8:00 p.m., do some work in between classes at school, find time to eat.

Jordan: Okay. Is there a specific part of your day where you feel most productive?

Shayne: During the afternoon, from probably 2:00 to 4:00.

Jordan: How about any particular part of the day where you're struggling to focus or be productive?

Shayne: From 7:00 to 8:00, the last class of the day. By then, I'm pretty tired.

Jordan: Okay. In terms of your daily routine, is there any way you keep track of it?

Shayne: I have a small planner, like a small notebook planner.

Jordan: A physical planner?

Shayne: Yes.

Jordan: Do you find it challenging trying to balance different goals and tasks on a day-to-day basis?

Shayne: Yeah, sometimes. Sometimes an assignment takes longer than anticipated, so stuff has to be moved around.

Jordan: Okay. So is there any way that you prioritize your tasks either before or after you run into something like that?

Shayne: I usually prioritize the more difficult tasks first. That way, if I do get stuck, I'm able to stop and work on something else.

Jordan: Okay. Good feedback on that. That does it for the student and working questions. Now, I'm going to ask you some questions about health apps or productivity apps. Have you or do you use any health or productivity apps?

Shayne: I used one that helped track my workouts when I would go to the gym, but not anymore.

Jordan: Do you remember what it was called?

Shayne: No.

Jordan: That's fine. While you were using it, how effective do you feel that app was in terms of achieving any workout goals?

Shayne: I would say not super effective. It required you to input every detail of what you ate and how much you weighed and stuff like that.

Jordan: If there was one word to describe how it made you feel, what would you say?

Shayne: Probably good.

Jordan: Overall, even considering the drawbacks?

Shayne: Yeah.

Jordan: So you talked about workout apps. Would you say you seek self-improvement?

Shayne: Yes.

Jordan: Do you still work out?

Shayne: No.

Jordan: What would you say your activity levels are?

Shayne: Pretty low right now. Once school picks up, I get really busy, and most of the time, I'm sitting in a chair doing work.

Jordan: Okay. What would you say is your average daily or weekly screen time? Are you tracking that on your phone?

Shayne: On my phone, yeah. I would say for my computer, maybe four to six hours a day.

Jordan: What about on your phone?

Shayne: Let's see... My daily average is about four hours.

Jordan: Do you feel okay with sharing what app you spend the most time on?

Shayne: YouTube.

Jordan: And what do you primarily use YouTube for? Entertainment? Education? Just to kill time?

Shayne: Most of the time, it's entertainment. I do use it a lot for education. When I'm working on my SolidWorks assignments, I'll have a video up explaining how to do certain things.

Jordan: Okay. That's a good transition into asking about user engagement within apps. Do you play any video games, whether on mobile or desktop?

Shayne: Occasionally, I do play Call of Duty on my computer.

Jordan: What about on your mobile device?

Shayne: I just have one game—the Pokémon card game.

Jordan: Did I ask you about free time already?

Shayne: I think so.

Jordan: Specifically, how much free time would you say you have?

Shayne: Not much.

Jordan: And when you do, what do you usually spend your free time on?

Shayne: Small projects. I'll try to create something with Arduinos and code it, just to practice my coding skills because I also find that fun, so it doesn't really feel like I'm just doing more work.

Jordan: Okay. Is there anything you would say keeps you engaged in any applications that you use?

Shayne: Like having music in the background.

Jordan: Okay. We're going to move on to a different set of questions. I'm going to ask you about potential pain points with productivity itself in general. What would you say are the most frustrating aspects of staying productive or organized?

Shayne: The most frustrating thing is when something you didn't account for pops up. Like, if suddenly a professor assigns something new that wasn't planned or talked about, and it shifts everything over.

Jordan: Do you feel overwhelmed by tasks or goals?

Shayne: Yes, sometimes.

Jordan: Are there any challenges or frustrations you've experienced with productivity tools or methods? This isn't just apps—it could be anything, like how you said you have a planner.

Shayne: It was a little frustrating getting used to planning because sometimes I would forget that I even had the planner and not write things down. But for helping me stay productive, it's been very helpful—not so much frustrating.

Jordan: Would you say the frustrating part was getting used to it?

Shayne: Yeah.

Jordan: But now that you're using it, was it worth the frustration?

Shayne: Yes.

Jordan: And then you mentioned the workout app. Is there anything about that app that would make it easier or more enjoyable to use?

Shayne: The UI of it sucked. It was very overwhelming. There were a lot of tabs on the screen that you had to fill in. If the app had a simpler, cleaner home screen, I would want to use it again.

Jordan: Okay. So it was overwhelming because of how much stuff was on the screen that you had to click on and organize?

Shayne: Yeah. It would give you a whole week to plan out on one screen.

Jordan: So let's say they were to shorten that time frame—how would you feel about that?

Shayne: I think I could get used to that, and I would want to try using the app again.

Jordan: Are you familiar with the term gamification?

Shayne: No.

Jordan: Basically, gamification is introducing game-like features into an app, like leveling up, achievements, cosmetic items, or in-game tokens. Since you're a gamer, how would you feel about combining those types of features with a productivity app?

Shayne: I think it would make it a lot more interesting. One of the more satisfying things about gaming is achieving and unlocking things, so if they put that idea into a productivity app, it would make it a lot more fun to use.

Jordan: Would you agree that it would help with motivation and productivity?

Shayne: Yes, I think so.

Jordan: Uh, so what kind of, like, in-app or in-game rewards would be more motivating for you?

Shayne: I think, uh, leveling up and maybe having some kind of just badge or online ranking system—skill-based. Weightlifting maybe, yeah.

Jordan: Okay, uh, let's see. So for gaming and productivity, do you prefer using mobile or desktop devices? Or—yeah, so do you prefer using mobile or desktop devices for gaming and productivity?

Shayne: I would say desktop for gaming and mobile for productivity.

Jordan: Okay. Uh, so what is—generally speaking, just mobile and desktop—what is more convenient for you?

Shayne: Uh, more convenient would be mobile.

Jordan: Okay. Uh, do you have any smart devices, like a smartwatch or, uh, I don't know, other, like, devices that you can connect to?

Shayne: Um, I have my iPad and Apple Watch.

Jordan: Okay. Uh, do either of those help you con—like, do they help contribute to your daily routine or your productivity?

Shayne: The iPad, yes. Um, I do a lot of work on that, and it's—it's easier to work on than a notebook. As far as the Apple Watch, I just got that.

Jordan: All right, we'll follow up—I'm kidding. Uh, so generally speaking, do you value competition amongst your peers?

Shayne: Um, not so much competition—maybe more, uh, collaboration.

Jordan: Okay. Uh, what about amongst, like, close friends?

Shayne: Yeah, yeah, I would say I value competition.

Jordan: Okay. Uh, what types of, I guess, outlets do you use to socialize? This could be social media, video games, uh, messaging apps, or even in person.

Shayne: Um, video games, uh, working on cars, uh, and yeah, social media apps—Instagram.

Jordan: Uh, which one of these would you say you use primarily?

Shayne: Probably video games.

Jordan: Okay. Uh, do you currently have any subscriptions for any—any apps?

Shayne: Um, I have a subscription to a note-taking app on my iPad and a subscription to Apple Music.

Jordan: Okay. What is your take on the battle pass for a reward system?

Shayne: Um, I—I don't really like the battle pass idea. Um, it is nice to get free stuff, but it's not fun having to pay for something and have more things to buy in a game that you feel should have been completed. It kind of—it kind of feels like it's trying to make up for the fact that the game you're playing is not complete.

Jordan: Okay. So would you say—let's see. Does fear of missing out encourage any of your purchases?

Shayne: Um, no, no, not really.

Jordan: Uh, what about, uh, like, in-game—you mentioned Call of Duty. Are there any limited-time, like, in-game things that you can purchase?

Shayne: Um, yeah, but to me, it's not worth spending 25 bucks on digital items to use in a game.

Jordan: Okay. So, uh, how do you feel about the subscription model versus, like, a—like, the one-time buying, like how you buy the video game and you don't have to keep paying for the video game? Like, how do you feel about those two?

Shayne: I prefer one-time purchase over subscription. I feel like almost everything now has a subscription part to it. Um, yeah, I prefer first-time purchasing—unless it's something that costs a lot, like—like, uh, a software where the software is, you know, it comes with a lot of expensive stuff.

Jordan: Okay. Um, yeah, what about a subscription that is relatively inexpensive compared to, like, a more expensive buy-in? Like—okay, I'm—I'm trying to create a hypothetical scenario.

Let's say there's, like, a—a software, you don't know if you like it, and it has either an expensive initial buy-in or it has a subscription, then you can cancel.

Shayne: It doesn't have a trial?

Jordan: That's not the question.

Shayne: Um, I feel like that makes sense. Yeah, you don't want to risk buying something right out and, uh, and find out you don't like it or enjoy using it.

Jordan: Okay. So in general, how do you feel about spending money on software and apps, whether that's on mobile or desktop?

Shayne: Uh, I—I rarely spend money on apps. Uh, I was hesitant to pay for the subscription for my notebook—or my digital notebook—even though it's only \$10 a year. Um, I was just hesitant because it's real easy to forget.

Jordan: Okay. Uh, so how do you feel about demos? Like, a demo of a paid service, but the demo is free, like as a trial?

Shayne: Uh, I think demos are a great idea. Uh, they're very useful. Um, I use all kinds of trials, uh, and demos of programs just to—just to see if I can learn them within that demo or—or complete a project using them.

Jordan: Uh, and as far as gaming goes, demos are the—you know, the best way to find out if it's something you are interested in.

Shayne: Yeah.

Jordan: So, for—you mentioned about learning a software. Um, would you say—uh, let's see, how do I phrase this? If you are able to, I guess, learn a software within the trial period, that would make it—uh, would you say it was worth paying for?

Shayne: Um, I wouldn't say it's—if I—if I learned it, it's worth paying for. I would say it's more if—if I enjoyed using it and I know that I need it, then it—it might be worth paying for. Um, if—if the system of the program is too complicated or foreign to you, uh, within that demo, then it—it might not be the best option to buy it. Um, unless, of course, you need it, and you're planning on just learning how to use it.

Jordan: Yeah, so you value, like, intuitiveness and ease of use?

Shayne: Yeah.

Jordan: Okay. All right, that is all my questions. I'm going to stop recording.

2. Eddie Cuellar

Jordan: I am recording now. I'm going to go through the questions. So, are you currently a student, working, or both?

Eddie: Both.

Jordan: And how old are you?

Eddie: 24.

Jordan: How many units are you taking?

Eddie: 12.

Jordan: So you're full-time?

Eddie: Correct.

Jordan: And you said you're working. So what kind of work do you do?

Eddie: Operations consulting for two different car dealerships in Los Angeles and San Francisco.

Jordan: How would you describe your daily routine briefly?

Eddie: I usually wake up around 7:00 in the morning. I drive to the store that I have in Los Angeles. I spend between 5 to 8 hours there, depending on what's going on. From there, I go to school. I'm in school from 4:00 PM to 9:00 PM. On the days that I'm not working or the days that I'm not in school, I usually spend that time getting homework done or working remotely.

Jordan: Is there a specific part of the day where you feel most productive? Or are there parts of the day where you struggle to focus?

Eddie: I'm usually less productive later in the day just because I'm tired, but that's it.

Jordan: Is there any way you keep track of your daily routine?

Eddie: No, I don't track it.

Jordan: Do you find it challenging trying to balance different goals and tasks on a day-to-day basis?

Eddie: Sometimes, if I want to do anything additional to what I'm already doing. But generally, no.

Jordan: Do you do anything to prioritize your tasks throughout the day or week?

Eddie: Yes.

Jordan: How do you prioritize them?

Eddie: Just a written checklist of things that I need to do throughout the day that I make when I go to work in the morning.

Jordan: Is that what works best for you?

Eddie: Yes.

Jordan: So, we're going to move on to some questions about apps you may use. Have you or do you use any health or productivity apps?

Eddie: No.

Jordan: Would you say you're pretty productive on a day-to-day basis?

Eddie: Yes.

Jordan: Do you seek any type of self-improvement?

Eddie: I could have better time management in general, but not anything drastic.

Jordan: Do you work out at all? How would you describe your activity levels?

Eddie: 80.

Jordan: What is your average daily or weekly screen time? Do you have your phone track that?

Eddie: Yes. My average is four hours.

Jordan: Do you mind sharing what app you use the most?

Eddie: Maps.

Jordan: Nice. Are there any games that you play, whether mobile apps or actual video games?

Eddie: No.

Jordan: In terms of free time, how much free time would you say you have?

Eddie: 24 hours per week.

Jordan: What do you usually spend your free time on?

Eddie: Hanging out with friends.

Jordan: Do you value competition amongst your friends or peers?

Eddie: Among friends, no. Among peers, maybe.

Jordan: So would you say you socialize primarily face-to-face with your friends?

Eddie: Yeah.

Jordan: Do you prefer mobile or desktop devices for gaming and productivity?

Eddie: Desktop.

Jordan: Do you have any smart devices like a smartwatch or fitness trackers?

Eddie: No.

Jordan: Are there any aspects that are frustrating for you when it comes to staying productive and organized?

Eddie: Yes. Relying on other people to be competent enough for me to do what I need to do.

Jordan: Is that an acceptable answer?

Eddie: Yes.

Jordan: Do you often feel overwhelmed by tasks or goals?

Eddie: No.

Jordan: Have you experienced any challenges with your task tracking methods, like making a list? Or do you feel it's pretty reliable?

Eddie: No, I think it's pretty reliable.

Jordan: Let's say you were to use an app instead of making a list. What would catch your attention and make you switch from your current method?

Eddie: I've tried a few in the past, but none of them are efficient in actually reminding you to do things. The lists are always a little clunky, or they're too hard to get to. For instance, I tried the Reminders app, but I didn't like how it works because it doesn't actually notify you of anything. I also don't like that it automatically reorganizes things—you can't just add something to the top of the list. It just doesn't work well.

Jordan: Are there any other apps that you may have used?

Eddie: No, not that I know of. I don't remember the names.

Jordan: How do you feel about combining a productivity or task-tracking app with gamification?

Eddie: I think it's a great idea.

Jordan: Do you think it would help you or others with motivation and productivity?

Eddie: Yes.

Jordan: Why do you think it would help?

Eddie: People have short attention spans and like video games. Things that draw their attention might make them feel like they're getting something out of doing what they need to do—especially if the task itself isn't motivating enough.

Jordan: If there were rewards, are there any in-app or in-game rewards that would motivate you?

Eddie: I don't know. I can't think of anything specific.

Jordan: That's fine. What about seeing progress over time, like tracking tasks you've completed over a period of months? Would that be interesting to you?

Eddie: Yeah, that would be nice.

Jordan: Now, I'm going to ask some monetary-based questions about subscriptions and in-app purchases. Do you currently have any subscriptions for apps?

Eddie: No.

Jordan: What is your take on the battle pass as a reward system?

Eddie: What is the battle pass?

Jordan: You know, like Fortnite?

Eddie: I don't know about Fortnite.

Jordan: Basically, it's where you buy a battle pass, and over time, as you use the app, you unlock things just by completing in-game or in-app tasks.

Eddie: It sounds epic.

Jordan: Does fear of missing out encourage your purchases?

Eddie: Yes.

Jordan: So, let's say there was a game you cared about, and there was a limited-time item. Would the fear of missing out encourage you to make an in-game purchase?

Eddie: Yeah.

Jordan: What is your take on spending money on software and applications, whether on desktop or mobile?

Eddie: Anything that is useful is worth money. It just has to be useful.

Jordan: Last question—would a demo of a paid product help with your decision to buy it?

Eddie: Yes.

Jordan: Okay, I think that's all the questions.

3. Georgina Ayyoub

Jordan : Okay. Can you hear me?

Georgina : Yeah.

Jordan : Alright. So I guess I'm just gonna start with asking you some like questions about your student and work status.

Jordan : Basically, what we're doing is user research for our senior project.

Jordan : So are you currently a student working or both.

Georgina : I am currently well.

Jordan : What is your age?

Georgina : 22.

Jordan : How many units are you currently taking.

Georgina : Think 7.

Jordan : You said 7.

Georgina : Think so.

Jordan : Okay, how would you? Briefly describe your daily routine.

Georgina : Daily routine is, wake up, have breakfast.

Usually do homework, or any chores that I have, and then go to class in the evening.

Then I usually stay at the library after school, and then I come home.

That's some days that I have school and then work days.

It's usually the same. I usually have work the same time as school.

Jordan : Okay? And is there like a specific part of your day where you feel most productive, or any parts of the day, you find yourself struggling to focus.

Georgina : Usually most productive within the first hour of waking up.

And then I really struggle to focus usually around like 2 or 3 Pm.

That's usually when I am most tired during the day.

Jordan : Is there any way that you track your daily routine.

Georgina : I don't track my daily routine. I just use an app to put everything like a to-do list app for the day, and I cross it off as I go.

Jordan : Okay, let's see.

Jordan : So do you think it's challenging, trying to balance different goals and tasks on a day-to-day basis?

Georgina : Yes.

Jordan : What makes it difficult?

Georgina : I think the time management feeling like I'm always running out of time.

And also, I think the motivation from switching from task to task is also difficult.

Jordan : So how do you prioritize your tasks throughout the day or week?

Georgina : Usually my first priority is school.

So if I have something due that day, that is the number one thing that I need to get done.

After school, I usually try to prioritize my well-being. So making sure that I'm taking care of myself.

And definitely like sleeping enough.

Jordan : Okay, okay, so that kind of covers routine stuff.

Jordan : I'm gonna ask you some questions kind of directed more towards health and productivity.

Jordan : Let's see, do you have? Or have you used any health or productivity apps.

Georgina : Yes, I've used like Pomodoro apps so like timers for studying.

And I've used different apps for to-do lists, like I've used Notion to track my schoolwork as well as my schedule and stuff like that.

Jordan : Okay? You had mentioned like, what was it?

Like a list like you use like a list, and you cross things off. What do you use for that?

Georgina : Let me see what it's called.

I don't even know what this app is called.

Oh, it's called Dawn, and it's a really simple app.

You literally just put the task, the date, and time.

And then you could also put like additional reminders on there, and you can set like a bunch of them. So if it's something like an appointment,

if I have an appointment on Thursday, I'll have a reminder set for like

Wednesday. That reminds me, like I have an appointment the next day.

And then I also,

if there's some type of routine that I'm trying to get into like right now, I'm really trying to get into a routine of doing a skincare routine at night.

So I have that set to repeat every single day.

So that I can cross it off every single day that I do it.

And it's also nice because I have it as a widget. So I can see.

Jordan : Oh, yeah, that is nice.

Georgina : Yeah, I can see what I

like, what I have to do. But the widget I actually have on right now is like

it's like an image of a calendar. And then each day has, like a circle around it, and the darker that the circle is, the

more that you have on your to-do list that day. So if it's really light, that means it's an easy day. If it's dark, then it's like you have a lot to do that day.

Jordan : Okay.

Jordan : So of the apps that you mentioned, including the ones you've used in the past and the one you're using now, how effective do you feel that they are with helping you achieve goals or staying productive?

Georgina : I think it'll keep me motivated for a short amount of time.

Like an app will work for me for a little bit, maybe like 2 months, and then afterwards, if I don't use it for a few days, then I completely forget about it, and I don't go back to it.

But I think I found that

I either need something that is completely customizable so that I really like, I really do a lot with it. And it's like a very creative like prospect, like that's how Notion was for me.

Or it has to be really simple like Dawn is super simple, and it's literally just about like, here's the things I have to do. Get them done.

I think they do what they need to do in the time period that I'm using them.

Jordan : That's good.

Jordan : So let's see.

Jordan : So would you say that you seek self-improvement?

Georgina : Yeah.

Jordan : Do you currently work out?

Georgina : A little bit.

Jordan : What would you say your activity levels are like weekly?

Georgina : As of right now, I would say I work out like maybe twice a week.

Jordan : Okay?

Jordan : So on your phone, do you keep track of your screen time?

Georgina : I don't keep track of my screen time.

Jordan : Do you know if your phone shows you like, if you go into your settings?

Georgina : Yeah, I think there's like the settings. It's on the Apple phones.

Georgina : Screen time.

Georgina : Yeah.

Jordan : Is it? Is it like set up.

Georgina : Oh, yeah, I can see my screen time.

Jordan : So what's your like? Your average daily.

Georgina : My average daily.

Georgina : My daily average is, oh, do I see this 5 h.

Jordan : And do you feel comfortable sharing what app you spend the most time on.

Georgina : Messages.

Jordan : Okay, what about the second? Most.

Georgina : Spotify.

Jordan : Okay, so that kind of covers health and productivity.

Jordan : I'm gonna ask you some some questions more guided towards like actual apps.

Jordan : So applications that you've used or you've had experience with. What keeps.

Jordan : what kind of keeps your engagement like with that app.

Georgina : Oops my engagement.

Georgina : I think.

Georgina : Bike I really like apps. Most of them do this. But when you can actually like.

Georgina : be what you've crossed off.

Georgina : I don't like when like a to do list. If you cross something off, if it disappears.

Georgina : like seeing that it's actually crossed off cause. I think that gives you like.

Georgina : like a sense of motivation where you're like. Oh, I only have like 1. 1 more thing left like might as well do it.

Georgina : Just being so. You like seeing your progress?

Georgina : Yeah.

Georgina : I've always steered away from any apps that.

Georgina : give me like notifications, I guess, because it always felt like condescending in a way.

Georgina : I don't know. I don't like. I don't like notifications from like productivity apps.

Georgina : I like.

Georgina : what else?

Georgina : Yeah? Like, I said, I feel like I do.

Georgina : I do best if it's like a very specific app like.

Georgina : Don is literally just make a to do list, cross it off. And like, I, I like using like Pomodoro apps, because it's literally just a timer.

Georgina : I don't like when apps do too much like if they try to put too many things in one cause, then I think it gets.

Georgina : I think one like trying to navigate. How to use the app is too exhausting, so a lot of people won't use it. I've deleted apps for them like just having.

Georgina : too much.

Jordan : Right.

Georgina : So yeah, I guess I guess simplicity. If if I.

Georgina : if I'm like really trying to get like tasks, tasks done.

Jordan : Okay?

Jordan : So how much free time would you say you have.

Georgina : A good amount of free time.

Georgina : Usually I can enjoy my weekends.

Georgina : because I'm able to get.

Georgina : most of my homework done during the week.

Jordan : And what do you normally spend your free time on?

Georgina : I watch a lot of Youtube,

Georgina : and just doing tasks around the house or seeing my friends.

Jordan : Okay, what video games do you play? If any.

Georgina : I don't play any.

Jordan : Interesting.

Jordan : Okay, I'm gonna ask you some. I guess.

Jordan : questions about problems you may have had with.

Jordan : kind of productivity and apps in general.

Jordan : What would you say is the most.

Jordan : or some of the most frustrating aspects of staying productive or organized.

Georgina : I think, the the feeling of like being very overwhelmed by.

Georgina : all the tasks you have to do.

Georgina : and being so overwhelmed that like you just don't start them.

Jordan : Right.

Georgina : I think that's really frustrating, and also going from task to task.

Georgina : I have like a very long buffer time between things that I have to do if they are like.

Georgina : if they feel like mentally exhausting, like, if I have to switch from studying from one class to another like it takes me a very long time to like start that.

Jordan : so what would you say? Are some challenges or frustrations? You've experienced with.

Jordan : not only productivity, tools, like apps. But maybe methods, you've used either currently or in the past.

Georgina : I think.

Georgina : I think there's like a lot of tips out there that don't adhere to like the way that I learn.

Georgina : even though I I use pomodoro apps.

Georgina : and like try to stick by it. I realized that.

Georgina : I don't do that well with like.

Georgina : It's always like it's a recommendation to try to do like 20 min of studying 5 min off like stuff like that. But the way I've always functioned is like, if I am in the zone of something like there's no need for me to stop.

Georgina : But then I feel like I face burnout much easier, so I never know like how to balance that.

Jordan : So you had mentioned you have used some apps in the past.

Jordan : Is there any like specific reason why you stopped using them.

Georgina : I stopped using notion, because it's a very like.

Georgina : I would say there's a very difficult learning curve on notion.

Georgina : And

Georgina : There was a lot you had to do independently because it's a very like—you get to set it up exactly how you'd like, which is nice for when I'm very interested in doing that. But it's not very realistic with the time I have currently.

Georgina : I always stop using apps if they send notifications, or like—not even just notifications, but if the way that they try to get you to be productive feels a little condescending.

Georgina : Like, there's a very fine line between encouragement and kind of being condescending.

Jordan : So what would you say would make those either easier or more enjoyable to use?

Georgina : I think I've realized that I work so much simpler with something that is just very simple.

Georgina : So I like things that I can customize, but things that don't have too many options to use.

Jordan : You prefer simplicity with also customization.

Georgina : Yeah, so like simplicity with customization, but not to the point where this app is taking more time away from you that you could be putting into the things you actually need to get done.

Georgina : And also, having too many options is exhausting and makes you not want to use it.

Georgina : There are just too many decisions in the app itself.

Jordan : Yeah, so like, if you download an app to help you be productive, you kind of want to just use the app for what it's for—not really have to spend so much time setting it up.

Georgina : Yeah, like, I've tried apps before, like the ones where you take care of an animal by completing your tasks and stuff like that.

Georgina : And that sometimes doesn't work because it's like, okay, you're putting all this energy into making your avatar and whatever.

Georgina : And it's fun, but I think there's a line—it can't be taking too much of my time.

Jordan : Yeah, that makes sense.

Jordan : So are you familiar with the term gamification?

Georgina : Yes.

Jordan : Okay, so how would you feel about the idea of combining a productivity app with gamification?

Georgina : I think it's fine. And it works for some people.

Jordan : I think it would help with motivation and productivity.

Georgina : I think it can. I like those apps where your alarm won't turn off until you take a picture of something or finish a game. I think things like that can help.

Georgina : And I also think it can be helpful for people who need kind of an external—validation isn't the right word, but like...

Jordan : Like a motivator or something like that?

Georgina : Yeah, like... yeah, I guess.

Jordan : Okay, so if there were a gamified productivity app, are there any specific rewards that would be motivating for you?

Georgina : Oh... I guess I don't understand exactly how the app is gamifying things.

Jordan : So I guess some examples of rewards would be in-app points, badges, or leveling up. It could be that you have an avatar you can customize.

Jordan : Or maybe track your progress...

Georgina : I think something like that would work well as a habit tracker, more so than a to-do list, you know?

Georgina : If I'm trying to do my night routine every single night, it could be something that I'm tracking, and it's a visual representation of progress—like a tree growing every time you do it.

Georgina : I have a Pomodoro app that uses a tree system where every time you finish a study session, you grow your tree. And if you do enough of them, they actually donate money towards planting trees.

Georgina : So I think something like that, where what you're doing can actually make a difference.

Jordan : Okay, that's cool.

Jordan : Do you have a preference between mobile or desktop devices for gaming or productivity?

Georgina : I usually use my phone for any productivity apps.

Jordan : Okay, so which one do you feel is more convenient—mobile or desktop?

Georgina : Mobile.

Jordan : Do you have any smart devices, like a smartwatch or fitness tracker?

Georgina : No.

Jordan : Okay.

Jordan : Do you value competition amongst your peers?

Georgina : No, not really.

Jordan : Okay.

Jordan : How do you socialize—either social media, games, messaging, or in person?

Georgina : Normally, mostly in person or through text messages.

Jordan : Do you currently have any subscriptions to any apps?

Georgina : I have a Spotify subscription, and it's the student one, so I also get Hulu. And that's it.

Jordan : Okay.

Jordan : Are you familiar with the battle pass?

Georgina : No.

Jordan : Okay, so basically, a battle pass is an in-game reward system. It's kind of like a season pass where you purchase it, and depending on the game or app, you get rewarded over time through completing tasks, challenges, and leveling up.

Jordan : Basically, you're rewarded by progressing within the game.

Jordan : So how do you feel about that as a reward system?

Georgina : I think it could work. I don't see it working for myself, though.

Georgina : But I definitely could see it working if it's something shared amongst peers.

Georgina : Like if you could see your actual friends on leaderboards, and you can create a community where you push each other to do better, but you're also trying to do better than your friends.

Georgina : And you can kind of create this community where you push each other to do better, but you're also trying to do better than your friends.

Georgina : By completing more of your tasks.

Georgina : Yeah, especially since it's a digital thing. I think it would be a cool way—

Georgina : Like, if you have Internet friends, it's a cool way to connect with them.

Jordan : Okay.

Jordan : Would you say fear of missing out encourages any of your purchases?

Georgina : Yeah.

Jordan : Okay, how do you feel about spending money on software and applications, either mobile or desktop?

Georgina : I never really do.

Jordan : So is there any paid software or app that interests you, but because of the cost, it steers you away?

Georgina : Not really, not as of right now.

Jordan : Okay.

Jordan : So hypothetically speaking, if there was a paid service with free trials or demos, would that help with your decision on paying for it? Or would it still not interest you?

Georgina : I normally will use a trial as a trial, but it usually will not catch my interest to the point where I purchase it.

Georgina : The only things I have purchased are for note-taking for school.

Georgina : Yeah.

Jordan : Okay, thank you, Georgina.

Georgina : No problem.

[Michael] 00:10:03 Yep! No problem.